

ASIAN DEVELOPMENT BANK
**ANNUAL MEETING
REQUIREMENTS MANUAL**

OCTOBER 2025

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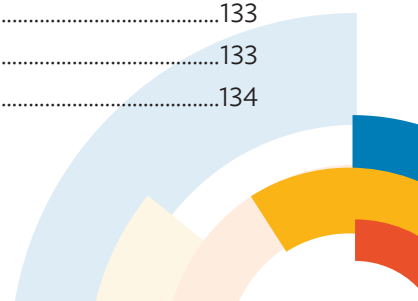
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ABBREVIATIONS



ADB	–	Asian Development Bank
AFE-ADB	–	Association of Former Employees of ADB
CSO	–	civil society organization
DOCK	–	Department of Communications and Knowledge Management
GOH	–	guest of honor
HOC	–	host country organizing committee
HOD	–	head of delegation
IPTV	–	internet protocol TV
m ²	–	square meter
MACC	–	Multi Agency Command Center
Mbps	–	megabits per second
MOU	–	memorandum of understanding
NGO	–	nongovernment organization
NGOC	–	NGO and Civil Society Center
PCO	–	professional congress organizer



INTRODUCTION OVERVIEW



The Annual Meeting

The annual meeting of the Asian Development Bank (ADB) Board of Governors is an opportunity to provide guidance on ADB administrative, financial, and operational directions. The meetings provide opportunities for member governments to interact with ADB staff, nongovernment organizations (NGOs), civil society organizations (CSOs), media, and representatives of observer countries, international organizations, academia, and the private sector. ADB's annual meetings have become a premier forum for the discussion of economic and social development issues in Asia and the Pacific.

The annual meeting strengthens ties between ADB and its members, especially the host country, as well as with its other development partners and stakeholders. It provides an opportunity for

- various stakeholders to interact/network with each other, member governments, ADB personnel, NGOs, the media, and representatives of observer countries, international organizations, academia, and the private sector;
- citizens of the host country, and those of other ADB members, to become more familiar with ADB operations; and
- the host country to showcase its culture, products, and facilities, and to demonstrate its capability of hosting a major, high-level international event.

The annual meeting serves as a valuable opportunity to strengthen the partnership between ADB and the host country. Planning and executing an event of this scale is a significant undertaking, typically spanning 1 to 3 years. Throughout this process, ADB and the host country work in close collaboration, building strong ties while ensuring the event is well organized, engaging, efficient, and memorable.

Overview. The Agreement Establishing the Asian Development Bank (ADB Charter)¹ and the Rules of Procedure of the Board of Governors² provide that:

The Board shall hold an Annual Meeting at such date and place as the Board may determine. However, the Board of Directors may change the date and place of the Meeting when special circumstances or reasons arise to justify such an action.

¹ ADB. 1965. [Agreement Establishing the Asian Development Bank \(ADB Charter\)](#).

² ADB. 2003. [Rules of Procedure of the Board of Governors of the Asian Development Bank](#).

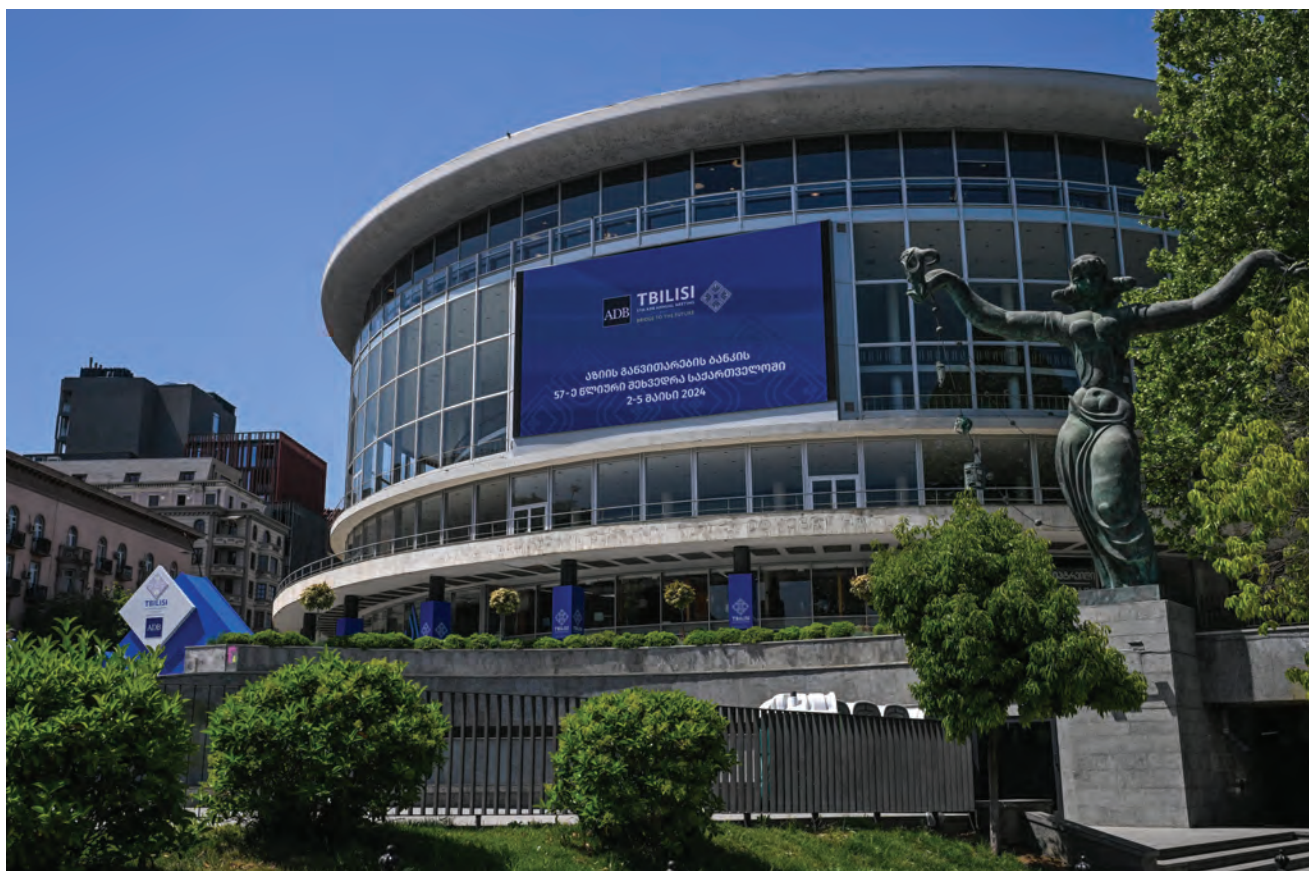


Date. The annual meeting takes place during the first week of May. ADB consults other multilateral development banks to ensure that there is no schedule overlap. The official meeting period is 4 days, plus 2 days of preparations, and additional setup and dismantling days.

Events. The events program usually includes seminars, meetings, and networking events arranged by ADB and the host country.

Venue. The annual meeting is always held in an ADB member country.

Participants. Usually around 3,000–4,000 participants attend.



Signage and banners welcome delegates to the 57th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Tbilisi, Georgia.



The main exhibit hall at the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.

Host Country

When an ADB member informally expresses interest in hosting an annual meeting, ADB provides the requirements for hosting, including a draft memorandum of understanding (MOU), an outline of a cost-sharing agreement, and meeting requirements. After the host country's consideration of the requirements and approval in principle of the cost-sharing agreement, ADB fields a fact-finding mission to assess the facilities and hold discussions with senior host country officials. The fact-finding mission usually comprises the ADB Secretary and ADB annual meeting coordinator. During this mission, the prospective host country shortlists key cities and probable meeting venues.

The annual meeting venue should have

- about 20,000 square meters (m²) of conference space, preferably in one venue;
- sufficient and appropriate size and types of meeting rooms; and
- adequate ancillary services like food outlets, medical clinic, elevators, safety standards such as fire exits, facilities for people with disabilities, and adequate restrooms.

Preferably located close to the meeting venue should be around 2,000 rooms at hotels rated at three to five stars, and with various function rooms, at reasonable rates.



The host country should

- ensure there are no special events, parades, or other meetings or conventions scheduled during or close to the annual meeting period that may compete with the resources of the prospective host city or affect circulation around the city;
- tentatively book the proposed meeting venues, from the start of the annual meeting setup period to the dismantling date; and
- ensure that any renovation plans in place for any of the proposed meeting venues are scheduled to be completed at least 3 months before the setup date or are scheduled for after the dismantling date.

In addition, the host country is expected to provide

- good security and traffic control;
- high-quality technical and other equipment and furniture for the meeting and temporary ADB offices;
- local staff to support the annual meeting; and
- adequate staff and facilities at the airport (or point of entry into the host country) for arrival and departure formalities (i.e., customs, immigration, and quarantine) of the meeting participants.

Memorandum of understanding. The host country and ADB sign an MOU for the annual meeting, setting out the obligations and responsibilities of the two parties, communication channels, and other details. A cost-sharing agreement forms an integral part of the MOU.

The signatory for ADB is always the ADB Secretary, and the signatory for the host country is usually the ADB Governor. Signing should take place before the ADB establishment mission. Two copies of the MOU are signed so that ADB and the host country may keep one original each.

Tax exemptions, privileges, and immunities. The host country

- provides the Governors, other members of official delegations, and other officials, employees, and experts engaged by ADB the privileges, exemptions, and immunities provided for in the Charter, to which all members of ADB are signatories;
- should extend to other participants, including accredited international and local journalists attending the annual meeting, the necessary privileges and courtesies to facilitate the proper exercise of their duties, functions, and activities at the meeting;
- should exempt the operations and transactions of ADB from all taxation and customs duties. The preferred way to implement tax exemption is by authorizing the suppliers and service providers used by ADB to not charge taxes. If this approach is not possible, taxes paid by ADB must be reimbursed by the host country; and
- must also provide speedy clearance through customs, and duty exemption, of any shipments sent by or on behalf of ADB.

Schedule of host country tasks. Once an agreement on the meeting venue has been reached, a schedule of host country tasks is submitted for general guidance of the host country in its preparations.

Responsibilities of ADB and the host country. The cost-sharing agreement, which is attached to the MOU signed by ADB and the host country, details the division of responsibilities between ADB and the host country.

The table below outlines the typical division of costs between ADB and the host country in organizing the meeting. Specific tasks, as well as technical requirements, furniture specifications, and equipment, are customized based on the event location.

ADB and Host Country Division of Responsibility		
Item	ADB	Host Country
A. Travel-related costs (airfare and hotel) of ADB personnel to and from the meeting venue	X	
B. Program of high-level seminars, including speakers' travel expenses	X	
C. Major networking events (e.g., ADB President's reception and receptions organized by ADB departments (e.g., for media and bankers)	X	
D. Refreshments in ADB offices and any other production offices required by the professional congress organizer (PCO)		X
E. Services (for 1 week) of about 100 English-speaking locally engaged staff members to assist the ADB Secretariat		X
F. Venue, including office and meeting space required; construction of office partitions as necessary; technical, janitorial, and other staff; sound systems, all audiovisual equipment and operators, simultaneous interpretation, and audio and video recording; furniture, equipment, internet services, and supplies; and food outlets where participants may purchase meals during the annual meeting		X
G. Local transport (about 80 official cars and shuttle bus services between airport and hotels, hotels and the meeting venue, and to and from venues for networking functions), buses for the Tours Program (if any), and parking		X
H. Security		X
I. Other local staff (receptionists, ushers, etc.)		X
J. Networking events and Tours Program (optional)		X
K. Entry facilitation (i.e., customs and immigration) and ensuring that sufficient hotel rooms are available at a reasonable cost (participants meet their own hotel expenses)		X
L. Meeting signage at airport for arrival and departures, on-site and venue branding, graphic design and local area marketing requirements		X

Host country organizing committee. The host country creates an organizing committee to ensure delivery of the annual meeting. The host country organizing committee (HOC) is headed by the host country executive director, a high-ranking government official, who interfaces with different government officials across departments and ministries up to the ministerial level when needed. They are expected to be given full authority, on behalf of the host country, to make the necessary organizational arrangements with ADB.

The HOC also establishes a working level secretariat, led by a host country coordinator. The host country coordinator prepares, coordinates, and implements arrangements for the meeting. The host country coordinator is expected to be a government official of sufficient high rank and is expected to communicate regularly with ADB staff.



The ADB annual meeting coordinator is the principal ADB officer with whom the host country coordinator communicates.

Professional congress organizer. The host country is strongly encouraged to engage a professional congress organizer (PCO), or event manager, and a public relations manager. A PCO is a company specializing in the planning, organization, management, and administration of congresses, conferences, seminars, and similar events for corporate firms, institutions, and organizations. It can handle areas of congress administration for which the HOC may not have the knowledge, resources, time, or technical know-how. If appointed, the PCO acts as a consultant to the HOC.

Companies offering PCO services are usually event managers, travel agents, tour companies, or public relations consultants. Some PCOs offer a full range of services, while others offer only partial services directly, subcontracting the rest.

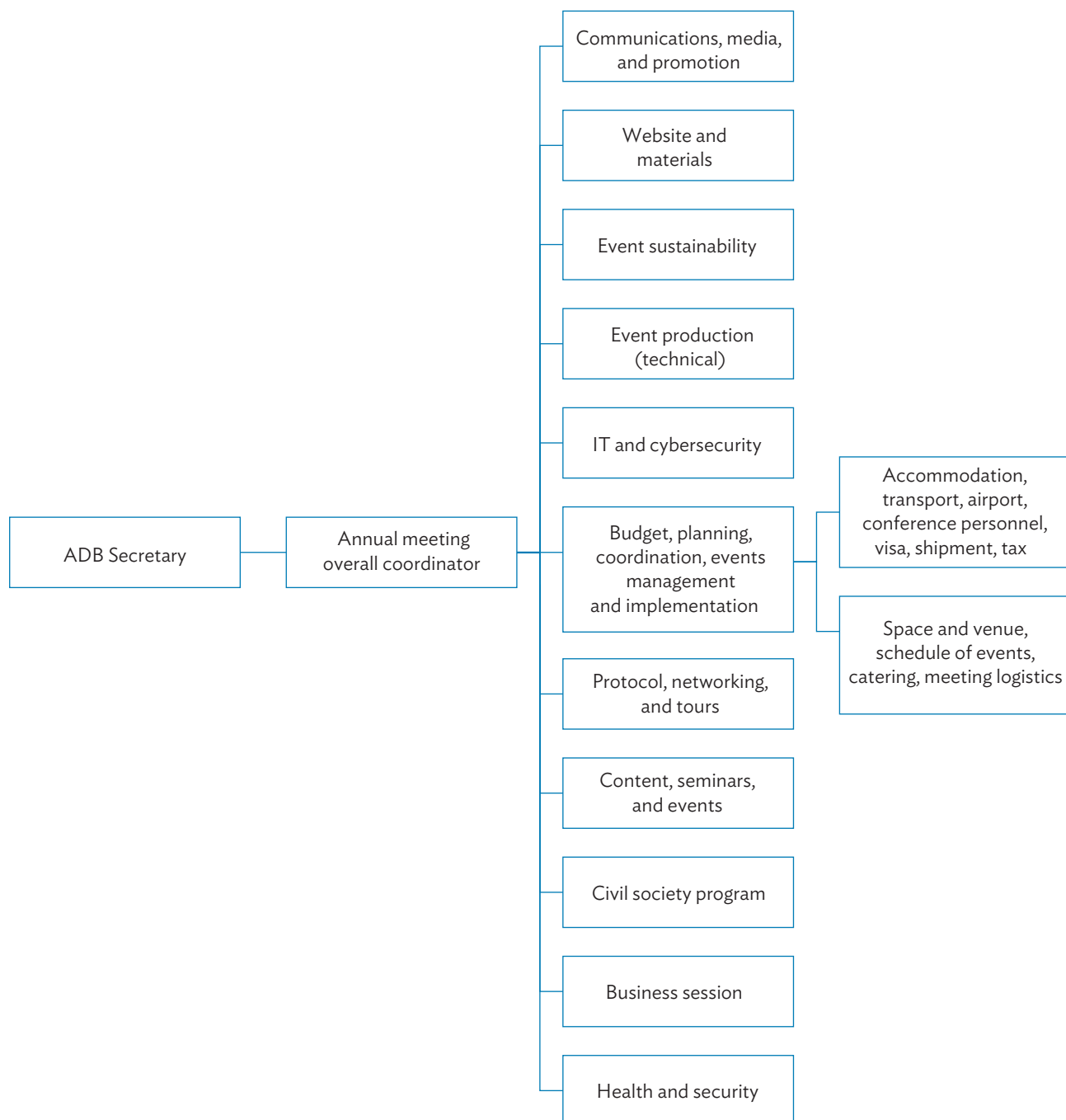
Contracts between the HOC and PCO or event manager should be prepared and signed, preferably before the ADB establishment mission, 12 months prior to the annual meeting. All agreements and communications between the HOC and PCO should be confirmed in writing. The HOC is expected to clearly define the PCO's responsibilities.

Annual Meeting Requirements Manual

This document, the Annual Meeting Requirements Manual, sets out the main requirements of ADB's annual meeting, as referred to in the MOU signed by the host country government and ADB.

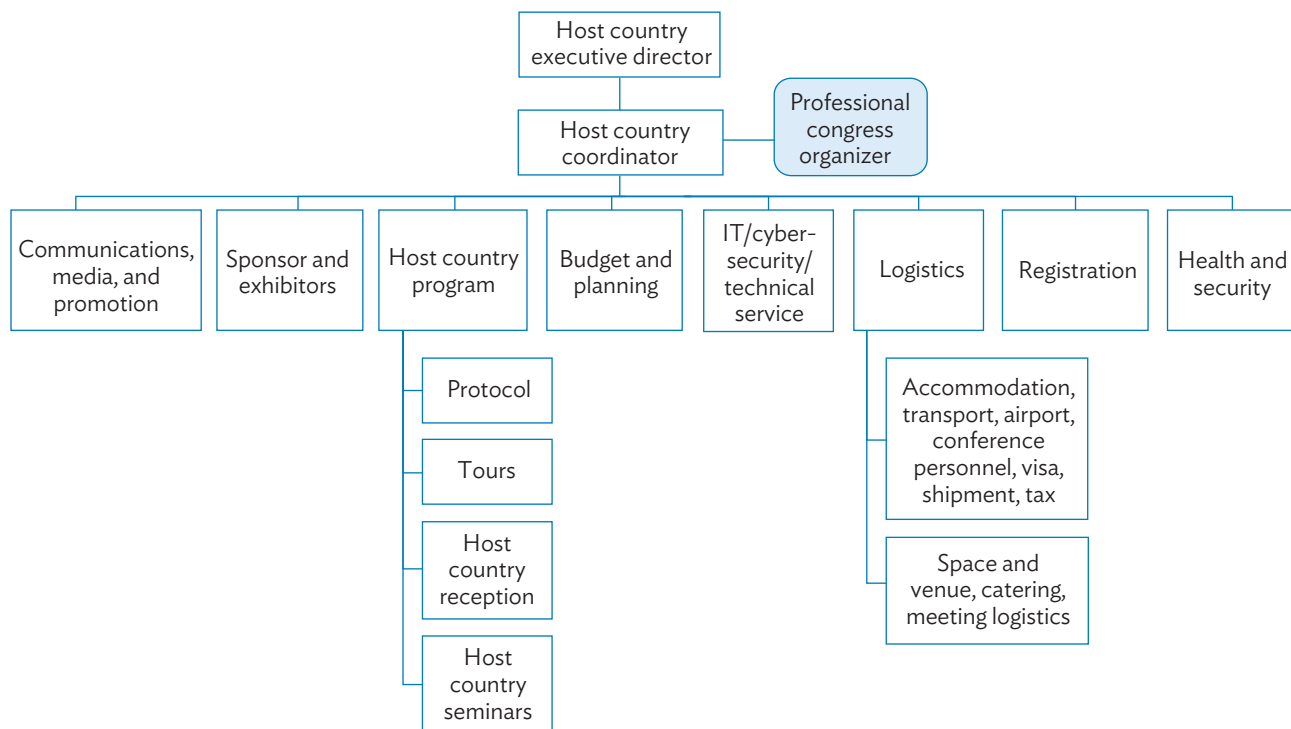
It is a detailed guide for the host country and ADB of the requirements for an annual meeting and the responsibilities of each side. While most requirements are standard for every meeting, they may vary according to location, local conditions, and other factors that may arise during the organization of the meeting. The manual is updated regularly to incorporate any new procedures and technologies.

ADB ORGANIZATIONAL CHART





HOST COUNTRY ORGANIZING COMMITTEE ORGANIZATIONAL CHART



ADB Annual Meeting Requirements Wheel



Summary of Annual Meeting Requirements

Governance and Evaluation • Memorandum of understanding • Organizational structures for ADB, host country • ADB missions • Stakeholder engagement: ADB's Annual Meeting Requirements Manual, presentations, briefings, outreach • Project management tools: schedule of activities, timelines, milestones • Survey and post-event feedback sessions after the meeting	Hotels • Assistance with participants' travel • Total hotel estimated rooms required: 1,800 – 500 rooms for member delegations and observers in hotels near annual meeting venue – 300 rooms block booked for ADB personnel – Additional 1,000 rooms for private sector, media, nongovernment/civil society organizations • Block book hotel rooms in advance • Negotiated rates for all rooms for official delegates • Reservation link managed by a hotel management company • Ensure free Wi-Fi connectivity • Negotiate for hotel desks with personnel • Parking area for shuttles	Security and Health • Risk assessment and mass casualty plan • Health-related entry requirements and procedures, if any • Coordination with police and medical authorities • Coordination with ADB's NGO and Civil Society Center (NGOC) • Emergency contact numbers • Standby ambulance, doctors on site • Security plan for VIPs, hotels, airport, venues, tours • Security perimeter, emergency procedures
Budget • Coordination of annual meeting budget • Coordination of cost-sharing agreement between ADB and host country	Transport • Cars for Governors/heads of department and other VIPs (68 Governors + 10 VIPs, less those using embassy cars and those availing car pool) • Shuttle buses for airport to hotel and for hotel to venue (approximately 50 but could be fewer if hotels offer transfer) • Parking and drivers' lounge required • Transport coordinator and dispatcher required	Branding, Media, and Promotion • Communication and awareness (internal and external ex. website, mobile application, e-newsletter, news releases) • Branding and logo • Theme and content • Media and social media • Crisis communications plan
Events • Coordination of theme, schedule, Governors' events, and seminar program with ADB and host country • Coordination with ADB's NGOC, Private Sector Operations Department, and other key ADB departments • Annual meeting board papers, arrangement paper, and information bulletin • Networking events, including venues for receptions, networking lunches • Tours Program, if applicable	Accreditation, Invitations, and Registration • Identify who attends the annual meeting and how they are invited • Types of participants and how they are accredited • Host country invitations to events and optional activities • ADB provides system for registration • Definition of registration categories • Online registration requirements for all invited participants • Security coordination • Registration system and timelines • Appointment of host country registration focal	Staff Support • ADB organizing committee and host country counterparts • Liaison officers for Governors/heads of department • Security personnel • Local service personnel (airport, transport, tours, medical) • Conference Staff assigned to annual meeting duties



Summary of Annual Meeting Requirements		
Space Requirements Events venue, offices, seminars, meetings, Registration Center, Media Center, Civil Society Organizations Center, booths (total space is approximately 20,000 m²)	Visas - Published procedure for visas with focal person - Ministry concurrence for gratis visas to ADB personnel attending the annual meeting - Ministry of foreign affairs office to instruct embassies and consulates to facilitate visas for participants	Sponsorship, Partnerships, and Gifts - Host country may engage external sponsors to cover some costs - ADB to be consulted on host country sponsors - ADB invites organizations to sponsor lunch seminars during the meeting
Procurement - Discussion of requirements with possible suppliers - Contract finalization and appointment of event-specific suppliers and third-party suppliers by ADB and host country	Protocol - Coordination with ministry of foreign affairs for VIP protocol arrangements and guest of honor participation - Protocol for Governors	Sustainability - Reduce carbon footprint - Reduce and recycle waste - Use renewable energy where possible - Promote use of local resources and fair trade - Use systems and processing in line
Information and Conference Technology - High-speed internet connectivity (Wi-Fi) in all venues, enhanced in high-traffic areas - Live webcast of selected events - Redundancy plan for internet service provider - Cabling plan for offices and event venues - Cybersecurity measures - Audiovisual requirements in all venues	Airport Arrangements - Welcome and departure assistance desks - Consider dedicated ADB special lanes at immigration - Signage and welcome banners - VIP welcome and lounge - Parking space for shuttle - Designated pick up area	Shipments and Tax Exemption - Discuss shipment requirements with ADB and appoint broker and focal person - Confirm ADB privileges and immunities

m² = square meter.



CHAPTER 1

BUDGET



Overview

Hosting the ADB annual meeting entails carrying out detailed preparations and requires making choices while considering costs. The MOU and cost-sharing agreement clearly set out the division of costs and responsibilities between ADB and the host country. ADB does not charge participants, nor does ADB expect income from the annual meeting. The host country may decide to share costs between central and local governments. It may also defray expenses through private sector sponsorships and partnerships, and other revenue sources.

The host country should ensure that its budget is approved on time to avoid procurement delays and provide an update to ADB on budget approval 1 year before the meeting. Monitoring of expenses should be implemented by both ADB and the host country, following clear guidelines for staff regarding authority to incur expenditure. Advice on financing implications must be given as early as possible to concerned parties if there are unforeseen expenses.

In case the anticipated level of sponsorship is not achieved (e.g., sudden decision of sponsors to back out), the host country must have backup plans in place, such as procuring other local sources of funds. Any decision to downsize or revise the program or meeting plans should be made, at the latest, by January of the year of the annual meeting.

Budget Assumptions

- **Number of participants.** 3,000–4,000. Some factors affecting the actual number of participants for each meeting include direct flight availability, hotel and flight costs, availability of host country embassies in the participants' countries, and procedures for visa issuance.
- **Duration of the event.** 4 days, plus 2 days in advance for preparatory meetings, plus ingress (setting up) and egress (dismantling).

Ingress	Preparatory	Official Days	Egress
# of days for construction/ setup to be confirmed by host country	2 days before meeting Operation dates for registration, offices and centers	4 days official annual meeting days	# of days for dismantling / cleanup to be confirmed by host country



- **Number of events.** Up to 100, including networking events organized by the host country, such as the reception lunch hosted by the government, and any paying tours offered to participants.
- **Contingency expenditures.** 15% of budget.

Calculating and Disbursing the Budget

- Identify expense categories.
- Identify fixed expenses (e.g., venue, marketing materials, audiovisual requirements) and variable expenses (e.g., meals).
- Calculate overall budget guided by expense categories.
- Identify sponsorship or partnership opportunities to support the budget. Even if sponsorship of some items is anticipated, these should nonetheless be included in the budget since sponsorships may not be confirmed until late in the preparation process.
- Ensure the agreed budget is made available to the corresponding authorities on time so preparations are not delayed due to the late release of funds.
- Provide contingency and set clear guidelines for the use of contingency funds.
- Factor in the cost of labor and overtime, as there is often work on holidays and weekends.
- Provide sufficient time for bidding procedures to take place that will allow contracted service providers to be properly briefed and deliver on schedule.

General Host Country Expense Categories

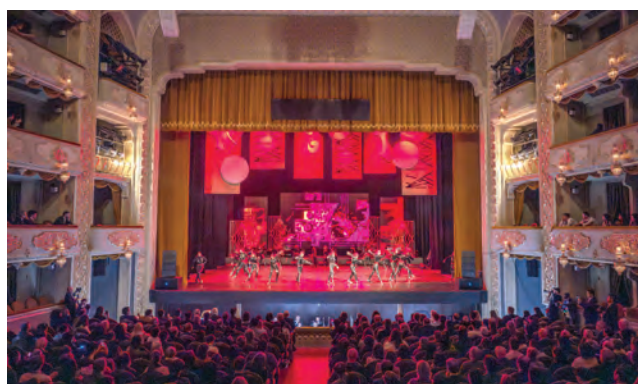
Preparatory Stage

- **PCO.** Engagement of services of a PCO to support the implementation of the meeting.
- **Space for the HOC.** This includes temporary offices, meeting rooms, equipment, supplies, and communication requirements
- **Travel expenses.** This includes airfares, transport, accommodations, and allowances
- **Branding expenses.** This covers the development of logo and website, public relations, and outreach prior to the meeting.
- **Simulation exercises.** This includes airport reception, transportation/shuttle services, and security evacuation.
- **ADB mission.** Support including meeting venues, equipment, shuttle services for site visits/hotels, and interpretation, if applicable.

During the Annual Meeting

- **Staff support.** For a full list of requirements, see Chapter 17: Staff Support.
- **HOC staff.** This includes cost of food, transportation, and telecommunications.
- **Additional personnel needed on site.** This will be for various venues and includes the cost of hiring, training, food, transportation, telecommunications, and uniforms.

- **Meeting and office space.** Venue/s, including provision for backup plans, permits, labor and cost of setups, high-speed internet, and security.
- **Site facilities.** These include construction costs, technical facilities (such as generators, webcasting facilities, simultaneous interpretation equipment, cable connections, and video production), utilities (such as air-conditioning or heating, gas for kitchens, drinking water, restrooms, and trash sorting, recycling, and disposal), and decorations.
- **Communications.** This covers telecommunications, including installation, testing, and dismantling costs, and handling of shipments of materials and equipment.
- **Entertainment.** Expenses include host country events, such as receptions, catering, optional cultural performances at the opening session and evening reception, and conference souvenirs.
- **Local transport.** Expenses include the cost of drivers, gas, meal allowances, parking, paging or communication systems, and insurance.
- **Printed materials.** Promotional materials, signage, writing pads with logo, and registration badges.
- **Furniture and supplies.** Tables and chairs, microphones, backdrop, photocopiers, LCD screens, projectors, simultaneous interpretation booths, headsets and receivers, standard office supplies (pens, pencils, erasers, staplers), flagpoles with stand, plants, flower arrangements, computers, shredding machines, and white boards.



Scenes from the host country event held on the sidelines of the 57th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Tbilisi, Georgia.

Costs Covered by ADB

- Travel and related expenses of ADB personnel attending the meeting, including seminar speakers and moderators participating in ADB-led events and seminars.
- Note: Travel and related costs for government delegations and other participants are not covered by ADB and are the responsibility of the respective individuals or delegations.
- Cost of transporting ADB's shipment from Manila to the host country and back, including supervision of unpacking and repacking at the venue.
- Expenses for official receptions organized by ADB, such as the President's Reception and ADB-hosted events such as breakfast, lunches, or cocktails hosted by ADB departments.
- Cost of the registration system and badging.
- Expenses related to meeting documentation, whether printed or electronic, including the program of events and info map.



Timeline of Tasks Related to Budget

Task	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
Review and agree on the cost-sharing agreement between ADB and host country	30
Sign the MOU, with related cost-sharing agreement	24
Issue host country draft budget for all elements of the event	18
Identify events and services that may be of interest to sponsors and update expenditure	12
Ensure all payments are made and send pending bills to ADB	1
Provide breakdown of costs incurred by host country and sponsors	1

MOU = memorandum of understanding.



CHAPTER 2

EVENTS



Overview

The three main event categories of the annual meeting are (i) official events, which are formal and structured; (ii) the seminar program, which is more informal; and (iii) networking and cultural events, which provide an opportunity for delegates to socialize.

The overall schedule of events is managed by ADB in coordination with the host country. Major meetings, events, and networking activities are included in the schedule.

Event Categories		
Official Events	Seminar Program	Networking Events
Opening session	ADB seminars	ADB networking events
Business session	Host country seminars	Host country networking events
Governors' plenary	Sponsored seminars	Governors' luncheons
ADB President's press conference and media briefings	Media events	Networking lunches
Official meetings • ADB President's bilateral meetings • Constituency meetings • Subregional meetings • Trilateral meetings among Governors • Asian Development Fund Meeting • Association of Southeast Asian Nations + the People's Republic of China, Japan, and the Republic of Korea (ASEAN+3)	Civil society organizations program	Tour program
	Private sector events	



Sample Schedule of Main Events

SUNDAY - 2 MAY		MONDAY - 2 MAY		TUESDAY - 3 MAY		WEDNESDAY - 4 MAY		THURSDAY - 5 MAY	
8:00 - 8:30		President's Bilateral Meetings [times to be determined]	8:00 - 8:30	President's Bilateral Meetings [times to be determined]	8:00 - 8:30	President's Bilateral Meetings [times to be determined]	8:00 - 8:30	President's Bilateral Meetings [times to be determined]	
8:30 - 9:00			8:30 - 9:00		8:30 - 9:00		8:30 - 9:00		
9:00 - 9:30		South Asian Regional Cooperation Meeting (Restricted)	9:00 - 9:30	ADB Inaugural Meeting (Restricted)	9:00 - 9:30		9:00 - 9:30	Governors Business Session	ADB Seminar 10
9:30 - 10:00		ADB Inaugural Meeting (Restricted)	9:30 - 10:00	Meeting between Civil Society and ADB Senior Management	9:30 - 10:00		9:30 - 10:00		
10:00 - 10:30		Pacific DAC Governors and ADB Meeting (Restricted)	10:00 - 10:30		10:00 - 10:30	Opening Session of the Board of Governors / Cultural Event / Governors' Photo with Guest of Honor	10:00 - 10:30		
10:30 - 11:00			10:30 - 11:00	ADB Seminar 4	10:30 - 11:00		10:30 - 11:00		
11:00 - 11:30			11:00 - 11:30		11:00 - 11:30		11:00 - 11:30		
11:30 - 12:00			11:30 - 12:00		11:30 - 12:00		11:30 - 12:00		
12:00 - 12:30			12:00 - 12:30		12:00 - 12:30		12:00 - 12:30		
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7:30 - 8:00			7:30 - 8:00		7:30 - 8:00		7:30 - 8:00		
8:00 - 8:30			8:00 - 8:30		8:00 - 8:30		8:00 - 8:30		
8:30 - 9:00			8:30 - 9:00		8:30 - 9:00		8:30 - 9:00		

Restricted events are only for specific participants notified in advance.

CIVIL SOCIETY ORGANIZATION'S EVENTS

GOVERNORS' EVENTS

HOST COUNTRY EVENTS

MEDIA EVENTS

PARTNERS' EVENTS

ADB SEMINARS & ADB-LED SIDE EVENTS

SIDE EVENTS

SPONSORED SEMINARS

SUBREGIONAL MEETINGS

The table of schedule of main events is managed by ADB in coordination with the host country. Only major meetings, seminars, and networking events are included here.

Official Events

Official events throughout the annual meeting include the following:

Opening session. As this is a high-profile event attended by the host country guest of honor (GOH), close coordination with ADB on protocol, security, and the setting for the opening session is critical. It is a formal occasion where the Chair of the Board of Governors, GOH, and the ADB President all address annual meeting participants. Simultaneous interpretation is provided and the event is webcast live. A video recording is uploaded to the ADB website within hours of the event.

Before the start of the opening session, the host country stages an official photo session with the GOH, Governors or heads of delegations (HODs), and ADB Management. Only ADB and host country photographers are allowed to take photos, as opening the session to the media is usually restricted due to protocol and logistics issues.



Opening Session of the 56th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors, in Incheon in the Republic of Korea.



Governors' photo at the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors, in Milan, Italy.

Around 1,500 of the 3,000–4,000 meeting participants usually attend. Formal invitations to registered participants are not required. About 400 seats are also allocated for Governors, ADB Board and Management, host country guests, and diplomatic representatives of ADB members.



The host country may include a short cultural event as part of the session. The program may also include videos produced by ADB and the host country, shown as participants take their seats before the official program.



Host country cultural event during the Opening Session at the 56th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Incheon, Republic of Korea.

Business session. The Governors' formal business is conducted during this session, which gives the Board of Governors an opportunity to (i) adopt resolutions presented to it by the procedures committee and to take notes of other documents; (ii) approve the provisional schedule of meetings, provisions relating to the conduct of meeting, and the agenda; and (iii) make individual statements, if desired. Around 400 observers may be expected to attend.



Scene from the Governors' Business Session of the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.

At the start of the session, the Chair explains how the meeting will be conducted and introduces some of the agenda items. They then invite one Governor at a time to deliver their statement. There are usually no unannounced interventions or discussions. The Governors conclude their statements and consider the remaining items on the agenda. The Chair-elect (usually the Governor of the next host country) gives a short statement, followed by the closing remarks of the ADB President and the Chair, and just before the session ends, the ADB President presents gifts of appreciation (sets of gavel and block) to the Chair and Vice-Chairs. The Chair passes on the symbolic baton to the Chair-elect in a brief ceremony, then the Chair officially closes the business session.



ADB President Masato Kanda presents a gavel to Vice-Chair of the ADB Board of Governors Rose Nakanaga, Governor for the Federated States of Micronesia at ADB and Secretary of Finance and Administration for the National Government.



The Chair of the ADB Board of Governors and ADB Governor for Italy, and Governor of the Bank of Italy, Fabio Panetta (second from left), hands over the baton to ADB Alternate Governor for Uzbekistan and First Deputy Minister at the Ministry of Economy and Finance, Ilhom Norqulov. They are joined by ADB President Masato Kanda and the Secretary of ADB Asel Djusupbekova.

Governors are informed in advance to limit the length of their oral statements to 3 minutes to give everyone the opportunity to speak (each ADB member is represented by a Governor, so there are 69 Governors). Governors can submit for the record longer texts than those delivered or even their entire text without delivery. Joint statements are encouraged, and those giving joint statements are given 5 minutes, as well as higher priority in the speaking order.

The order of speakers and meeting agenda is established in advance by ADB, with the list of ADB members by “subscribed shares and voting power” used as the basis for determining the order. The list of speakers is posted on a board outside the venue and copies are also placed on the head table.

The working language for the session is English, as stipulated by Section 10 of the Rules of Procedure of the Board of Governors (footnote 2).

The host country must provide facilities and equipment for simultaneous translation for this session, with headsets placed in front of each Governor or HOD and at the head table. Members wishing to use the facilities are required to provide their own interpreters at their own cost. Only the interpreters may receive Governors’ statements before they are delivered.



Once a Governor has delivered their statement, a member of the ADB Secretariat uses some form of electronic communication (e.g., email, live webcast, or instant messaging) to inform staff at ADB headquarters that the statement may now be uploaded to the ADB website. Delegates may read the Governors' statements on the ADB website and download if needed. Video recordings of the statements are uploaded to be viewed on demand on the website within hours of the event. To reduce paper consumption, hard copies of statements are not distributed.

Governors' plenary. This provides an opportunity for Governors to engage with their peers in a closed door, free-flowing dialogue on a topic selected by the ADB President. This session is not open to the public. Participation is limited to ADB Governors/HODs and the ADB President. The host country provides the venue, furniture, and equipment for the meeting.



Scenes from the Governors' Plenary held during the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.

Press conference. The ADB President customarily gives an opening press conference on topical issues to set the agenda for the annual meeting. Attendance is by invitation and limited to the media, with around 150 journalists expected to attend. Special arrangements for live video conferencing may be needed and facilities for simultaneous interpretation are also required.



The then President of ADB Masatsugu Asakawa addresses the global media at the press conference of the 56th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Incheon, Republic of Korea.



ADB President Masato Kanda engages with members of the international press at the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.

Official meetings. These high-level events attended by the ADB Board of Governors or other key stakeholders are organized throughout the annual meeting period. They serve as important forums for dialogue and exchanges of views among ADB's development and business partners. The host country provides venues, equipment, and setups for these meetings. ADB provides information on the detailed requirements for each meeting. Agendas are set by the meeting organizers. ADB will advise host country officials if they are expected to attend any of the official meetings.



Scene from the Pacific Developing Member Countries Governors and ADB Management Meeting held on the sidelines of the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.



Scene from the ADF Donors Annual Consultation Meeting held on the sidelines of the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.

Seminar Program

The seminar program aims to facilitate knowledge exchange on a range of economic, financial, and development issues and to promote dialogue on issues that affect poverty reduction efforts in Asia and the Pacific. It includes seminars, country presentations, the host country exhibit, private sector and institutional events, and a civil society program. Seminars are open to all registered participants on a first-come, first-served basis.

Seminars range from informal forums to workshops, but most are in the form of a panel with a moderator and a limited number of speakers. It is recommended that each seminar last no longer than 1.5 hours, including 30 minutes for questions and answers.

Promotion. ADB promotes the seminars by posting information on its website and its annual meeting mobile application, distributing a printed program of events, and circulating e-newsletters to participants. ADB's Department of Communications and Knowledge Management (DOCK) and seminar coordinators work together to issue news releases immediately after the seminars.

Displays. ADB designs the slides template for the digital backdrop for each seminar. Sponsors of seminars may display their banners and logos during the sponsored seminars if they are consistent with the branding guidelines prepared by DOCK for each annual meeting. ADB prepares information on the seminars on digital display screens at high-traffic areas around the venue. Seminar materials, including any presentations and resumes of speakers, are posted online. No printed copies are distributed.



Seminar room requirements. All seminar room requirements are summarized by ADB and forwarded to the host country. The host country must ensure that the latest information on seminar requirements is shared with their room setup managers. Changes to seminar setups are often inevitable, e.g., speakers dropping out or new speakers added. Flexibility is therefore essential to address changes to seminar room setups efficiently.

The types of seminars are as follows:

ADB seminars. These feature panelists from government, the private sector, academia, and civil society, and provide a platform to discuss economic, financial, and development issues of current interest to ADB stakeholders. Around 10 topics are selected by ADB from proposals received.

ADB reserves and pays for hotel rooms for seminar speakers at one of the official hotels for the official duration of their stay, directly to the hotel. If speakers choose other hotels, they settle their invoices themselves, and ADB reimburses them up to a pre-established ceiling. ADB informs the host country about speakers that require VIP treatment.

Governors' seminar. This ADB flagship seminar sees selected ADB Governors, the ADB President, and other distinguished participants exchange views on timely financial and economic issues.

Sponsored seminars. ADB invites private sector partners to submit proposals for these lunchtime seminars, and usually selects six to eight from many submissions. Venues for these seminars should accommodate up to 150 participants, usually at round tables. The sponsor liaises directly with the venue and caterer regarding requirements and payment details, for which the sponsor is responsible. It is strongly recommended that venues are chosen inside the primary annual meeting venue.

Host country seminars. The host country may organize its own seminar program. Overlap with ADB seminars—especially the Governors' seminar—should be avoided. The host country decides on the topics for its seminars and should avoid duplicating the themes covered in ADB seminars. ADB should be informed at an early stage of the topics and the speakers for these seminars. The host country handles all logistical arrangements and costs. It may prepare its own brochure containing the program or include the program on the Annual Meeting webpage, in a newsletter, or on the host country's website, with a link from the ADB website. The host country may also organize a business, trade, investment, or tourism exhibition in cooperation with the private sector, media, or other partners and ADB. It may consist of a series of events, seminars, and presentations, including an opportunity for participants to meet ministers of the host country.



Delegates exchange views at the Unlocking the Power of Sustainability Disclosure event held on the sidelines of the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.



Panelists discuss cross-border collaboration for future resilience at the Governors' Seminar held on the sidelines of the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.

Media. ADB's DOCK facilitates a partnership with an international media agency to hold a panel debate on a topical issue. The panel is typically composed of the ADB President and invited Governors, and economic or development experts. This event is exclusively broadcast by the media partner organization. Video recording by other media organizations is prohibited.

Civil society program. This program is organized by ADB's NGO and Civil Society Center (NGOC) and targets civil society representatives and other participants interested in civil society development. The program starts with a meeting between representatives of CSOs and members of ADB's senior management team. Panel discussions are co-organized with CSOs on key developmental or specific topics relevant to ADB operations. The program also includes Learning with Partners events, which are informal and flexibly structured CSO networking activities to share knowledge and good practice in development activities that have a high degree of civil society participation or relevance.

Typically, program speakers are invited by the CSO in charge of organizing the event. ADB also invites speakers to the program and covers their travel expenses. ADB reserves hotel rooms for the speakers at one of the official hotels and pays for their hotel accommodation for the official duration of their stay directly to the hotel.



Scene from the CNBC debate on AI and the future of food systems. The recording of the event took place on the margins of the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.



Scene from the meeting between civil society organizations and ADB Senior Management held on the sidelines of the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.



ADB President Masato Kanda addresses participants of the meeting between civil society organizations and ADB Senior Management held on the sidelines of the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.



Delegates attend the seminar Engaging Stakeholders Meaningfully on Sustainable Development Projects - Lessons from Community Participatory Approaches held on the sidelines of the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.



The host country must ensure that the latest information on program requirements is shared with their room setup managers. Changes to program setups are often inevitable and flexibility is therefore also essential to address changes efficiently.

Networking and Cultural Events

Networking events are lunches, dinners, or cocktail receptions where ADB stakeholders strengthen existing partnerships, create new ones, and advance their mutual interests. Networking events do not customarily include trade exhibitions and fairs; functions hosted by associations of consultants or contractors; or receptions hosted by banks, newspapers, or other commercial institutions. Exceptions may occur when, with the concurrence of ADB, the event is either cosponsored by the host country or has the endorsement of the host country (e.g., receptions hosted by the bankers' association of the host country). Receptions hosted by individual delegations are not classified as official networking events.

The ADB protocol and networking events team has an oversight role for host country networking events and coordinates with host country counterparts about any special arrangements for VIPs, information for participants, security, and traffic flow.

The networking and cultural events include the following:

ADB networking events. ADB is solely responsible for arranging and paying for the costs of the ADB President's reception, luncheons, and receptions hosted by ADB.

Host country networking events. The host country is expected to host luncheons for Governors and other VIPs, and a reception for all participants hosted by the ministry of finance, or other agencies, e.g., mayor's office, central bank, or local bankers' association. At the reception, the host country may include a cultural presentation, e.g., concert, opera, or ballet.



Delegates attend the Host Country Reception held on the sidelines of the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.



ADB President Masato Kanda with Italy's Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni; Chair of the ADB Board of Governors and ADB Governor for Italy, and Governor of the Bank of Italy, Fabio Panetta; Italy's Minister of Economy and Finance Giancarlo Giorgetti; and Mayor of the city of Milan, Giuseppe Sala at the Host Country Event in La Scala.

Networking lunches. The host country offers networking lunches for participants for up to the 4 days of the annual meeting.



Networking hub at the Annual Meeting in Incheon, Republic of Korea.



Tour program. This optional program may be prepared by the host country for annual meeting participants and any accompanying persons. The host country may wish to review this arrangement with ADB and consider the possibility of offering the tour program free of charge or with a set fee. Details of the tour, payment, and schedule can be posted on the annual meeting website. A VIP spouses and partners' tour may also be organized by the host country but is not mandatory.



Timeline of Tasks Related to Events

Opening Session	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
Discuss usual opening session protocol scenario	11
Decide if there will be a cultural event and videos. Inform that ADB will showcase a corporate video before the opening session as delegates are entering in the session hall.	11
Inform that the ADB President will use a speech prompter during the opening session, and will need to rehearse at the venue of the opening session before the event	11
Discuss webcasting the opening session	11
Confirm proposed seating plan. Inform that media will be given a designated seating area and a platform for photographers and broadcast media	5
Advise ADB of GOH	5
Provide list of members of diplomatic corps and local VIPs to be invited	5
Discuss opening session protocol scenario; provide feedback to ADB	5–2
Finalize arrangements for opening session in consultation with ADB	1
Implement opening session protocol scenario	Month of the annual meeting
Business Session	
Confirm Chair's availability	6
Determine date, time, and venue of ADB President's courtesy call on the Chair	6
Confirm if the Chair will deliver a combined statement (opening and country statements) or separate statements	6
Discuss and confirm logistical arrangements for the business session (including dry run)	5
Governors' Plenary	
Discuss logistical arrangements	9
Confirm logistical arrangements, including dry run	4
Decide who will moderate the plenary and confirm their availability	3
ADB Seminars	
Establish host country seminars' focal point	11
Provide feedback on draft ADB seminar list and propose moderators and speakers from host country	9
Discuss initial logistical requirements	9
Provide logistical requirements and local staff required for seminar series	5
Confirm logistical arrangements for all seminars including requirements for live streaming of key official events as well as videos and promotional materials of sponsors/partners on display screens	4

Sponsored Seminar Program	
Host country shortlists vendors for catering, stage/lighting, technical equipment, shipping, and identifies proposed space	9
Seminar sponsors coordinate directly with selected vendors on requirements	5
Host Country Events	
Share and consult ADB on draft program of events, including speakers and moderators	9
Provide ADB with an executive summary of the program and list of moderators and speakers	4
Networking Events Program	
Identify possible locations for ADB and host country networking events	11
Discuss schedules and procedures for organizing networking events	11
Advise ADB of proposals for government-hosted official networking events, and arrange site visits	7
Advise ADB of any tours program, and post information on website	7
Provide list of names of host country VIPs	4
Provide detailed protocol scenarios and information on transport for VIPs at host country networking events	4
Prepare invitations to host country events and send by email (if any)	2





CHAPTER 3

MISSIONS



Overview

Preparatory meetings and ADB missions held between the HOC and ADB during the pre-production phase of the annual meeting, and clear delineation of roles and responsibilities for these meetings and missions, are crucial for a successful annual meeting.

Progress Meetings

Regular (monthly, twice-monthly, or weekly) progress meetings between the HOC and ADB are critical to ensure all tasks are carried out within their allocated time frame. The purpose of progress meetings is to ensure that all parties are aware of key actions and responsibilities for the coming week(s). The meetings should be driven by clear agendas, normally prepared by the HOC and circulated to all participants and relevant stakeholders in advance of the meeting. It is expected that a scribe will be nominated by the host country to provide a summary of the meeting and action points to be circulated as soon as possible after the meeting.

Host Country Organizing Committee Meetings

Where meetings are held with multiple stakeholders from the host country, PCO, government, sponsors, ADB, and other parties, it is expected that the HOC will set a clear agenda for the meeting with expected outcomes included. The HOC is expected to prepare detailed minutes of the meeting in English and disseminate to all parties as soon as possible after the meeting with actions, deliverables, and roles and responsibilities incorporated. This is to achieve discipline and structure for these occasions. The host country is responsible for any translation of meeting documents into the local language, if required.

ADB Missions

Missions by ADB to the host country are critical to assess progress and act as required to ensure activities are on track. They are an opportunity for knowledge sharing and in-depth project planning with a focus on specific annual meeting-related topic areas. At the conclusion of a mission, all stakeholders should be clear as to what needs to be done by whom and by when.

Each time an ADB mission visits the host country, the HOC is expected to

- provide mission clearance for the ADB team and facilitate visa processing;
- provide transport from and to the airport, and within the city if venue visits are planned;
- recommend a hotel;
- provide meeting rooms;
- provide an interpreter (if required); and
- set up meetings with different counterparts and stakeholders in accordance with the pre-mission plans.

The minimum number of ADB missions to the host country is three, and more (consultation missions) may be organized as necessary. In addition, ADB encourages the host country to send a team to a previous annual meeting to observe how it is implemented, and to visit ADB headquarters.



Consultation mission in Tbilisi Georgia with the ADB Secretary Muhammad Ehsan Khan and Lasha Khutsishvili, Minister of Finance of Georgia and Governor for Georgia in ADB.



Technical mission of the annual meeting team in Tbilisi, Georgia.

The usual missions are as follows:

Fact-finding mission. About 3 years in advance, a prospective host country informs ADB of its wish to host an annual meeting, indicating its preferred year. The dates of the meeting are subsequently decided by the Board of Governors based on a report and draft resolution prepared by the Board of Directors.



The Office of the Secretary consults the Board Director concerned and prospective host country authorities on the timing for the fact-finding mission. The mission usually lasts about 3 days and is attended by the ADB Secretary and ADB annual meeting coordinator. After the mission, the Secretary discusses the findings with ADB management and provides feedback about the host country. The decision on the venue will be made by the host country, in consultation with ADB.

The objectives of the fact-finding mission are to

- meet with key host country authorities;
- assess venues;
- secure agreement in principle from the host country on a cost-sharing agreement before the formal acceptance of an invitation;
- obtain preliminary information on the proposed facilities and hotels to be used by the participants;
- undertake preliminary consultations with counterparts who will have direct responsibility for preparations; and
- review the suitability of transport, communications and infrastructure, and possible networking event venues.

Establishment mission. ADB consults host country authorities on the appropriate timing for the establishment mission, which is usually the year before the annual meeting. This mission can only take place once the MOU has been signed. The mission usually lasts about 5 days and is attended by the ADB annual meeting coordinator and team, with the information technology (IT) and technical production focal. If an ADB resident mission office is in the host country, one staff member from the office may be included.

A detailed program is drawn up by the host country in close consultation with ADB. The mission may be followed up by subsequent consultation missions by the ADB teams, depending on the progress of preparations.

The objectives of the establishment mission are to establish contacts and discuss detailed arrangements for the annual meeting. These discussions will cover hotel requirements, IT and technical requirements, local staff, media and outreach activities, media partnerships, branding, networking events, official events, printing, security, shipping, sponsorship and promotion, tax exemption, venue and space allocation, and visas.

Technical mission. A technical mission, comprising ADB staff from the annual meeting core team as well as focals from communications, security, health, the civil society program, and seminars program, is usually scheduled 4 months before the meeting, and lasts 3–5 days. ADB sends in advance a checklist of items for discussion and places to visit so that the host country can draw up a program and ensure that all relevant counterparts are available. This mission is critical for making any final adjustments required in the weeks before the annual meeting.

The objectives of the technical mission are to

- finalize logistical and protocol arrangements for the annual meeting;
- discuss technical issues and conduct tests and rehearsals where possible, including for telecommunications, equipment, and other logistics;
- discuss seminars and events, registration, security, CSO matters, media, outreach activities, and branding; and
- finalize arrangements for the ADB President's visit to the host country, if planned after the technical mission.

ADB President's visit to meeting venues. The timing for this visit is usually about 3–6 months before the annual meeting. It usually comprises the ADB President, the Secretary, the ADB Board Director representing the host country, the director general covering the country, the country director, and the ADB annual meeting coordinator.



ADB President Masato Kanda registers for the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors and inspects some of the facilities in Milan, Italy, where the event was held from 4 to 7 May 2025.

The host country prepares a program of activities for the mission in consultation with ADB. The duration of the mission is 2–3 days, depending on the number of meetings with government officials scheduled and other activities, such as visits to project sites; outreach activities, including talks with commercial organizations, think tanks, or universities; and press conference and media interviews. If possible, arrangements are made for the ADB President to meet with the host country head of state, especially if they will be the GOH at the opening session, or with a minister of the host country.

Prospective host country observation team. ADB recommends that the host country, for the next annual meeting, send their team to the annual meeting the year before their event to observe all arrangements as well as to meet the present host country secretariat and ADB team. The prospective host country has a booth display at the meeting and may bring small gifts produced by their country as well as brochures for participants to take home. This serves to advertise the venue and encourages participants to attend the following year.



Host country officials' visit to ADB headquarters. This visit of 3–5 days usually takes place 3 months before the annual meeting. It is desirable if the Chair of the Board of Governors can also visit ADB to meet the ADB President and Board of Directors. ADB recommends that the host country allocates a budget for this visit (ADB missions to the host country are budgeted for by ADB).

ADB prepares a program for the mission to discuss the status of preparations with key ADB annual meeting unit supervisors and staff. The mission gives the host country the opportunity to learn more about ADB and its operations, and to meet most of the ADB staff members involved in annual meeting preparations. Discussions during this mission focus on finalization of any pending preparatory issues.

Advance arrival of ADB Secretariat before the event. Two to 3 weeks prior to the annual meeting, a number of ADB Secretariat staff arrive in the host country to finalize all outstanding preparations and ensure that all logistical and operational arrangements are in place for the successful delivery of the event.

Timeline of Tasks Related to Missions and Meetings

Task	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
Arrange and host ADB initial assessment mission	Upon receipt of offer
Send observer team to previous/current annual meeting	Month of the annual meeting
Identify missions required throughout pre-production and schedule with all involved	12
Set up progress meetings with ADB and HOC	As needed
Host country to establish HOC and any subcommittees	12
Arrange and host ADB establishment mission	12
Arrange and host ADB President's visit to host city	7
Arrange and host ADB technical mission to host city	4
Host country to visit ADB	5-3
Advance arrival of ADB Secretariat before the event	Month of the annual meeting
Host country provides feedback to ADB on experience hosting annual meeting and provides a final post-event report	Annual meeting month



CHAPTER 4

SPACE REQUIREMENTS

Overview

The host country provides sufficient space for all offices and meeting rooms required for the annual meeting in addition to storage, services, and facilities. These spaces should be close to the main venue—ideally, in the same building—to minimize cabling and walking time. If required, the host country provides shuttles between buildings. All offices and areas should have sound-insulated partitions, be appropriately finished and carpeted, and have adequate lighting, electrical, and air-conditioning (or heating) systems.

The host country appoints a draftsman or architect to prepare the venue plans and layouts for constructing or setting up the offices and meeting rooms as needed. The architect should advise if the required setups in different meeting rooms will fit in the assigned rooms.

The host country, in consultation with the ADB Secretariat, should develop a timeline for hotels/venues under construction or renovation. These should be ready by at least 3 months prior to the meeting. If a venue/hotel is under construction, a backup plan must be in place. During the establishment mission, a decision on whether a hotel/venue can be used for the annual meeting is made. If the host country/owner cannot commit at that time to complete by November of the year before the annual meeting, the backup plan will come into effect.

Meeting Rooms

All meeting rooms should be ready for occupancy with furniture, equipment, and all other requirements, from the day registration opens to the evening of the last day of the meeting. The ADB Secretariat should be able to access the rooms to be set up one day before the opening of the offices.



The Piazza Italia at the Allianz MiCo (Milano Convention Centre) at the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.



Offices

Temporary offices are established in the meeting venues for the Chair of the Board of Governors and ADB offices, i.e., President's office, Board of Directors, Management offices, ADB Secretariat, and seminars team.

Offices of the Host Country Secretariat

The host country secretariat also sets up offices located at or near the meeting venues. Their size, furnishings, and exact location are left to the discretion of the host country. The host country may share offices with the ADB Secretariat to facilitate coordination.



Meeting venue at the Allianz MiCo (Milano Convention Centre) in Milan, Italy.

Refreshment Stations

Offices and meeting rooms should be equipped with facilities to serve coffee, tea, chilled mineral water, and snacks. Two waiters should serve at each refreshment station. A food pantry is ideal but not required for the office of the ADB President.

Media Center

The Media Center should ideally be located within the main meeting venue and must have a minimum floor area of 1,000 m². It should be fully equipped with proper cabling, and all equipment must be installed and tested prior to handover to the ADB DOCK team, which takes place 3 days before the start of on-site registration. The Media Center opens on the same day as registration. Its operating hours are from 8:00 a.m. to 7:00 p.m. until the last day of the annual meeting.



Media Center at the Allianz MiCo (Milano Convention Center) in Milan, Italy.



Media Center at the Republic in Tbilisi, Georgia.

The Media Center consists of

- a main working area for journalists, with 150 chairs;
- a DOCK staff working area, located at the far end of the Media Center, enclosed in partitions with glass windows and with a lockable door;
- a DOCK management room, consisting of office(s) for the principal director and director;
- soundproof booths for news agencies and ADB's media partners within the Media Center offered on a first-come, first-served basis;
- a multimedia room, dedicated to the DOCK multimedia team, with a lockable door with key;
- a media interview room, soundproofed and suited to small briefings and one-on-one interviews by print journalists, and with a banner or designated backdrop on the wall;
- a media briefing room, soundproofed and suited to large media briefings organized by DOCK, with space for six TV crew members and appropriate lighting for video coverage, and space for a simultaneous interpreter if required;
- a TV studio, fully equipped and soundproof for live broadcast interviews, away from high-traffic areas, e.g. bathrooms, break rooms, buffet areas;
- a newspaper and magazine stand with partner publications, including newspapers, and niche finance and economics magazines with articles about ADB;
- an ADB corporate booth to increase awareness of ADB's mission, strategic agenda, activities, and publications, with its size and shape determined by the space made available; it will need a minimum of 30 m², preferably with no walls, at a high-traffic location;
- a media broadcast area for broadcast media interviews, located in a high-traffic area, possibly around the seminar rooms; and
- an internet protocol television (IPTV) room to manage the content of IPTV screens, centrally located near the seminar rooms or secretariat room.

Civil Society Center

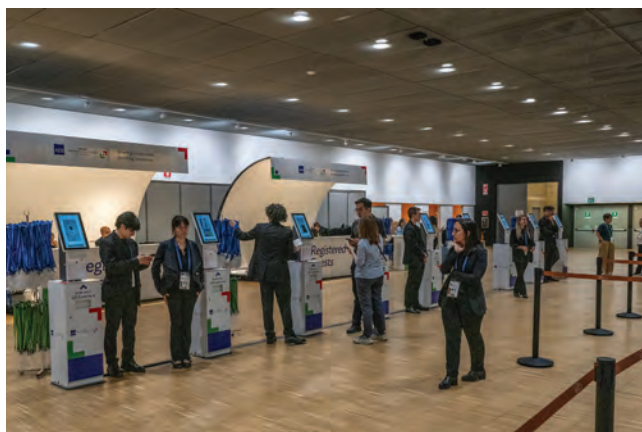
The Civil Society Center should be located within the main meeting venue, close to the seminar area. It consists of

- two enclosed meeting rooms for 20 participants;
- CSOs' lounge with desk working space for 50 chairs, with a printing area;
- refreshment table in the center, regularly replenished with coffee, tea, chilled mineral water, and snacks; and
- a lockable office for ADB staff, which must accommodate a minimum of five people.

Registration Center

Located inside or near the meeting venue, the exact site should be determined in consultation with ADB and the host country. The Registration Center should have an information desk that can assist participants with administrative and logistical queries.





Volunteers welcome delegates to the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.



Delegates convene in Tbilisi, Georgia, for the 57th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors.

Next Annual Meeting Promotional Area

This area is provided to enable the following year's annual meeting host country team to distribute materials and information about the next meeting. The area consists of a promotional booth, with the specific requirements confirmed with the users, and an office, either near the booth or the Board of Directors' offices, whichever is most convenient.

Multi Agency Command Center

Located inside or near the meeting venue, the Multi Agency Command Center (MACC) is used by government agencies and ADB security coordinators to monitor and respond to any local emergency or disaster.



Uzbekistan as the next host country booth display.

Association of Former Employees of ADB Office

Located inside or near the meeting venue, this office is allocated to the President of the Association of Former Employees of ADB (AFE-ADB). The AFE-ADB organizes several side events during the annual meeting, including their coordinators' meeting, general assembly, and a cocktail reception.

Timeline of Tasks Related to Space Requirements

Task	No. of Months Before the Annual Meeting
Offices	
Ensure that sufficient offices with adequate soundproofing will be available	11
In consultation with ADB, prepare plans and layouts of ADB offices as required	11
Provide offices to advance teams (i.e., secretariat, registration, media teams)	1
Ensure ADB offices are furnished and equipped following requirements	Month of annual meeting
Open all other ADB offices	Month of annual meeting
Site Inspection and Space Allocation	
Agree on overall allocation of meeting and office rooms	11
Submit proposed layouts and plans of ADB offices and meeting areas	9
Agree with ADB on final space allocation and layouts	8
Submit final floor plans for reproduction	5
Agree on turnaround time for meeting and seminar rooms	3
Agree on exact setup and dismantling dates	3
Appoint space managers to oversee each venue where meetings and events will take place	3
Ensure that all meeting spaces are set up according to requirements 1 hour before the meeting or event for checking	Month of annual meeting





CHAPTER 5

PROCUREMENT



Overview

The host country appoints event-specific partners and third-party suppliers to ensure a successful annual meeting. It is important they complete required processes, following relevant guidelines of the host country and ADB, before being awarded and appointed to do the work within the expected time frames provided by ADB. Relevant sustainability provisions must be included in contracts.

Procurement

The procurement process should commence early to follow the host country's procurement procedures, with allowance for delays. Once suppliers and service providers have been selected, they will need time to discuss exact requirements with ADB and the host country, which are usually agreed upon 6 months before the annual meeting. Final discussions, including exact selection of models (equipment), menus (catering), and designs (uniforms) should take place during ADB's technical mission 4 months before the meeting.

Main Providers

Host country. Major contracts include

- PCO (if the HOC decides to appoint one, selected at least 18 months before the annual meeting);
- transport;
- tours (if any);
- construction of offices (if required);
- furniture (if required);
- catering (at the meeting venue and any offsite events organized by the host country);
- local staff;
- computers and other IT equipment;
- photocopiers;
- cables for computers;
- audiovisual provider of LCD screens, video walls, sound systems, and microphones; and
- large and small format printing.

ADB. Providers are required for

- catering (for any events organized by ADB), and
- large and small format printing (for ADB photo exhibit and brochures).

ADB may use the same provider as the host country to simplify coordination on-site. ADB prefers to use suppliers with policies and established practices on sustainability, waste management, equal opportunity, and people with disabilities. This will be considered during the supplier selection process.

To ensure that suppliers, service providers, and sponsors are bound by the terms and conditions of their contracts and service level agreements, insurance should be added.

The host country shall ensure that deadlines for procurement set by ADB are strictly followed. Monopolistic practices such as inflating prices by vendors and suppliers at venues, hotels, and other locations, which may cause reputational risks to the host country and ADB, shall be penalized through temporary suspension and debarment from participating in any ADB-related activities in the future.

ADB and the host country shall follow these guidelines on sustainable procurement:

- Deal with credible suppliers who respect sustainability.
- Maintain a good and mutually beneficial relationship with suppliers.
- Coordinate supplier development activities on events sustainability awareness and provide practical tools for capacity development.
- Collaborate on the risk assessment for holding the annual meeting.
- Consider suppliers that take into account labor and environmental factors such as the conditions under which their employees work and the environmental impact arising from their operations.
- Use local materials, produce, and labor.
- Reduce, reuse, and recycle waste.
- Maintain transparency on all event-related planning activities through meetings and frequent information exchange.

Timeline of Tasks Related to Procurement

Task	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
ADB and host country meet with possible suppliers to discuss requirements, including sustainability requirements	10
ADB and host country start their procurement process	9
Host country/ADB finalize selection of their suppliers	6
ADB and host country send detailed information to suppliers	6
ADB and host country meet with suppliers to discuss details and test and select items as necessary	4
Host country/ADB finalize arrangements for suppliers and providers	1
Host country/ADB check that all services and products are provided as required	Month of the annual meeting



CHAPTER 6

INFORMATION AND CONFERENCE TECHNOLOGY



Overview

Precise technical needs are required at the annual meeting for IT and production technology, audiovisual equipment and systems, and necessary staffing requirements.

This chapter is written in language that experts in this area will comprehend. It is recommended that this be handed directly to the IT/audiovisual technical planning team and relevant partners appointed by the host country as a briefing document to ensure clarity in terms of ADB expectations of host country deliverables. This chapter should also be read alongside Chapter 16: Meeting Setups for more detailed information on event arrangements.

ADB will provide IT and technical production consultants to support and brief host-appointed partners as needed. The host is expected to assign a fluent English-speaking technical director or production manager as the main point of contact.

Information Technology: Computers, Internet Connectivity, Printers, and Network

The host country is required to supply the equipment and cabling as outlined below. It also must provide service personnel and technicians to be on duty at the meeting venues 2 days before the annual meeting begins until the last day (6 days total) and attend to technical issues.

Computers and IT. Technical descriptions of equipment and software requirements, including computers (i.e., computer hard drives and monitors) and printers are shown in the list below.

- Equipment in offices and meeting venues must meet ADB specifications, including QWERTY keyboards and high-speed internet.
- Devices must be less than 3 years old and wiped before and after use (e.g., using DBAN).

- Host country provides computers for ADB offices, seminar/meeting rooms, and the internet center.
- A LAN setup must be available 24/7. ADB operates its own VLAN with access to network printers, while Wi-Fi and public areas use separate networks without access to the ADB VLAN.

Internet connectivity. The host country is to provide uninterrupted internet connectivity for the entire duration of the annual meeting. It should be tested at least a week before the meeting. The following covers requirements.

- Primary dedicated internet bandwidth of at least 1.5 Gigabit per second (Gbps).
 - Backup dedicated internet bandwidth of at least 1Gbp.
 - Sufficient wired and wireless network coverage to all annual meeting venues, offices, and rooms.
 - Quality of service (QoS) capability to prioritize traffic such as media streaming and uploading as needed, at least 350 megabits per second (Mbps) dedicated.
 - Logical controls such as web content filtering, firewall, and device isolation.
- The host country is to provide internet connectivity for the ADB advance team, which usually arrives 2 weeks before the annual meeting.
- Note that there are several high-density Wi-Fi usage areas during the annual meeting. These areas should be adequately sized. These areas/sessions include but are not limited to the Media Center, Civil Society Center, seminar rooms, opening session, business session, and public spaces, including networking areas.
- Internet should be accessed through a security filtering device (e.g., Bluecoat, Checkpoint) or service (e.g., OpenDNS, Zscaler) that is able to do, at minimum, URL filtering and malware scanning.
- A total of 75 USB-C to LAN adapters should be provided to ADB offices.

Client laptops and other accessories. Requirements for laptops and accessories are as follows:

- Processor: Minimum Intel Core i5 processors with 8 GB RAM
- Hard disk: At least 100 GB disk, active partition should be no bigger than 100 GB (to facilitate fast wiping of data)
- Operating system: Windows 10 64-bit with System or above, and display language in English with latest Service Pack and latest patches installed before being deployed
- Integrated Wi-Fi interface
- Support HDMI display output
- Microsoft Office 2021 ProPlus or above
- Adobe Acrobat reader latest version
- Microsoft Edge and Chrome latest version
- Updated virus protection software
- Drivers for provided printers
- USB 3.0 port with at least two available for computers in Registration Center
- Asian font pre-installed
- Other devices and accessories:
 - Keyboard (QWERTY)
 - Mouse
 - Power strip
 - Cable lock
 - Monitor (at least 22 inches, required only for select ADB offices)





Printing and photocopying services. Requirements for printing and photocopying services are as follows:

- Workgroup multifunction printer:
 - Laser-type colored printer
 - Minimum 25 pages per minute
 - A3/legal, A4/Letter paper supply (ADB will typically bring Letter paper supply)
 - With the following capabilities:
 - » Photocopying
 - » Scan into PDF via SMTP
 - » Multipage feeder
 - » Cassette capacity of at least one ream paper
 - Consumables (toner, ink, cartridges) available on-site
- Volume multifunction printer:
 - Laser-type colored printer
 - Minimum 35 pages per minute
 - Finishing set (collating, stapling for the Office of the President)
 - A3/legal, A4/Letter paper supply (ADB will typically bring Letter paper supply)
 - With the following capabilities:
 - » Photocopying
 - » Scan into PDF via SMTP
 - » Multipage feeder
 - » Cassette capacity of at least one ream paper
 - Consumables (toner, ink, cartridges) available on-site
 - Volume multifunction printers are typically required for the Office of the President, ADB Secretariat Office, Registration Center, and Media Center.
- Paper shredder

Upper-End Estimation of Information Technology Equipment Required per Office	
Office	IT Equipment
Office of the President	3 desk phones, 4 monitors, 1 USB keyboard, 2 volume multifunction printers, 1 workgroup printer
Office of the Secretary	1 workgroup printer, 2 monitors
ADB Secretariat Office	2 volume multifunction printers, 1 monitor
Board of Directors offices (12)	Per office: 1 monitor, 1 volume multifunction printer
Vice-Presidents, offices (7 in total)	Per office: 1 monitor
Vice-Presidents' staff area	2 workgroup printers
Heads of Department open working space	4 monitors, 2 workgroup printers
Future host country office	1 workgroup printer
Civil Society Center	1 workgroup printer, 1 laptop
Seminar Coordination Office	1 workgroup printer
Registration Center	2 workgroup printers, 5 monitors
Media Center	2 workgroup printers, 1 laptop

Registration Center. Requirements are as follows:

- 12 laptop computers—same minimal specifications for client workstations. All units have at least 2 available USB 3.0 ports
- Internet access
- 2 workgroup printers
- 8 webcams (ADB to provide)
- 7 units ID card printer (ADB to provide)
- Extra power board for each computer in the Registration Center (to be able to connect other devices)
- Adapters (if necessary) for US-type power plugs

Seminar rooms. Requirements are as follows:

- 1 laptop at each room (for Pigeonhole Live). Note that all audiovisual production laptops should be included and provided by the audiovisual supplier and have a separate quantity requirement.
- Power outlet and adapter.
- The seminar coordinator's office will need access to power and a LAN cable with at least 50 Mbps guaranteed bandwidth if not dedicated to enable upload of video-on-demand files.

Information security. It is highly recommended that internet access be provided by transparent proxy servers with the firewall blocking all outgoing internet traffic other than the proxy. The proxy must support protocol validation. The following IT security measures will apply:

- Wireless network Service Set Identifier (SSID) reserved for ADB office use should be secured with WPA2 or above with strong password agreed by ADB.
- Windows firewall is activated with “Don't allow exception” checked by default on every workstation.
- Kiosk PCs offered to participants, if any, are on a segregated LAN with only access to the internet.
- Connectivity between devices on the guest LAN (wired and wireless) should be restricted.
- At the end of the meeting and upon direction of the ADB IT specialist, all workstations are sanitized with a disk wiper utility (freeware DBAN is acceptable). All workstations have at least one pass.
- All printers in the ADB offices should be in the ADB network only and cannot be accessed by guest network.

Videoconferencing equipment. Videoconferencing facilities supporting cloud-based videoconferencing technology (e.g., Microsoft Teams, Zoom, WebEx) should be available in at least one meeting room assigned to ADB.

Media Center. The Media Center is managed by DOCK. These are basic requirements for the Media Center to allow for a conducive work environment for media delegates:

- Low-sound or noise levels, as the Media Center is an office environment, where delegates generally write and work
- Consistent, comfortable temperature
- Adequate bandwidth to be able to upload articles, photos, and videos
- Access to personnel who can mitigate any facility concerns





Within the Media Center, the specific areas that require IT support are as follows:

ADB staff area • 1 unit workgroup printer • 1 lamp per person and access to power	Media briefing room • Audiovisual equipment, including screens • Several microphones • Studio area • LAN access • Power supply	Host country media representative office • LAN access • Power supply
ADB staff meeting room • Power access	Multimedia room • Power supply • Access to a LAN cable with at least 50 Mbps guaranteed bandwidth if not dedicated	Journalists' area • Power in every table • Desk lamps for every seat • 1 workgroup printer connected to a laptop • Audio equipment for making general announcements

Live broadcast media interview areas. Live broadcast media interviews are held in a high-traffic area, preferably near the seminar rooms. Requirements are a hard-wired uncontended/dedicated broadband LAN with ethernet connection box and a minimum speed of 50 Mbps. LAN must have direct access to the internet, or if firewalled, open for UDP and TCP traffic on specified ports (ports to be specified closer to the annual meeting).

Cabling. The annual meeting network comprises optical fiber, Cat6 or Cat5e cables, panels, and cords. Switches operate at a minimum of 100 Mbps full duplex mode. The host country is expected to provide all cabling and networking in the offices, centers, and meeting venues at least 1 week before the annual meeting.

Power. All IT equipment, e.g., workstations, servers, switches, is on an uninterrupted power supply. One electric plug of international standard, supporting at least US-type plug, should be provided and tested for each ADB staff desk or agreed occupancy level. Electric plugs of international standard should also be available in the meeting room offices (at conference tables).

User support during the meeting. Relevant support personnel specified in this section should be available from 7:00 a.m to 7:00 p.m. for the entire duration of the annual meeting, including while the ADB advance team works on-site (i.e., 2 weeks before the first preparation day for the meeting). Emergency contact should be made available around the clock for this period as well.



Interview area for media at the Annual Meeting in Milan, Italy.

All IT incident requests are received by a field technician with a unique phone number or convenient communications channel. Field technicians must be proficient in Windows, Microsoft Office, printers, mobile devices, and general network and videoconferencing troubleshooting. One field technician is permanently assigned to the Media Center, at least two field technicians are assigned to support Wi-Fi and LAN networks, and at least one field technician is assigned to support printers.

Technicians should also be proficient in the setup and architecture of the annual meeting networks as well as the networking equipment in use (Switch; Firewall: VLAN, QoS; filtering/proxy devices).

Break-and-fix technicians are also available on-site to address any hardware failures encountered by attendees. Common spare parts and adaptors should be available on-site.

Website

The annual meeting website is hosted on www.adb.org. To ensure consistency, security, and cost-efficiency, the host country should provide content rather than create a separate site. Further guidelines are as follows:

- Content, in English and optionally in the local language, must be reviewed by ADB's Office of the Secretary and uploaded by DOCK's web team, following the agreed content plan.
- The minimum launch content comprises a country overview and information about currency, weather, transport, cuisine, recommended hotels, and visas.
- Additional content, from 7 months before the meeting, includes further hotel and transport details, tours (with registration forms), and details of the full annual meeting program with schedule and speaker information.
- No ADB-related sites may collect sensitive personal data (e.g., passport or credit card info) without prior agreement with ADB.
- The site must be securely designed, tested, and monitored for potential security breaches.

Live Webcast and Broadcast of Events

Arrangements need to be in place for the live webcasts and broadcasts of certain events, including the opening session, business session, and Governors' seminar. The host country is responsible for the live webcast and broadcast of events, and tests for the live webcasts (video and audio) should be arranged with ADB staff 2–5 months prior to the meeting.

The master control room requires access to power and a VLAN with public IP with at least 2 x 20 Mbps lines of guaranteed bandwidth over two internet service providers.





Timeline of Tasks Related to Information and Conference Technology

Task	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
Technical Requirements	
Host country appoints an audiovisual production supplier and briefs them on all requirements	12
Ensure the audiovisual production supplier has the capability to provide all infrastructure across the project, e.g., simultaneous interpretation booths, media, and webcasting equipment. If not, alternative partners should be appointed at this stage.	12
Identify if additional internet/download speed needs to be added to the existing infrastructure of the selected venues	11
Discuss all the wiring, equipment, and webcasting requirements with the ADB technical director and ensure clear lines of communication are established between the appointed suppliers and the technical director	11
Start planning for the technical mission held 4 months before the meeting	8
Test wiring and equipment required	4
Provide all the wiring and webcasting equipment needed to meet requirements	1
Identify where wireless two-way radios are required and how many across all locations are required, and brief ADB IT and conference technology team as to the supply of these on-site	1
Install all audiovisual screens and seminar equipment (2 days before use)	1
Website	
Designate a focal point for the website who will liaise with DOCK's web team	18
Discuss design of website and updating procedure	17
Launch website with basic information	On last day of previous annual meeting
Link host country tourist websites to annual meeting website	12
Post detailed information on hotel and transport details, tours, and full program with schedule and speaker information on website	7
ADB launches mobile app	1

Telecommunications

To facilitate communication at the meeting site among members of the ADB and host country secretariats, the host country provides 60 physical SIM cards and three desk phones for ADB personnel. International direct dial (IDD) facilities are required for the SIM cards and phones. Cellular calls, SMS, data, and IDD services can be provided to all ADB devices in a pooled manner. The recommended allowable is as follows:

- Local call minutes within calling circle: Unlimited
- Local call minutes outside of calling circle: 3,600 minutes
- SMS messages: Unlimited
- Local cellular data: 1 terabyte
- IDD call minutes: 3,600 minutes

Audiovisual and Technical Systems

This section details the technical requirements further to assist the HOC in its procurement process in contracting suitable vendors for the supply of such systems as audiovisual, sound, lighting, camera and recording, IPTV screens, simultaneous interpretation, and conference microphone systems.

The host country must supply all required equipment, cabling, and qualified technical staff—including engineers, operators, and service personnel—to test and support systems throughout the meetings.

It is imperative that all meetings have dedicated technical operators. They should also be assigned to the same meeting room throughout the full duration of the meeting to enable ADB staff to be familiar with the same person for the period. Audio operators/engineers should be proficient in handling multiple microphone setups, especially in panel sessions where multiple lavalier/lapel microphones are used.

The following details will require a thorough review at the earliest convenience by the HOC and their appointed vendors, together with ADB, as the needs of the annual meeting will require adaptation each year. The host country may supply additional equipment to enhance the standard equipment if it wishes. While requirements are not fixed, this section is a good reference document for third party vendors during procurement. Quantities are not fixed and will need review according to meeting setups and chosen meeting spaces for each annual meeting.

While the annual meeting technical requirements are mostly fixed, the host country should provide a stock of contingency audiovisual equipment for small changes in specifications or additional meetings that may be called for from time to time. It is important that the eventual technical providers are contracted to carry a suitable stock of contingency spares that can be deployed at short notice with no additional charges. Where possible, ADB will endeavor to advise the host country of potential changes in advance, but a reasonable amount of spare stock should always be provided.

The host must also provide scaled floor plans for all venues, subject to review by ADB.

Audiovisual Systems

All support audiovisual systems provided by the host country's vendors should be provided by a reputable rental company with experience in providing similar services to international events. The company should also provide a suitable-sized team of qualified and experienced conference engineers and technicians to run and manage the systems. It is an advantage if the rental company has worked in the venue spaces before and has a preferred supplier relationship with the selected convention center/venue to ensure there is compatibility with in-house equipment where required.



Scene from the Governors' Business Session of the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.



All audiovisual, sound, and lighting systems should be known international brands with a known reputation in the rental market.

Audiovisual display systems. Large meeting rooms (i.e., for the opening session, business session, Governors' seminar) and any other rooms requiring camera images to be shown on screen should be provisioned with high-brightness professional digital light processing technology projectors for best viewing and color detail.

Large-format LED screen solutions are an alternative and also provide a digital backdrop that can be changed between different sessions or meeting setups, adding to sustainability if the venue spaces are limited or if rooms are required for other purposes. LED pixel spacing should be a minimum of 3.9 mm (P3), though preferably less, and must be high-grade, batch-matched tiles with no flaws or dead pixels.

Smaller meetings for PowerPoint-only presentations may use LCD or digital light processing projector technology, provided that the light output of the projector is sufficient to display clearly within the ambient lighting conditions of the room.

Seamless switchers. For any room that requires source switching to the projection system, a seamless graphics switcher(s) should be provided with adequate preview monitors and signal distribution at the technician's control desk (console).

For the business session, a seamless switching system with multiple destinations should be provided to allow for lower third titles and the display of the ADB speaking timer graphics, which are to be displayed on different screens.

Source laptops. For the opening session, business session, Governors' seminar, and ADB seminars, enough laptops—PCs or MacBooks—should be provided at the console for Main, Backup, Title, Speaking Timer, and Holding Graphics source machines for presentations. (Title and speaking timer are only required for the business session).

In case there is a need for Video and Media playback, it is recommended that professional media playback software be provided. Operators should be familiar with format conversion and if any source material is provided in other formats, they should be adept at converting to playback using software.

For all ADB seminars, a dedicated laptop should be provided for the moderator near the stage at one side of the room, or at one end of the production console, for moderation of questions and polling by ADB's Pigeonhole Live interactive question harvesting system.

Laptops should also be provided at the lectern or head table. Where possible, all provided presentation source laptops in meeting rooms should have access to the internet by Wi-Fi or wired LAN connections.

A suitable number of videoconferencing-enabled laptops should be provided in key meeting rooms for high-level events to enable hosting a call and for separate source laptops for pinning participants/speakers.

Signal, resolution, and screen format. All audiovisual signals should meet the highest possible standards. Source laptops should use HDMI outputs, and audiovisual cable runs should follow HDMI, DVI, HDSDI, or NDI standards. For long distances, use optical fiber, HDSDI, CAT5 extenders/converters, or SRT/NDI over a dedicated managed network.

All screens—projectors, flat-screen TVs, and large displays—should be in 16:9 format, with a resolution of 1920 x 1080 (Full HD) wherever possible. Presenters should be informed in advance to prepare slides and videos in 16:9 format to ensure proper screen display.

If wide or non-standard LED screens are used (e.g., for the opening or business sessions), this must be carefully pre-planned and coordinated with the ADB technical team to ensure compatibility with ADB-provided content.

Content media file format. All videos shown at the event should be a minimum of 1280 x 720p, preferably 1920 x 1080p. Files for display on IPTV screens supplied by the host should be optimized accordingly. The host country will convey to ADB at the earliest date possible this technical specification, and ADB will format its video material based on these specifications.



Scene from the ADF Donors Annual Consultation Meeting held on the sidelines of the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.

Sound Systems

All sound systems provided by the host country's vendors should be provided by a reputable sound rental company with experience in providing a service to similar international events. All audio systems should be known international brands with a known reputation in the rental market.

Speaker systems. For larger meetings, if the venue allows for it, audio speaker systems should be flown using a suitable truss rig or independently. For the opening session and Governors' seminar, given the size of the audiences and space required, compact line-array speaker technology may be used. Where wider rooms are used, front-filling speakers should be placed near the stage to allow the front rows to hear clearly.

Monitor speakers should be placed on stage or in front of the head table for any meetings that require Q & A microphones to ensure that the presenters on stage/head table can hear clearly.

For meetings with hollow square, U-shape, and hollow rectangle layouts, care should be taken to provide full-range speaker cabinets as monitors within the hollow area (in the round). This is important to ensure that the amplified sound is in front of the seated delegates and not solely from behind. It also helps to avoid feedback in multi-microphone setups and to assist anyone with hearing difficulties. Where delegates or observers are seated behind those at the tables in these room styles, additional speakers on tripods within the room should be provided to give adequate coverage across the room.

For meetings requiring multiple microphone setups, care should be given to equalizing the system to avoid feedback. As a rule of thumb, no more than two microphones should be live at any one time unless it is a panel discussion.

For smaller meetings, enough full-range speakers on tripods should be provided.



Microphone systems.

- (i) **Radio microphone systems.** When supplying wireless microphones, care should be taken to control the frequencies of the systems. As there are multiple rooms and large numbers of microphones being issued and running concurrently throughout the venues, there should not be any interference between meetings. The audio vendor must supply technical staff to scan and monitor frequencies of their own systems as well as external systems that may be transmitting within the venue or general area. Similarly, the host country should convey to ADB at its earliest convenience what allowable frequencies can be used, so that attending media can be guided accordingly. Rooms requiring multiple wireless microphones should all be set to different frequencies to avoid any confusion. It is advisable for the audio vendor to draw up a spreadsheet to ensure that all wireless channels are accounted for and that it is checked with a suitable scanner to avoid signal overlap from external systems.
- (ii) **Conference microphone systems.** Conference microphone or discussion systems should be of the wired type and, where possible, be supplied with microphone control software. Wireless discussion microphones are not recommended due to concerns with security and reliability. All conference microphones must be supplied with suitable pop shields. Conference microphones should be of a well-known and reputable brand and may need to be rented from a specialized international company with experience in large multiple microphone setups.



Delegates exchange views and discuss matters of interest at the seminar Navigating the Digital Leap – Reimagining Work for Sustainable Prosperity, held on the sidelines of the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.



Scene from the ADF Donors Annual Consultation Meeting held on the sidelines of the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.

- (iii) **Speaking time control.** For the business session, ADB provides speaking time control equipment to enable speeches to be limited to a set time under strict control of the Chair of the meeting. The status of the time is shown with colored indicators: green, yellow, and red. Green indicates that the prescribed 5 minutes of speaking time is available to the delegate. Yellow indicates the 1-minute grace period to enable the delegate speaking to conclude their statement appropriately. Red indicates that the delegate has exceeded the speaking time. The Chair, who is able to monitor each delegate speaking, may interrupt a delegate who exceeds the 6-minute total speaking period.

A video interface module is provided by ADB so that the timing indicators can be luma keyed using an appropriate video mixer/switcher onto the floor mounted flat-screen foldback or digital signage and messaging display units by use of a suitable vision mixer. The technical vendor must provide one Windows-enabled laptop and video mixer to enable the use of this requirement.

The preferred location for the technical staff to control the timing system is on the floor, within sight of the Chair/Secretary, with table and chairs for at least 3-4 persons from the Secretariat. It is expected that the delegate's speaking time is uninterrupted by any other delegate. However, the Chair can interrupt. The speaking time of the delegate counts down from the assigned number of minutes. If the Chair interrupts, the speaking time clock will be paused, and continues counting down the moment the delegate continues to talk. If interrupted by another delegate, the speaking time clock will be reset to the original number of minutes assigned to the speaker (i.e., the discussion during speaking time control is between the Chair and the individual delegate only).

(iv) **Microphone management.** For the microphone technician who operates the system, the following is a synopsis of meeting proceedings and how the microphones should be used in conjunction with the speaker timer.

- Each delegate/member is assigned their own microphone. The Chair follows the camera images of who is talking on the flat screen located in front of the head table, and how much speaking time remains for the speaker through the speaking time control system.
- The Chair's microphone should have a "priority" feature, which allows them to switch off the microphone of the speaking delegate. There is no speaking time limit for the Chair.
- Only one delegate microphone should be active at any time, unless the Chair decides to override the current speaker. The microphones should be centrally operated by the technician using control software and not switched on or off by individual delegates, except for the Chair, who can override and switch off the current speaker at any time.
- The order of proceedings would follow the format: Chair > Delegate A > Chair > Delegate B > Chair > Delegate C, and so on.
- To enable fast switching of the camera system, the program ID of each microphone should correlate with the remotely controlled pan tilt zoom (PTZ) camera system. A display mimic of the microphone management system's "geographic layout" screen should be given to the camera operator to enable them to switch accordingly.
- All lectern microphones provided should be condenser microphones with 18" goosenecks and supplied as matched pairs.
- All table microphones should be condenser type and provided with suitable pop shields. The 3-head table microphones for the business session should be 18" longer type, if possible, to allow for extra space needed for secretarial and management materials. For the press conference, 13" microphones should be provided.
- All lapel and handheld microphones must be supplied with fresh/recharged batteries at the start of each session. Care should be taken that used batteries are not mixed with fresh batteries and that battery levels are monitored by the console technician/sound engineer.





Lapel microphones should be supplied with suitable pop shields and must be cardioid or super cardioid type. Clips, cables, and belt-packs should all be in good, clean condition.

Audio desk/console. For the opening session, business session, and Governors' seminar, it is recommended that digital audio consoles and suitably trained operators be provided for ease of operation and for better clarity. For smaller meetings, the use of analogue desks is possible if adequate equalization outboard racks are provided.

Lighting Systems

All lighting systems provided by the host country's vendors should be provided by a reputable lighting rental company with experience in providing similar service to international events. The systems should be known international brands with a known reputation in the rental market. Care should be taken to avoid excessive power consumption from unnecessary lighting fixtures where possible. The use of efficient lighting fixtures using LED technology is encouraged.

Each session has lighting requirements as follows:

Opening Session

- Use ample Fresnel and profile/ellipsoidal lights to light the stage, lectern, and event branding.
- Include back- and side-fill lighting to create depth for cameras and broadcasts.
- Provide intelligent lighting (e.g., moving heads or LED fixtures) for stage and cultural performances—used only for theatrical effect under the direction of the host country.
- All lighting must be rigged safely using venue structures or trusses and comply with international safety standards, including the use of certified safety chains.
- Stage lighting must be bright enough for clear visibility and suitable for TV, webcast, and IPTV.
- House lights should be dimmable and ideally linked to the main lighting control system.

Business Session

- Lighting must support effective communication and visibility for all delegations at their desks and allow a clear view of the head table.
- Use venue lighting or supplement with overhead truss lighting as needed.
- Highlight the head table, backdrop, and the front area for the formal gavel handover.
- Avoid excessive heat or glare from lighting that may distract or cause discomfort for speakers and participants.
- Ensure lighting is adequate for broadcast and PTZ cameras, especially for speaker close-ups.
- House lighting should be sufficient for all participants and observers.

Governors' Seminar

- Use existing venue lighting or additional truss lighting to cover the stage and head table.
- Avoid lighting angles that cause glare or discomfort for speakers.
- Lighting must support clear camera capture for broadcast, webcast, and IPTV.
- Provide appropriate house lighting for the audience and delegates.

Press Conferences and Media Briefings

- Lighting should be broadcast quality to ensure speakers are well lit on camera.
- Provide sufficient lighting for both stage and audience/media areas.

Other Meetings

- For high-level or staged meetings, lighting should enhance visibility, support speaker presentations, and improve photography and video quality.

Simultaneous Interpretation

All simultaneous interpretation systems provided by the host country's vendors should be procured from a reputable rental company with experience in providing a similar service to international events. All simultaneous interpretation systems should be known as international brands in the rental market. Systems may need to be rented from a specialized company with experience in international, multiple-language meetings.

Although English is the working language of ADB, simultaneous interpretation from and into different languages is provided for the following events:

- ADB President's press conferences and select media briefings (2 booths);
- Opening session (5–6 booths);
- Business session (5–6 booths);
- Governors' seminar (up to 5 booths);
- Governors' plenary session (up to 4 booths); and
- One of the seminar rooms for seminars and subregional events requiring interpretation (should always be equipped with 2 booths).

Languages will be confirmed by ADB 3 months prior to the meeting.

The requirements are as follows:

- Simultaneous interpretation facilities for four to six languages, including English as the master language. The simultaneous interpretation system should be infrared. Receivers and audio should be digital to provide for best clarity. Interpreter consoles should be digital and be a known brand and have features and layout used and recognized by international interpreters.
- Four interpreters' booths with channel assignments and a spare booth with interpreters' equipment (total of five booths). There may be a requirement for a sixth booth if the host country has more than one language requirement. Portable interpreter booths supplied must comply with international ISO4043 specifications and be in accordance with International Association of Conference Interpreters (AIIC) guidelines.
- Adequate numbers of simultaneous interpretation headsets for each meeting as required (receivers with headphones). For any head table or stage panel, comfortable single earpiece type earphones should be provided. This will avoid potential feedback issues encountered if the presenter/speaker places their headset around their neck.



- A distribution counter for simultaneous interpretation headsets (receivers with headphones), including stands with signs indicating channel assignments (e.g., Channel 1—English; Channel 2—Chinese; Channel 3—French; Channel 4—Japanese; Channel 5—Russian; Channel 6—others). Channel assignments could also be displayed on projection screens.
- Control booth with digital recording facilities (which must have backup recorders) to record proceedings. In case of speeches delivered in languages other than English, the English interpretation is recorded by a separate recorder. Recordings should be labeled as English and Floor (for other languages). All recordings should be made in MP3 format and distributed either directly to server-based storage, accessible by the ADB Secretariat or via manual delivery on portable USB drives and be clearly labeled both physically and with suitable file naming/folder structure, with reference to the meeting/session name, date, and time.
- It is recommended that daily logs are taken by the rental suppliers and the room coordinator to monitor headset losses (if any). Losses are usually minimal and are often just misplaced or mistakenly removed from the meeting rooms. Housekeeping notes can be displayed at the start of each session to remind delegates not to remove headsets from the meeting rooms. ADB will not be responsible/liable for any losses of headsets and the host country should have clear written agreements in place with the rental vendors accordingly on how to deal with any losses and the costs associated with replacing units.

Coordination

- At the meeting site, ADB helps the interpreters by showing them their assigned interpreter booths and how to use the equipment. A technical briefing and/or rehearsal are usually arranged in advance upon request by the host country technicians. A dedicated simultaneous interpretation technician must always be available.
- During the meeting, ADB attends to the interpreters and ensures that advance copies of statements that they are required to interpret are provided for them.
- ADB coordinates with host country meeting staff in charge of providing simultaneous interpretation headsets and maintaining the channel assignments board located close to the entrance of the meeting room.
- Distribution and collection of headsets is the responsibility of the host country and its appointed vendors. Sufficient support staff should be provided for larger sessions to help avoid losses and assist for fast turnovers between shared meeting venues/rooms.
- For the opening and business sessions, it is recommended that headsets and receivers be distributed from a central point outside or just inside the meeting room, with clear indication of channel assignments.

Video and Audio Recording and Formats

The host country is responsible for making audio and video recordings of all sessions, meetings, and seminars throughout the annual meeting.

Audio recordings. Digital audio recorders are to be provided by the host country to record continuously, but on separate files for each meeting. Due to the large number of files, a dedicated person should be engaged by the host country to oversee this and coordinate with the ADB Secretariat technical team, who will manage the collection process of the files.

Individual meetings must be recorded as separate files and labeled/file named accordingly. A suggested format is <YYMMDD>_<TIME>_<Meeting Name>_<Room>. Audio files should be delivered by the host country to the designated person responsible in the ADB Secretariat. All files must remain under the management of the ADB Secretariat before sharing.

Video recordings. For the opening session, business session, and Governors' seminar, recordings should be taken from the final camera mix. Videos must be in 16:9 HD format, suitable for post-editing, and ideally delivered on a hard disk for direct transfer to editing systems. The file format may vary depending on the camera and recording equipment used, but all files must be of professional quality and compatible with standard non-linear editing systems. To ensure consistency, the same format should be used across all venues whenever possible.

Two sets of recordings are recommended:

- Real-time compressed H.264 files for immediate, web-ready use; and
- Uncompressed master files for post-production editing.

For the seminar program, recordings should be produced for video-on-demand, archival, and documentation purposes. The final list of sessions to be recorded will be confirmed 3 months before the meeting. Recordings should also be in 16:9 HD format, mixed from two operated camera positions, and delivered as web-ready files. Consistent formatting across venues is preferred. Each session should be recorded using both a main and a backup system, capturing real-time H.264 files for quick post-event use. An event-grade production switcher with an integrated streaming codec should be available to enable live web streaming at short notice. Every setup must include a direct internet connection to support streaming. Where space or cost is a concern, compact integrated software/hardware solutions may be used.

For file handling, all video and audio recordings must be handed over only to the designated ADB Secretariat staff member responsible for final distribution.



Delegates exchange views at the Unlocking the Power of Sustainability Disclosure event held on the sidelines of the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.

Live Webcast

Arrangements need to be in place for the live webcasts and broadcast of certain events, including the opening session, business session, Governors' seminar, and other select seminars as advised in advance by ADB.

Arrangements need to be made to test with ADB staff the live webcasts (video and audio) 3 months prior to meeting. The host country will be responsible for the transmission of the live webcast and broadcast of events and provide an adequate fixed IP address on an uncontended line with sufficient bandwidth of at least 20Mb/s. Suitable RTMP IP streaming devices must be provided with HDMI/HDSI input to point toward a URL, to be provided by ADB prior



to the transmission. This will allow for the live webcast streams to be placed on the ADB website. Additionally, a second streaming device/channel must be provisioned to allow for direct Facebook live or other social media channel streaming on request.

The webcasts need to have clear audible English voiceover from the simultaneous interpretation system if the language spoken is not English and to be mixed with ambient mics to capture applause, music playback, and any other stage microphones that will be used for English spoken words in the program. After the webcast, copies of the original program should be made available to ADB within 2 hours of each event to enable editing and uploading on websites. These recordings are to be in a format that can be used as video-on-demand. ADB will accept only .MOV or .MP4 formats.

Where meetings are in multiple languages, the floor language and English interpretation channels should be recorded separately so that video-on-demand can be chosen with the correct audio stream.

Internet Protocol TV and Digital Signage

An IPTV/digital signage system, including content management software, must be installed and connected to flat-screen TV displays throughout the venue. These screens should be placed in key locations including the ADB Secretariat, seminar coordination office, heads of departments and Board offices, Media Center, ADB President's office, and other high-traffic public areas. The screens will broadcast live proceedings from the opening session, business session, Governors' seminar, and other selected seminars. They will also display infographics, digital signage, and video materials from ADB and the host country. ADB will confirm the final screen locations.

The complete IPTV system and network must be fully installed and tested at least 4 days before the official opening of the offices. While the number of screens will depend on the venue, approximately 50 flat-screen displays are typically required. The exact number will be confirmed by ADB during the technical mission.

IPTV is the preferred solution, assuming sufficient venue bandwidth and network capacity for live video streaming. The system should support end-to-end gigabit connectivity, ideally on a dedicated VLAN or, preferably, an entirely separate network. If local infrastructure cannot support this, a cloud-based distribution system may be considered as an alternative.

A content management system must be provided to manage and schedule daily programming, including live streams from selected events and other video or static content from ADB and the host country. ADB will supply video content, agendas, and static display materials, while the host country is responsible for installing, operating, and maintaining the IPTV system, including managing live links, programming the content management system, and ensuring all necessary cabling is in place.

Method of transmission/broadcast. The IPTV broadcast system should allow live coverage of the events detailed above to be clearly viewable on selected screens at the scheduled times. At other times media content such as videos from ADB or the host country, looping presentations, delegate information, digital events boards, and schedule of events will be shown.

IPTV transmission via a server/IP-based digital TV/signage platform should show content from within playlists or scheduled events and switch to a live switched stream via IPTV feeds when active sessions are required to be viewed.

Digital signage using a content management system allows for many ways to display information, such as live streams, TV channels, static pages, video, overlays, and tickers, and has the flexibility to control what screens are displaying independently as well as in groups within certain areas. IPTV/digital signage receivers are placed at each flat-screen TV and controlled over IP to switch to the correct IPTV stream, channel, agenda item, or to push content direct to the display and show content uploaded to the receiver itself.

It is imperative that a content management system be provided to allow for programmed scheduling and autonomous operation. Daily program and sequencing content will be advised by ADB.

Camera Specifications

Various camera setups are required for the following events. All cameras should be at least HD format and current specification. To enable better communications and avoid signal latency, the vision mixer and camera director should be located locally within the meeting room and not in a separate media van. A portable production unit comprising all elements for a field production should be supplied and installed together with the audiovisual systems.

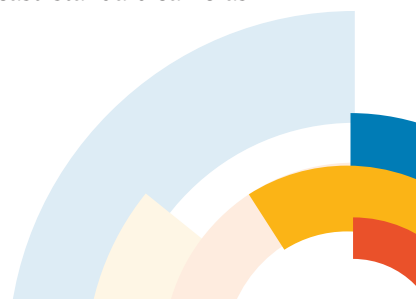
Details of camera specifications are given below.

Opening session. The opening session will be recorded for later broadcast and archiving, webcast online, and streamed live to IPTV screens throughout the venue. A broadcast-standard camera system is essential. In addition to speeches from the lectern and table, there may be a cultural performance, so the camera setup must be capable of capturing both formal and performance elements effectively.

- At least one camera with a long zoom lens and full electronic field production setup should be placed centrally in the front-of-house area to capture medium close-ups of speakers on stage.
- Two to five additional cameras with full electronic field production setups—including tripods, remote zoom/focus controls, pan bars, and preview monitors—should be used for full event coverage.
- A portable production unit must be provided, including a broadcast-grade vision mixer, camera control unit monitoring, and signal distribution, along with a team of support engineers and a vision director to manage the camera feeds.
- A recording system must be supplied, in line with the specifications outlined earlier.

Business session. The camera system for this session is mainly used to show close-ups of speakers on venue display screens, as well as for live streaming, IPTV transmission, and archival purposes.

- Due to the hollow seating arrangement, at least three remotely controlled PTZ cameras should be installed within the center area of the table. These PTZ cameras should be supported by operated HD/broadcast-standard cameras positioned at the table corners and the main camera platform.





- PTZ camera requirements:
 - Broadcast-standard, 3CCD, at least HD quality
 - Remote panning of at least 350 degrees
 - Mounted on pedestals no higher than 75–80 cm (table height)
 - Pedestals can be concealed with floral or plant arrangements
- All camera switching must be done manually via a digital vision mixer—not automated through microphone activation software.

Governors’ seminar. Provide two to four HD/broadcast-standard cameras with full communication links between camera operators and the vision director.

- A portable production unit is required, including a broadcast-grade vision mixer, camera control unit monitoring, and signal distribution, along with support engineers and a vision director.
- A recording system must also be included, following previously outlined specifications.
- Like the business session, the camera mix will be used for IPTV, webcast, live streaming, and archival purposes.

Videoconferencing

With increased use of videoconferencing in international events, there will occasionally be a requirement to provide IP-based videoconferencing in some high-level meetings at short notice. While the annual meeting is a face-to-face, in-person event, there may be instances where Governors or Ministers may not be able to attend in-person. Facilitation of linking those remote speaking participants to the meeting via videoconferencing may need to be provided.

To incorporate clean and effective switching of remote participants into a meeting, the minimum requirements the host country should provide are as follows:

- At least three Windows-enabled laptops with Zoom desktop app installed. One will act as the host of the meeting and be equipped with a necessary video and audio capture device, linked to the main technical systems. The other two will be dedicated as pinned sources, i.e., Current and Next. If more than two pins are required, notification will be provided by the ADB Secretariat in advance and additional laptops may be required and provided from the vendor’s contingent/spare stocks.
- Capture devices should be from a renowned brand, up to date, and equipped with USB-C.
- Return audio and video program feeds from the meeting should be sent back to the remote participants, with mix-minus audio so that they can follow the proceedings clearly.
- Zoom meeting links will be hosted and managed by ADB as a security measure and calls enabled for Session Initiated Protocol (SIP) for connection to traditional videoconferencing systems often used by ministries.
- Test calls must be made at least 1 day before for any videoconferencing-equipped meeting with relevant representatives and will be supported and facilitated by the ADB Secretariat technical team.
- In smaller, less formal working meetings where videoconferencing is needed, ADB will provide Zoom-equipped laptops and IT staff to support.

Master Control Room

A master control room should be installed by the host country's technical vendors to allow for greater control of all cameras, IPTV, video, audiovisual, and audio signals as well as all recordings. This should be controlled from a central geographic location within the venue and allow for efficient cable connectivity. This location can be a small room (15–20 m²) to allow technicians to monitor the live proceedings of events and to ensure that recordings and live streaming are carried out as effectively and efficiently as possible. Meeting rooms should be networked via fiber optic or use of another network stream.



Scene from the Governors' Business Session of the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.



CHAPTER 7

HOTELS



Overview

All parties and stakeholders should be aware of the types of hotels required for the annual meeting, expectations of hotel infrastructure, and the roles and responsibilities for briefing and engaging the hotels.

The engagement of a professional housing agent or a PCO is recommended to negotiate, organize, and supervise room allocations and to liaise with the hotels. The HOC and ADB must agree on the procedure for booking hotel rooms for all categories of participants. This process takes place at least 18 months prior to the meeting.

Hotels are expected to be within walking distance of the main meeting facilities and are required to have specific infrastructure for certain requirements of the annual meeting, including the ability to update and revise hotel room furnishings and interiors.

Rates

The negotiated room rates should not exceed rates extended to embassies and other development agencies.

Guarantee

ADB does not guarantee any block bookings for delegations other than rooms to be paid for by ADB (300 rooms). Any guarantee requested by hotels for other annual meeting participants will be the responsibility of the host country.

Cut-Off Dates, Deposits, Cancellations, and No-Shows

It is preferable that hotel policies on deposits, cancellations, cut-off dates, and no-shows be uniform across hotels selected for the annual meeting to minimize confusion. It is the host country's responsibility (or their designated professional housing agent or PCO) to discuss this with the hotels concerned. Cut-off dates for final reservations and payment of deposits, if any, are negotiated with hotels by ADB and the HOC. For past annual meetings the cut-off date has been the second half of March. In some cases, a phased approach may be required depending upon expected registration, timing, and numbers.

Hotel Desk

A hotel accommodation desk, managed by the HOC, is required at the annual meeting venue to handle participant inquiries related to their hotel accommodation.



Hotel information desks at the 56th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Incheon, Republic of Korea.

Categories of Participants and Reservation Procedures

The host country is responsible for blocking 1,800 rooms for Governors, delegations, and other participants 18 months before the annual meeting. A focal person within the HOC, PCO, or a professional housing agent who has a good relationship with hotels in the host city should be appointed to carry out negotiations and make the reservations.

The procedure for booking hotel rooms is agreed by ADB and the host country 10 months before the annual meeting, while information about hotels and booking procedures is on the website 6 months before the annual meeting.

The HOC sends key regular updates on accommodation bookings to ensure expectations are managed regarding attrition and contractual negotiations. ADB conducts a briefing for hotels on the protocol required for guests as well as sustainability considerations. This includes required security procedures and the availability of an emergency response plan in case of accident, incidents, or loss of property or valuables.

A mission to visit the hotels will be conducted by ADB in the months prior to the meeting.

There are three main categories for hotel bookings, as follows:

Category A. ADB personnel, including the ADB Secretariat and seminar speakers, or around 300 persons/rooms. Their accommodation is block booked, controlled, and paid for by ADB. The rate is preferential and tax exempt. It is



preferable that all ADB personnel stay in the same hotel close to the meeting venue, but not crucial. ADB provides the list of personnel, the type of rooms they will occupy, and the official reservation dates, as well as travel information. Booking for this category is made 10 months prior to the annual meeting.

Category B. Governors, delegates, and observers, or around 500 persons/rooms. Hotels should be rated four to five stars, be near the meeting venue, and be block booked at preferential rates. Governors, delegates, and observers are advised to make requests for accommodation directly to the HOC, PCO, or professional housing agent. These rooms are paid for directly by the Governors, delegates, and observers.

ADB provides the block booking details required for each country's delegation, the list of delegate contact persons, and ADB contact persons for each delegate. Block bookings for delegates and observers in the official hotels are made before the hotel booking web page is made public 6 months prior to the annual meeting.

Governors, delegates, and observers are then asked to send their hotel reservation requests directly to the HOC, PCO, or professional housing agent through the hotel booking web page, linked to the ADB registration website. The hotel booking web page only lists the official hotels reserved for delegates and observers, together with contact details and links to hotel websites, if available.

The PCO or professional housing agent is responsible for managing the block of rooms and confirms reservations directly through the delegate contact persons (with a copy to ADB) for delegates, and directly to the observers. Updates are regularly provided to ADB on the list of hotel bookings by Governors and HODs.

Category C. Guests, media, and CSOs, or around 1,000 persons/rooms. Hotels should be rated three to five stars and participants make their reservations directly to the PCO or professional housing agent via the hotel booking web page. The page will have all the hotels available for participants in Category C, together with contact details and links to hotel websites.

The PCO or the professional housing agent confirms reservations directly and compiles arrival and departure details of participants for the host country. They provide ADB a list of participants with confirmed hotel reservations when requested.

Billing and Collection

For ADB personnel, ADB pays for the room charges for the official period of stay communicated by ADB directly to the hotels. In accordance with the ADB Charter, ADB is exempted from all taxes—national, provincial, and municipal (footnote 1).

The hotel is responsible for billing individual ADB personnel upon checkout for all incidental expenses (e.g., laundry, room service, and telephone calls) incurred during the period of stay in the hotel. If an ADB staff member brings an accompanying person, and there is a difference between the rate for single and double occupancy, the hotel bills the staff member for the difference in the rate. The ADB staff member is also billed for any personal stay at the hotel before or after the official dates of the meeting. The hotel may refer to the accommodation booking advice as a basis for the charges to be paid under the personal account of the staff member, which should be billed upon checkout. It is preferred that the preferential rate negotiated for the annual meeting is honored for extended personal stays where possible.

For the ADB President, ADB pays the room accommodation and all incidental expenses (including laundry, room service, and telephone calls). These charges are included in the ADB master account.

For seminar speakers, unless otherwise specified, ADB pays only single occupancy room charges for the official period of stay communicated by ADB. All other incidental expenses are billed directly by the hotel to the individual speaker upon checkout.

To facilitate payment, the PCO and/or the hotels submit to ADB a completed supplier information form to register in the ADB system.

For participants in categories B and C, bills for rooms and other incidental charges and collections are the responsibility of the hotel and/or the PCO, by mutual arrangement. ADB accepts no responsibility for any unpaid accounts or claims, nor does it guarantee payment for unused rooms. It is therefore incumbent upon the hotel to collect any charges due from the participants upon check-in or checkout of the hotel

Timeline of Tasks Related to Hotels

Task	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
Write to general managers to request room reservations for annual meeting participants	18–24
Block book hotel rooms for all official participants and ADB personnel	18
Agree with ADB on the agent to handle hotel bookings	11
Decide, in consultation with ADB, which hotels to use for which guest category, as well as hotel booking procedures, terms, and conditions, e.g., reserving rooms and no-show policy	10
Pilot test hotel booking procedure, in consultation with ADB	10
Decide the procedure for handling tax exemption of ADB personnel paid through ADB master account	10
Block book hotel accommodation for delegation	10
Post information about hotel bookings on the annual meeting website	6
Process hotel reservations, cancellations	6 to the month of the annual meeting
Provide reports on hotel bookings to ADB as required	5 to the month of the annual meeting



Categories of Participants and Hotel Room Requirements/Terms

Category	Participant/s	Room Requirements	Remarks	Billing and Payment
Category A Around 300 participants ADB staff and seminar speakers	ADB President	1 deluxe or executive suite	Preferably close to the meeting venue Block booked Controlled by ADB Preferential rates	Room rates paid by ADB, therefore exempt from taxes. Except for the ADB President, charges for incidentals to be paid by individual upon checkout.
	ADB management and staff	300 rooms		
	Seminar speakers			
Category B Around 500 participants Governors, delegates, observers	Member country representatives	50 suites	Should be close to the meeting venue Block booked Preferential rates 4- to 5-star hotels	Paid directly by participants (terms of payment negotiated)
	(i) Representatives of international organizations and countries being considered for membership	450 rooms		
	(ii) Special guests			
Category C Around 1,000 participants Guests, media, NGOs, CSOs, special guests	Representatives of banks, financial institutions, and industry, legal, and private sectors, former ADB employees, international media, NGOs and CSOs	1,000 rooms	Negotiated and accredited by host country Preferential rates 3- to 5-star hotels Participants are advised to make their requests for accommodation directly with the ground handling agent appointed by the host country or directly with the hotels if there is no agent	Paid directly by participant



CHAPTER 8

TRANSPORT



Overview

The host country provides transport for official annual meeting participants from the airport to hotels on arrival and from hotels to the airport on departure, as well as to and from the annual meeting venue and any other venues that may be used for official networking events.

There are three main types of transport requirement across the meeting:

- VIP cars for Governors and/or HODs and the ADB President and spouse;
- standard cars for the ADB Board of Directors, Management, ADB Institute Dean, Secretary, and annual meeting secretariat; and
- shuttle service for all other attendees.

Transport Coordinator

The host country provides an English-speaking 24-hour transport coordinator to

- coordinate transport with meeting security (i.e., sticker requirements if applicable) and local law enforcement;
- manage the traffic flow;
- design routes to take, with alternative backup routes; and
- manage the parking areas for VIP cars, buses, and any others with entry permits.

The transport coordinator is based at the transport desk at the meeting venue to be visible and easily contactable by participants or secretariats throughout the meeting.

Chauffeur-Driven Cars

The host country provides chauffeur-driven cars to certain participants for official purposes. Cars for Governors, HODs, the ADB President, and other special guests are made available from the dates of arrival at the airport until their departure. Some Governors and HODs may arrive earlier to participate in official meetings prior to the start of the annual meeting. In such circumstances, the vehicles are made available not earlier than 2 days after the offices open, and not later than 1 day after the closing of the annual meeting.



Cars for vice-presidents, Dean of the ADB Institute, and ADB Secretary are made available at their hotels from arrival until departure date.

For the ADB Secretariat, six vehicles, which include one or two minibuses, are required. One vehicle is made available for the ADB advance party, usually 2–3 weeks earlier than the others. The dates required for the other cars are provided near the time of the meeting.

Other VIPs, such as heads of state and/or government and others of ministerial rank or higher; royal family members; eminent seminar speakers (e.g., Nobel laureates); former heads of state and/or government; Governors of central banks; heads of multilateral organizations; and selected observers may also be provided chauffeur-driven cars at the discretion of the host country and in accordance with its protocol.



Signages and banners welcome delegates to the 57th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Tbilisi, Georgia.

Car Identification

ID cards for annual meeting cars facilitate parking and call-up. ADB prepares the car ID cards with country, management, and secretariat codes to distinguish the passengers and allow access to the venue. Paging facilities and transport desks will enable Governors and HODs to call their official cars from parking areas when and where required.

The host country will ensure that security details are also briefed as to the relevance of these car identification cards as these define who is permitted in and out of the designated and assigned parking areas.

Shuttle Buses

Shuttle buses are required between (i) the meeting venues and hotels where participants are staying; (ii) the meeting venues and venues for official events, including networking and cultural events; and (iii) hotels and venues for official events.

The host country coordinates with ADB to make the shuttle bus schedule available for participants in advance through the website. The host country may also print a shuttle bus schedule in advance and distribute it to all participants at registration. This information is also available at the meeting venue's transport desk and



Signages and banners welcome delegates to the 57th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Tbilisi, Georgia.

posted at the venue and official hotels. Buses must be of high quality, well maintained, and meet environmental standards, preferably using low-emission or electric technology.

Transport and Hospitality Desks

Transport desks are required in the meeting venues and in each hotel where a shuttle bus is provided to answer questions about the annual meeting transport and shuttle bus schedules. The shuttle bus schedule should also be prominently posted at each official hotel. The desks may also provide information on tours, shopping, and restaurants. The host country should ensure that staff at these desks have all the information they require, including copies of the shuttle schedule, handbook, directory, and the schedule of events.

To facilitate transport to the airport upon departure, the host country may issue a departure transport request form to all participants.

Training of Drivers

All drivers of cars and shuttle buses should be thoroughly briefed and trained and familiar with the routes to be used for the meeting between the airport and the hotels, and between all the official meeting venues. A dry run of all the shuttle routes is conducted before the meeting upon arrival of the ADB advance party.

For host countries where the English language is not widely used, each driver should have a conversation sheet containing English translations of commonly used phrases for directions.

Transport Routes

The host country should determine the shortest and most convenient routes for the cars and shuttle buses. They should advise if any parades or celebrations will be taking place along the proposed routes at any time during the annual meeting. If so, they need to provide alternative routes, provide maps for participants, and brief all drivers on any detour.



Branded and well-labeled shuttle buses at the 56th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Incheon, Republic of Korea.



High-quality electric shuttle buses for participants at Incheon, Republic of Korea.



Parking

Adequate parking spaces are designated for VIP cars, rented cars (if allowed inside the venue), and shuttle buses. These must be clearly marked on a map, together with drop-off and pick-up areas. In addition, there should be arrangements for access, drop-off points, and routes for delivery vehicles within the venue. Clear security or sticker requirements for delivery vehicles must be given to ADB 6 months before the meeting. The host country is also expected to provide a covered waiting shed at pick-up and drop-off points. Chairs, drinking water, and umbrellas in these areas are also recommended.

Rented Cars and Taxis

The host country posts on the ADB website the contact details of two to three reputable car rental companies that participants may use. Online forms for renting these cars in advance should be available 8 months before the meeting.

A decision must be made as early as possible whether rented cars and taxis are allowed inside the annual meeting premises. If not, a convenient drop-off and pick-up place is designated for these vehicles so that participants do not have to walk too far to reach the venue. If the distance is great, shuttle buses or golf carts may be provided to transport participants.

If rented cars and taxis are allowed in the premises, the host country must decide how to screen them and whether to issue access stickers. If stickers are used, decisions must be made 6 months before the annual meeting on how many stickers will be available, any limits per delegation, and how to distribute them. The issuance of stickers is handled by the host country, taking into consideration security factors.



Hybrid cars for Governors and Head of Delegations at the 56th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Incheon, Republic of Korea.

Trains and Subway

Host countries with reliable and secure train or subway systems can use these as modes of transport for participants to and from the meeting venues, hotels, and other official venues. In such cases, the host country may provide train or subway passes to all participants, valid for the duration of the meeting. Signs and maps in English should be visibly posted at the train station. The train and subway schedules are also made available to the participants in each official hotel. In addition, the host country posts locally engaged staff in the station to direct participants to the venue and to hotels.

Traffic and Transportation Plan

The host country must ensure the following:

- an overall transportation and traffic committee is appointed;
- transportation and traffic flow plans are provided to ADB;
- a 24-hour host country transportation coordinator is appointed; and
- shuttle buses run frequently, vehicles are of good quality and reliable, vehicles follow the schedule, and shuttle bus drivers know the itineraries to and from the airport, the hotels, and all venues.

Timeline of Tasks Related to Transport

Task	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
Discuss transport and traffic flow requirements with ADB	11
Determine access to venue and pick-up and drop-off points	11
Determine how to allow access for registration and delivery of materials/equipment	6
Review schedule arrangements for cars and shuttle buses	4
Review traffic flow arrangements at the different venues	4
Review transport advisory for participants	4
Determine schedule and itineraries of shuttle buses	3
Finalize shuttle bus schedule booklet, if any, in consultation with ADB	1
Train all drivers on routes to and from all meeting venues	1
Conduct dry run for shuttles with ADB advance party	1



Summary of Transport Requirements

Type of Vehicle	Passengers	Number	Availability	First Pick-Up/ Last Drop-Off	Notes
VIP chauffeur-driven cars	Governors and heads of delegation	69	Arrival to departure	Airport	- Country code and management code visibly displayed - English-speaking driver
	ADB President	2			
	Former ADB Presidents and special guests	5			
Regular chauffeur-driven cars	Vice-Presidents	6	Arrival to departure	Hotel	- Country code/ appropriate signs visibly displayed - English-speaking driver
	Dean of ADB Institute	1			
	ADB Secretary	1			
	ADB Secretariat	3	Arrival until departure		
	ADB Secretariat advance party	1	2–3 weeks earlier than other secretariat cars		
Van	ADB Secretariat	1–2	Arrival to departure	Hotel	- Signs visibly displayed - English-speaking driver
Shuttle bus	All other participants	To be discussed	To be discussed	Shuttle buses used for: - Airport and designated hotels - Designated hotels and meeting venues - Meeting venue/s and networking events - Tour Program - Note: Signs must be visibly displayed	



CHAPTER 9

ACCREDITATION, INVITATIONS, AND REGISTRATION

Overview

There are particular procedures surrounding who attends the annual meeting, how they are invited, and how they register. Close consultation between ADB and the host country is required to ensure that the invite list is well coordinated and able to be handed to a PCO or booking agent for onward travel requirements.

Accreditation and Types of Participants

Participation at the annual meeting is by invitation only. The host country and ADB coordinate closely on the list of invitees, and all organizations must be accredited by ADB or the host country before being issued an invitation online by ADB. Online registration is then encouraged over on-site registration.

Governors and delegations. ADB sends the Governor and Alternate Governor of each ADB member a notice of the annual meeting and shares the draft agenda 6 months prior to the meeting. A contact person nominated by each member is responsible for ensuring that all delegation members are registered online.

Observers. ADB invites observers—representatives of international organizations and countries being considered for membership—to attend the annual meeting. The Chair of the Board of Governors is informally consulted on the draft list of observers before asking for the approval of the ADB Board of Directors. Upon Board approval, the list is sent to the Chair for final approval.

Representatives of CSOs. Representatives of CSOs from ADB members are invited to attend. The government of the country in which the CSO is based must endorse the organization. A list of previously accredited NGOs is sent to the Board of Directors for approval along with any additions by December. The application form for accreditation will be posted on the ADB annual meeting website 4 months before the meeting.



ADB's NGOC screens each CSO based on the following set of criteria: (i) it operates legally in an ADB member, (ii) it is independent of the state and has not been created for profit-making purposes, and (iii) it engages in activities related to development policy and practice relevant to ADB operations.

Private sector and banker guests. ADB's Treasury Department and Private Sector Operations Department accredit the organizations, consulting the Board of Directors as necessary.

Media. ADB's DOCK accredits journalists and media participants. The host country sends DOCK a list of local media to be invited 6 months before the meeting. Media representatives are informed about the meeting by a media announcement via the ADB website issued by DOCK 5 months before the meeting.

Host country guests. The accreditation of host country guests is the responsibility of the host country. These guests may include local dignitaries and government officials, sponsors who have supported the host country's efforts, and distinguished representatives of businesses and the academic community. The host country accredits these participants then sends them invitations.

Other guests. Guest institutions should have financial or operational relations with ADB that are actually or potentially beneficial to ADB. Guests may include

- major consulting firms; major engineering, procurement, and construction firms; and corporations that have a continuing, significant working relationship with ADB;
- representatives from organizations that have no working relationship with ADB but are either major players in the market or have the potential to work closely with ADB;
- former ADB Presidents, Vice-Presidents, secretaries, and former staff members who are members of the AFE-ADB; and
- members of the diplomatic corps, academic researchers, and students interested in or working in fields related to international development.

Other interested parties. An online accreditation website is set up for individuals who are interested in participating but are not yet accredited by ADB. The request for accreditation goes directly to the appropriate inviting units for evaluation. Organizations cannot be accredited on-site.

Delegates may register on-site provided they are representing a previously accredited organization, and that they have proof of their identities, copies of their invitation letters, and proof that they are representing their organization. Submitting a request for an invitation does not guarantee that the requester receives an invitation to register.



Participants on the way to the 56th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Incheon, Republic of Korea.

Invitation and Registration Process

After an organization has been accredited, ADB sends an online invitation to the head of the organization. The invitation contains an ID and password that representatives from that organization must use to register for the annual meeting.

Once the registration is complete, each individual from the organization receives an online confirmation letter as proof that they have registered.

Online registration is available throughout the entire meeting only for ADB member delegations, speakers, and host country guests, and the Registration Center is open for those who are invited but fail to register online prior to the event.

Invitations are issued by ADB for the following events:

ADB President's reception. All registered participants are invited. No printed invitation is issued, but participants must wear their badges.

Opening session. All registered participants are invited, including the media. The host country may require additional security or protocol measures to enter with the GOH. No printed invitation is issued, and the host country takes care of entry and security procedures.

Luncheon for Governors. Invitations are sent by ADB to Governors, HODs, Alternate Governors, ADB management, and others as considered appropriate. No printed invitation is issued.

Press conference and media reception. Journalists are welcome to attend key media events as well as public events such as the opening session, business session, seminars, networking events, and signing ceremonies.

The host country may issue invitations for host country restricted events according to host country protocol. Seating arrangements for host country luncheons and dinners follow host country protocol, with close coordination with ADB on head table seating. To assist in the preparation of these events, ADB provides the host country with a list of ranking participants, list of VIP spouses and partners (if applicable), and other lists as requested.

For host country-hosted networking events, to which all participants are invited, invitations may be issued at the discretion of the host country.

The host country may prepare a Tour Program for all participants and accompanying persons. This is optional and may incur a charge. Details of the tour and how to register and pay are posted on the annual meeting website. A VIP spouses and partners' tour program may also be organized by the host country but is not mandatory.



Host country staff support at the registration area in Incheon, Republic of Korea.



Registration

ADB provides an electronic event management system for the online registration of all annual meeting guests.

ADB also sets up procedures for on-site accreditation and registration. At the meeting site, the registration unit manages the Registration Center, coordinates accreditation and registration of walk-in guests, and provides lists of participants upon request.



Registration Center at the 56th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Incheon, Republic of Korea.

Categories. Registered participants fall into the following categories:

- delegates—Governors, Alternate Governors, temporary Alternate Governors, and advisers;
- observers—representatives of nonmember countries interested in joining ADB and representatives of ADB-accredited international organizations;
- guests—representatives of financial institutions and private institutions, members of the AFE-ADB, major consulting and contractor firms, local dignitaries, and special guests such as former ADB Presidents, Vice-Presidents, and secretaries;
- NGOs/CSOs;
- media representatives;

- ADB personnel;
- host country secretariat;
- accompanying persons—e.g., spouses or partners, children aged 18 years old and above, other individuals and representatives of other corporations, and personal assistants such as interpreters and personal bodyguards;
- host country guests; and
- event suppliers and partners—e.g., PCOs, venue technicians, and drivers.

Registration dates. Invitations are sent out 5 months before the meeting. This is announced through a news release that is posted on the ADB website. Online registration remains open until 2 weeks before the meeting.

Photographs. Participants are required to attach a color passport-style photograph file with their online registration. Photos should be on a white background, in .jpg format, with a resolution of at least 200 dots per inch (dpi) and a file size of not more than 100 kilobytes. Photos are submitted in advance so that ID badges can be printed and prepared by ADB ahead of time. If a photo is not submitted, the participant must finish the registration process on-site.

Completion of registration forms. Upon receipt of an online registration form, the relevant inviting ADB unit inspects the photograph submitted with the form. If it is acceptable, confirmation of completion of online registration is sent to the participant electronically by the unit. These confirmation letters are used by participants and their accompanying persons to apply for visas.

Registration database. Once participants have registered, their personal information is stored in a secure database. ADB makes this information available on a confidential basis to the host country through a secure organizer's app, which can only be accessed using an ID and password. This information is useful for embassies when processing visa applications, because each embassy can cross-check whether an individual applicant has registered to attend the meeting.

Schedule and venue. The Registration Center is located inside or near the meeting venue, with the exact site determined in consultation with ADB and the host country. Usually, the Registration Center is open from 7:30 a.m. to 6:00 p.m. every day during the meeting. The center should have adequate office facilities, including toilets and drinking water, and provide an environment conducive for working and receiving guests, including VIPs. It should have an information desk that can assist participants with their administrative and logistical queries.

Identification badge. Participants must personally pick up their badges at the Registration Center, presenting their passports as proof of identity. Local participants must present an official photo ID (e.g., national ID or other government-issued ID). Annual meeting ID badges display the name, affiliated organization, and registration category of each participant. Participants must wear the badges prominently at the meeting site and other venues where official events take place.

Participants who are unable to collect their badges in person must provide a signed authorization letter designating a representative to collect on their behalf. This requirement is strictly enforced.

A lost badge must be reported immediately to the Registration Center. It may be replaced only with the approval of a registration officer and only after verification of identity.

In the event of a power or systems failure during registration, a temporary badge that is valid for 1 day will be issued to registrants following the same requirements for proof of identity.



Walk-in guests. ADB discourages on-site registration of pre-invited participants since it leads to delays and congestion. However, representatives of previously accredited organizations and walk-in local guests (in particular, government officials) may register on-site subject to accreditation by the host country. Accreditation is handled by local staff posted by the HOC at the Registration Center throughout the annual meeting period. These local staff stay in touch with the host country media liaison officer to advise on local media participants.



Volunteers helping out at the 56th Annual Meeting of the Board of Governors in Incheon, Republic of Korea.

Before the annual meeting, all ADB inviting units submit to the registration unit a list of accredited organizations and names of people who may register on-site. This helps registration staff decide if an individual who wishes to register on-site is an accredited invitee. If a person's name or organization is not in the lists of accredited participants/organizations, registration staff should contact the following offices to accredit specific type of participants:

- Delegates: Respective ADB Board member or their alternate
- Observers: Office of the Secretary
- Guests: Treasury Department, Private Sector Operations Department, or Office of the Secretary
- Civil society: NGOOC
- Media: DOCK
- Local participants: Host country

These offices nominate one staff member to always be available or on call (whether on-site or remotely from headquarters) to assist in accrediting participants. The ADB offices must consult the host country contact person in the Registration Center for accreditation of local participants (e.g., bankers and media).

After the identification and endorsement procedures have been completed, the participant is instructed to register using dedicated computer terminals. The participant will be issued an annual meeting badge upon completion of registration.

Security. For security issues related to registration or occurring at the Registration Center, the registration team communicates the issue/s to the security coordinator for proper assessment and corresponding action. A contingency plan is required to specify required action and proper communication with registrants during a system/power failure. The plan shall specify the registration process for each type of registrant.

Timeline of Tasks Related to Accreditation, Invitations, and Registration

Task	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
Accreditation and invitations	
Host country provides feedback on list of observers to be invited, and suggests any additional observers to be invited	11
Agree with ADB procedure for issuing invitations	11
Review lists of participants from the previous annual meeting	11
Draft invitation design/template	7
Provide names and e-mail addresses of contact persons for host country guests, including local dignitaries, members of the diplomatic corps and members of host country secretariat, who will forward the ADB invitation to invited host country guests	3
Provide final list of invites for the host country luncheon to ADB at least 5 days before the event	1
Send invitations (by email) for host country luncheon and host country reception to invitees in advance	1
Registration	
Determine access to Registration Center, considering security measures	8
Provide comments on draft sample badges	7
Determine access procedure for nonregistered meeting invitees, if any	5
Assign contact person to coordinate registration of members of host country secretariat for their registration	5
Determine how to register, provide access to local staff, and inform ADB	5
Provide facilities and technical personnel to test and support ADB registration equipment	4
Agree on and establish accreditation and registration procedures on-site	4
If applicable, provide a prototype of badges for locally engaged staff to security, police, and ADB	1
Provide download instructions for the ADB app and provide a user guide to registration staff as part of the training	1
During the meeting, post a staff member at the Registration Center to accredit on-site registrants	Month of the annual meeting





CHAPTER 10

VISAS



Overview

ADB expects the host country to assist with annual meeting participants obtaining visas and clearing immigration and customs at the point of entry.

Visa Facilitation

The host country accords visa facilitation to all official participants in the annual meeting in accordance with the provisions of the Agreement Establishing the ADB (ADB Charter) (footnote 1).

This means all Governors, directors, alternates, officers, and employees of ADB, including experts performing missions for ADB, shall be immune from legal process with respect to acts performed by them in their official capacity, except when ADB waives the immunity. Where they are not local citizens or nationals, the same immunities shall be accorded from immigration restrictions, alien registration requirements and national service obligations, and the same facilities as regards exchange regulations, as are accorded by members to the representatives, officials and employees of comparable rank of other members. They shall also be granted the same treatment in respect of traveling facilities as is accorded by members to representatives, officials, and employees of comparable rank of other members.

Granting of Visas

The host country should instruct its embassies and consulates to grant suitable visas to official participants without delay and without requiring their personal appearance. The visa should allow participants to travel in the country before and after the annual meeting. In some situations, it may not be possible for applicants to obtain visas in their own countries. In such cases, arrangements should be made to facilitate the granting of an appropriate visa at other convenient locations or to issue visas on arrival. In some cases, ADB may be able to assist in requesting embassies to facilitate issuance of visas.

The host country is expected to grant visas to guests, media, NGOs and CSOs, and any other expert invited or granted annual meeting participant status by ADB, subject, if necessary, to production of written evidence of such invitation or status.

The host country is expected to inform ADB of any special requirements for the issuance of a visa to international media. Computer-generated registration confirmation letters from ADB's registration system may be used by participants and accompanying persons to secure visas to enter the host country. For ADB personnel participating in the annual meeting, the host country is requested to waive visa fees and facilitate visa processing. To assist in this process, ADB provides the host country with a list of ADB personnel requiring visas.

The host country agrees to undertake the following:

- Designate a dedicated English-speaking focal person to handle all visa-related matters of participants starting 7 months before the meeting.
- Create a designated email account for visa inquiries.
- Inform all embassies and consulates of the dates of the annual meeting and of the requirements to facilitate visa issuance to participants.
- Prepare a step-by-step online guide in English for participants to apply for a visa, including a visa-on-arrival at the airport, if any.
- Provide a procedure on the website for participants who come from member countries where the host country does not have an embassy or consulate.
- Ensure that 5–6 months before the meeting, all visa requirements, restrictions, and conditions, and detailed procedures on how to address them, are available on the website (e.g., host country has restrictions on who may obtain visas, visa issuance may be delayed, visa may be required at short notice).
- Provide a dedicated on-site visa desk near the registration desk, if needed.

It is recommended that a special immigration lane be provided for annual meeting participants. The host country is expected to reinforce services at international and domestic airports to expedite immigration and customs formalities for participants at the meeting.

Customs Clearance

The host country should expedite clearance and processing by customs, at entry and departure, of the documents, supplies, equipment, and other goods shipped by ADB to and from meeting venues. The import or export of all such items by ADB is exempt from all taxes, customs duties, and other levies and is allowed without hindrance of any kind. The host country is also expected to help facilitate the entry of equipment and other accessories needed by international media for the coverage of the annual meeting.



Annual meeting signages at the airport in Incheon, Republic of Korea.



Timeline of Tasks Related to Visas

Task	No. of Months Before the Annual Meeting
Visas	
Inform ADB of procedures for facilitating issuance of visas including any special requirements for media and NGOs/CSOs	10
Confirm waiver of visa-processing fees for ADB personnel	10
Advise whether visas may be issued on arrival; if so, determine procedure	10
Provide ADB with list of countries whose citizens require visas and list of countries that have no visa-issuing embassy or consulate	10
Post information on visa applications on host country website	7
Provide a focal point for visa inquiries and facilitation	7
Relay ADB's request to issue appropriate visas to participants to the host country's diplomatic or visa-issuing missions	6
Process visas for annual meeting participants, including international media, as quickly as possible	4
Tax and Customs Duty Exemption	
Confirm ADB privileges and immunities	11
Advise ADB of procedures for tax and duty exemption from hotels and shipments, including equipment used by international media	9
Issue any documentation required for hotels and shipping agents	7
Ensure hotels and other relevant entities implement tax exemption procedures	2 to the month of the annual meeting



CHAPTER 11

PROTOCOL



Overview

ADB and the HOC must follow policies, procedures, and protocol during annual meetings. ADB respects that each country has its own way of managing and coordinating VIP delegations; however, protocol plays a significant role in how annual meetings are run. It is imperative that ADB and the host country come to an agreement on the order of the annual meeting, ensuring both parties honor their commitments to their VIPs and key stakeholders.

ADB Protocol

Protocol plays an important role in the organization of ADB's annual meetings. Protocol is not intended to be rigid or overly formal, but rather a tool to assist the smooth interaction between ADB and its members and partners. At times, ADB protocol varies from that of some of its members. In such cases, ADB is usually guided by host country protocol. An example is the order of speaking at the opening session. According to ADB protocol, the Chair makes a short address, followed by the GOH and the ADB President. However, in some countries, the GOH might have to speak first. Other key areas where protocol is critical are (i) airport arrangements, including meeting and greeting; (ii) ground transport; (iii) courtesy calls; (iv) seating arrangements at key events; (v) head table arrangements at lunches and dinners; (vi) scenarios for certain events attended by heads of delegations; and (vii) schedules of VIPs, including the ADB President and Chair.

During the annual meeting, protocol matters are managed by the protocol and networking team, which plans and coordinates related activities under the supervision of the ADB annual meeting coordinator.



ADB President Masato Kanda meets Italy's Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni during the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.



Frequent communication with the coordinator is essential to ensure that arrangements for VIPs proceed smoothly. These arrangements include

- close coordination on invitations, transport, seating arrangements, and security for all official events;
- assigning liaison officers to assist in addressing VIP needs and any concerns and also be involved in formulating the appropriate opening session procedures, with backup plans in place to call upon if the need arises;
- providing VIPs with information about their cars, liaison officers, and the annual meeting itself, including events they should attend;
- meeting VIPs at the airport, transporting them to their hotels, and transporting them to the meeting venue; and
- specific arrangements for the GOH, Chair of the Board of Governors, and the ADB President at the opening session.

Definition of a VIP

For the purposes of ADB protocol, a VIP is broadly defined as a person having status not lower than

- head of state and/or government of a sovereign or internationally recognized state or territory (e.g., a monarch or President) or former head of state and/or government;
- Minister in a central government of an internationally recognized state (e.g., Prime Minister, Cabinet Minister, or Secretary of State);
- member of a royal family;
- ADB Governor or head of delegation;
- ADB Alternate Governor;
- President or former President of ADB;
- Governor of a central bank;
- leader of an assembly of elected representatives (e.g., senate president or speaker, or leader of a house of representatives);
- head of a major international organization (e.g., president of the World Bank or secretary-general of a United Nations agency); or
- eminent speakers.

For the annual meeting, ADB treats all heads of delegations (HODs) in the same manner. All HODs have the same cars and the same seating arrangements at the opening session, i.e., there is a seating block for heads of delegations, not assigned seats. Where possible, it is preferred that this approach is taken to host country VIPs also. However, ADB respects that this may not be the case and is very much dependent upon following precedence within the host country.

Protocol Coordinator

The host country appoints an experienced protocol coordinator to liaise with ADB 7 months before the meeting on all protocol matters. The protocol coordinator provides guidance regarding details on the attendance of the GOH and other VIPs at the opening session and other high-level events.

If the GOH is the head of state, it is essential that ADB meet the protocol personnel of the head of state preferably 4 months before the annual meeting. During the technical mission, ADB and the head of state's protocol staff walk through protocol arrangements together before the opening session to clarify the entire scenario. Copies of any speeches by the GOH and other host country VIPs attending official meeting events are provided to ADB by the coordinator at least 3 days before the event.

Airport or Port of Entry Formalities

Protocol assistance to VIPs may include, but is not limited to

- use of the VIP lounge at the airport or other ports of entry;
- speedy assistance with customs, immigration, and quarantine procedures;
- exemption from security checks;
- where applicable, meet-and-greet honors by the highest-ranking official designated by the host country; and
- provision of chauffeur-driven cars throughout the duration of the annual meeting and greeted by liaison officers on arrival.

Official and Networking Events

The ADB Secretariat, in coordination with the host country secretariat, monitors the official and networking events to be attended by the ADB President and Chair, particularly those requiring protocol observance. To ensure appropriate application of protocol, the ADB Secretariat, in consultation with the protocol coordinator, prepares protocol scenarios for major events such as the opening session, the ADB President's reception, and any high-level luncheons hosted by the ADB President and Chair.

Invitations

Preparation and delivery of invitations to ADB-hosted official and networking events are the responsibility of the networking events unit within the ADB Secretariat. However, the host country provides the Secretariat with the names and titles of local dignitaries and diplomatic officials to be invited to official and networking events and may also assist in distributing such invitations in advance of the meeting.

Preparation and delivery of invitations to host country events is the responsibility of the host country. At least 2 weeks before the opening of ADB offices on-site, the host country protocol coordinator prepares a detailed protocol scenario in close coordination with the ADB annual meeting coordinator, providing the names and titles of local VIPs attending, including spouses or partners, if applicable, and the likely role of the ADB President and Chair at such events (e.g., whether they need to deliver a speech).





Holding Room for Guest of Honor

The host country provides a holding room close to the venue of the event with refreshments when a President or Prime Minister of the host country is the GOH.

Any ad hoc requirements of the GOH at the annual meeting are the responsibility of the host country to organize and pay.

Seating Arrangements

The ADB Secretariat has overall oversight responsibility for protocol and should be consulted if there are questions. Seating plans and other arrangements for official annual meeting events and functions are a joint responsibility of the ADB Secretariat for ADB-hosted official and networking events and the host country for host country events.

The ADB Secretariat is responsible for table seating at official and networking events and for issuing invitations to the head table at ADB-hosted events. Head table seating for VIPs needs careful consideration.

For host country events, the host country provides protocol in consultation with the ADB Secretariat. The host country protocol coordinator is responsible for deciding on table seating arrangements, advising those seated at the head table, obtaining their confirmation of attendance, and greeting guests on arrival and showing them to their seats. The host country should inform ADB of arrangements for the ADB President and management team at host country events.

Timeline of Tasks Related to Protocol

Task	No. of Months Before the Annual Meeting
Discuss host country protocol practices with ADB and propose a planning schedule	11
Appoint a host country protocol coordinator to liaise with ADB on protocol matters	11
Propose VIP arrangement and protocol	11
Discuss airport arrangements, ground transport, courtesy calls, and seating arrangements at key events and receptions	7
Appoint a host country protocol coordinator to liaise with ADB on protocol arrangements for VIPs at the opening session and other high-level events	7
If the GOH is the head of state or government of host country, arrange for ADB to meet the protocol personnel of the head of state	4



CHAPTER 12

AIRPORT ARRANGEMENTS



Overview

Protocol and preferred procedures should be followed for arrival and departure at the airport closest to the annual meeting venue.

Airport Arrival and Departure

ADB expects that the HOC will have an established relationship with senior airport officials and security to ensure that the airport experience for participants is seamless. An outline of the airport reception arrangements should be prepared by the host country and presented to ADB during the establishment mission 1 year before the annual meeting. More detailed arrangements are finalized during the technical mission held 4 months before the annual meeting.

The host country provides arrangements for participants' arrival and departure. This includes

- speedy clearance through immigration and customs,
- VIP treatment as appropriate,
- a focal person in each airport where participants will transit or arrive, and
- English-speaking host country personnel or volunteers.

Arrival

The following guidelines should be followed:

- English signs directing participants to annual meeting VIP areas, welcome, and information desks should be visible.
- VIPs should be met by the appropriate host country authorities in accordance with local protocol. Where deemed necessary by the host country security authorities, provisions should be made so that VIPs do not have to proceed through the public areas in the airport.
- VIPs may be provided a dedicated car by the host country or a car on demand (e.g., carpool). The host country designates parking and collection points and ensures that drivers are briefed, trained, and preferably English-speaking.



Signages and banners welcome delegates to the 57th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Tbilisi, Georgia.

- ADB does not monitor the travel details of general participants, who may provide their arrival details through online registration or through hotel accommodation booking. The host country coordinates with their appointed PCO or local hotel booking agent to consolidate itineraries to prepare an airport shuttle schedule.
- Given the volume of participants arriving during a short period of time, the host country should anticipate queues for immigration procedures and congestion at baggage claim areas. The host country must identify solutions to these issues in their airport reception plan, including procedures for lost luggage.
- Two weeks prior to the arrival of the ADB President for the annual meeting, a stakeholder dry run of the airport reception arrangements should be hosted by the nominated senior airport official to allow for any adjustments.

Departure

The host country provides transport for participants from hotels or the meeting venue to the airport and may also help at the airport for departure of VIPs and general participants.

Airport Security

The host country is required to provide appropriate facilities including but not limited to immigration, security, assistance for people with disabilities, and baggage facilities for the arrival and departure of participants. Necessary practical arrangements are also required for the arrival and departure of VIPs. The ADB President is received and sent off by the ADB Secretary at the tarmac. ADB must be notified of airport screening procedures that will be in place for the annual meeting at least 4 months prior to the date of the annual meeting.

Timeline of Tasks Related to Airport Arrangements

Task	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
Discuss airport requirements with ADB	12
Discuss visa upon arrival and customs requirements for participants, including international media	7
Provide detailed airport reception plan for participants and VIPs and inspect airport	4
Train host country staff and volunteers	1
Conduct a dry run of reception procedures with ADB	1
Set up welcome and information desk, separate immigration lane, signs for transport to annual meeting hotels and venue	Month of the annual meeting





CHAPTER 13

SECURITY AND TRAFFIC CONTROL



Overview

The host country has overall responsibility for security throughout the annual meeting, including both the pre-planning phase and the event itself. While ADB acknowledges this primary role, it remains fully accountable for the safety, security, and well-being of its personnel and assets.

ADB's goal is to support and leverage the host country's lead role in security, while ensuring that ADB-specific requirements and standards are met. All security planning must therefore be conducted in close consultation with ADB to ensure comprehensive coverage across all official events and venues.

Consultation with ADB

The ADB security coordinator must be consulted and fully advised about all ongoing security arrangements. In turn, the ADB security coordinator should discuss with the host country security authorities, details of arrangements in accordance with the security and safety checklist. The ADB security coordinator also keeps the ADB Secretary and ADB annual meeting coordinator fully informed on all security-related matters. All key security personnel from the host country should ideally be fluent in English.

ADB security experts attending missions and the annual meeting should collaborate with the host country security team for security requirements. ADB should explain the security responsibility of the host country relating to losses or damage of equipment and materials during the whole event period.

Traffic Control

The host country is required to provide appropriate traffic control to facilitate the movement of all participants from the airport to their hotels on arrival and vice versa on departure, and to and from hotels to venues for official events, including networking and cultural events. In particular, the host country is expected to maintain full traffic control around the venues and ensure that adequate access routes, passenger drop-off and pick-up points, and parking facilities are provided to avoid congestion and enable the smooth arrival and departure of participants.

Four months before the annual meeting, the host country presents to ADB a plan of the meeting vicinity showing the security perimeter, entrances and exits for different categories of vehicles and pedestrians, parking for VIP cars, shuttle buses, delivery and other vehicles with access to the secure area, the flow of traffic, and routes to be used. This is then discussed with the ADB security coordinator and ADB annual meeting coordinator.

Annual Meeting Venue

The host country arranges for 24-hour physical security of the meeting area and venues, i.e., all buildings, including hotels, for the protection of property and maintenance of order around the meeting area. Security personnel are briefed to permit authorized ADB personnel access to the venue on a 24-hour basis. The host country will ensure to engage, plan, and coordinate with the primary and alternate ADB security coordinator on a continuing basis from the establishment mission and throughout the annual meeting.

A host country security presence is deployed in these areas:

- Outside entrances to the opening session and business session venues to prevent unauthorized admission and maintain order. Where feasible, all security measures should be in place and operational at least 1 week prior to the opening session;
- Official annual meeting networking and cultural events to provide overall security, prevent unauthorized admission, manage traffic, and generally maintain order. Security is also required to assist in ensuring the smooth flow of invitees attending these events (e.g., crowd control in escalators, stairs, at entry gates);
- Outside all entrances to the meeting area and venues, smaller meeting rooms, and access points on the floors where the Board and ADB Secretariat offices are located; and
- Other locations as determined by the host country in consultation with ADB.

Recommended Actions

The following are recommended actions to be taken by the host country agencies involved in providing security support to the annual meeting in full consultation with the ADB security coordinator.

Communication and Organization

Establish a single, fluent English-speaking point of contact at a senior level within the host country for planning and coordinating all security matters, including but not limited to

- security for ADB annual meeting venue and others,
- airport and hotel security,
- VIP security and protocol,
- traffic,
- law and order,
- security of accompanying persons, and
- emergency and pandemic situations.





Establish an MACC with communications capability staffed by a senior officer on-site for coordinating and directing site security during the entire event. This should include a police liaison officer inside the MACC at least 1 week prior to the annual meeting.

Establish a security operations center with an emergency contact number for all delegates, open 24 hours a day. Inform all participants of emergency contact procedures. The security operations center could be colocated within the MACC.

Clearly delineate responsibilities between venue security personnel and host country security agencies and personnel and inform ADB about what these are.

Attend daily security advisory meetings with ADB during the annual meeting. This daily meeting is held each day from the date of arrival of the ADB President until their date of departure.

All incidents involving non-ADB participants, such as caterers, convention center staff, technicians, audiovisual contractors, interpreters, janitors, florists, and entertainers, shall be communicated to the relevant authorities.

Physical Security Control Measures

- Establish physical security control measures to be implemented during the meeting, including perimeter security around the venue and security within all venues and at the Registration Center.
- ADB security together with that of the host country will conduct a walk-through prior to the annual meeting and report on the result to the ADB annual meeting coordinator.
- Ensure consistent screening of individuals and vehicles at outer perimeter checkpoints.
- Determine technical security measures required and/or available. X-ray machines and walk-through metal detectors are minimum security screening requirements for all meeting and networking event venues.
- Technical screening officers should be consistent in their performance and have clear, consistent conflict resolution procedures to ensure smooth flow of participant access.
- Ensure the professionalism of private security personnel responsible for access control and security screening (if any).
- Clearly identify all entry and exit points, safe-haven sites, on-site shelters, evacuation routes, emergency assembly areas, and traffic and pedestrian routes.
- Produce an electronic file of the emergency evacuation plan to be posted on the annual meeting website and official app.
- Plan and inform ADB how on-site ADB physical assets will be protected.
- Ensure that adequate security remains in place following the closure of the annual meeting to safeguard personnel and assets.

Access Control

- Determine the access control points and how they are defined, marked, and controlled.
- Determine the procedures to be used in dealing with demonstrators, protestors, and interruptions inside and outside of the venues.

- Identify all entry and exit points and any specific points of vulnerability on a floor plan. Identify countermeasures to secure these areas.
- Determine access to the Registration Center.
- Determine what credentials and IDs will be used for nonregistered participants, in particular VIP invitees who are not registered and for staff working at the venue.
- Determine how the credentials and IDs will be controlled and how access to the venue will be provided.
- Have clear conflict resolution procedures in place to resolve credential discrepancies quickly.
- Determine the physical search policy at access points.
- Determine vehicle access areas and the policy on delivery vehicles and the screening of delivered goods.
- Determine access to be provided to private or hired vehicles used by participants, process for screening vehicles and drivers, and process of distributing vehicle access stickers.

Information Technology Security

- In consultation with the ADB head of annual meeting IT coordinator, develop measures to protect sensitive annual meeting information from illegal or unauthorized collection.
- Determine whether there is a need for an electronic countermeasures sweep to be conducted before events, or any specific room associated with events. If so, after the sweep, the room must be secured and access tightly controlled.
- Allow ADB to clean all data of computers used by ADB personnel.

VIP Protection

- In consultation with ADB, identify any VIPs who may require special personal protection. Final determination of such a requirement through a security risk assessment and the provision of close protection to any individual is the sole responsibility of the host country.
- Ensure adequate security presence is deployed at VIP areas in the airport, hotels, and meeting venues.
- In the event of ceremonial visits to the annual meeting venue, or other occasions on which the host country customs or security arrangements might deviate from security procedures agreed upon for the annual meeting, ADB should be consulted and involved in security planning and coordination of such events.

Risk Identification

- Identify risks and discuss with ADB options for mitigating them.
- Determine whether there are potential terrorist or other security threats.
- In consultation with ADB, establish a mechanism to monitor and share information on threats and risks through host country agencies, law enforcement, websites, and newspapers.
- Determine how the risks will continue to be monitored and how information about them will be disseminated once the meeting begins.
- Determine if any other major events will coincide with the annual meeting.





Emergencies and Contingencies

- Prepare fully tested emergency and disaster management contingency plans with standby teams ready to respond in the event of an emergency or security threat (e.g., fire, medical, explosive ordinance disposal, terrorist threat via vehicle, parcel, letter, or suicide bomb). If the emergency occurs while participants are on tour, additional emergency and disaster management contingency plans should be required specific to scenarios such as (i) a participant goes missing, (ii) a tour vehicle is involved in a major or minor accident, (iii) a participant is robbed, or (iv) a participant has a medical emergency.
- Conduct health, safety, and security inspections before and during the annual meeting. These inspections/ walk-throughs should be conducted the night before the opening of registration or earlier. Responsibility of the walk-through will be with the ADB security coordinator and the security focal point of the host country.
- Install and test emergency communications systems at all venues and provide access to the system to the ADB security coordinator.
- Determine, define, and control emergency routes into and out of the main event area.
- Ensure that a crisis management system is in place at the meeting to include a clearly defined senior management chain of command for emergency decision-making.
- Develop a plan for effective and timely emergency communication with meeting participants.
- Establish an emergency contact warden system for all hotels where participants are staying.
- Determine mechanisms for obtaining additional security and support if required.
- Ensure that a list of emergency organizations and personnel who may be necessary in the event of an emergency is maintained in the security operations center.
- Prepare a contingency evacuation plan and draw up an immediate action response plan to address where to assemble in the event of an emergency during the annual meeting.
- Ensure that the capability exists on-site to provide emergency and trauma medical first aid (i.e., first response).
- Identify a safe location, away from the venue, to which VIPs can be quickly transferred. If necessary, identify an alternative annual meeting venue.
- Provide outpatient medical facilities at meeting venues and hotels where ADB annual meeting participants will stay.

Timeline of Tasks Related to Security and Traffic Control

Task	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
Discuss general security requirements with ADB	11
Continue consultations with ADB security coordinator	9
Provide plan of security perimeter, access and drop-off points, and traffic flow	6
Determine security measures and access for service vehicles, deliveries	6
Present security plan, including emergency evacuation, to ADB head of security	4
Discuss security scenarios with ADB security coordinator	4
Provide telephone numbers for emergency information	1
Design color-coded badges for local staff and police access to restricted areas such as the Governors' lounge	1
Meet with ADB security advisory committee every day during annual meeting	Month of the annual meeting



CHAPTER 14

MEDICAL AND HEALTH REQUIREMENTS

Overview

The host country is responsible for medical and health management across all venues, hotels, and transport used during the annual meeting. All planning for medical and health management must be done through consultation with ADB to ensure that the specific requirements across all ADB- and country-hosted events are met. Communication between the ADB medical coordinator and the HOC medical coordinator should be continuous beginning 9 months before the meeting until its conclusion.

Medical Facilities at Venues

The following should be arranged by the HOC.

- A medical center is staffed by a doctor and registered nurse, plus one backup nurse, between 8:00 a.m. and 6:00 p.m. from 2 days before the opening of the meeting to the end of the meeting (i.e., days 1 to 4). The medical room is accessible for all annual meeting personnel and participants, and provides basic consultations, basic first aid treatment, and referrals to hospitals as necessary. An English interpreter may be needed if the medical personnel are not English speaking.
- A nurse is also on call after working hours, and both ADB and the host country secretariats should have this nurse's mobile phone number. A list of physicians, dentists, and optometrists who can be contacted should also be available.
- Dedicated ambulances should be made available during the annual meeting starting from the day the ADB President arrives and ending on the day of their departure. At least one advance cardiac support ambulance is on standby at the main venue. The ambulance deployment plan is made available at the MACC.
- The host country ensures that all meeting venues and hotels are equipped with first aid kits and automated electrical defibrillators, and basic life support-trained personnel are available at all times.
- All official transport vehicles must be equipped with first aid kits and all drivers are trained with basic first aid and basic life support.



Designated Medical Facilities Outside Venues

The following should be ensured by the HOC.

- The host country recommends primary, secondary, and tertiary medical facilities close to the meeting venues that are capable of handling medical, surgical, and trauma emergency. The facilities must have a capable 24-hour emergency department, surgical theater, and high-capacity intensive care units.
- The host country should make an agreement with the medical facilities for dedicated emergency room access and intensive care unit beds for VIP delegates.
- Medical facility personnel must be able to communicate in English and have experience working with international health insurances.
- The host country facilitates the ADB medical coordinator visit to the medical facilities in one of the pre-annual meeting missions.
- Arrangements must be made with the designated hospital so all properly identified delegates are prioritized. Referrals are made by the professional medical staff at the medical center.
- Arrangements should be made with a local clinic for nonemergency care that cannot be administered at the medical center.

Medical Emergency

- The host country develops a medical emergency response plan in cooperation with the security plan. The medical emergency response plan should include
 - a 24-hour English-speaking medical emergency hotline,
 - the medical commander,
 - an ambulance deployment plan,
 - contact details of the designated medical facilities,
 - a medical evacuation plan, and
 - reporting lines.
- The host country provides a 24-hour English-speaking medical emergency hotline.
- The host country should appoint a senior medical person as a member of the MACC who will act as the medical commander in case of medical emergency.
- The medical emergency response plan should be bridged with the public mass casualty plan.
- In case international medical evacuation is recommended, the host country provides full support and coordination for the evacuation.
- The ADB medical coordinator should be reported to for all medical emergency cases on the agreed timeline.

Health Insurance

All ADB staff and dependents are insured under Cigna Health Insurance with full international coverage for any health conditions arising during the annual meeting. All other annual meeting delegates and participants are requested to have travel insurance or health insurance covering medical expenses that may arise during the annual meeting.

The host country is responsible for checking the required health/travel insurance depending on the specific country's rules and regulations.

Health Communication

The host country provides medical and health requirements and advice to all participants via email, messages, official app, and annual meeting website. The medical and health advice should include health requirements (if any) for traveling to the country, and/or access to the annual meeting venue, any pertinent current public health advisories (such as requirements to wear face masks), information on medical services available during the annual meeting, the medical emergency hotline, and other health-related services.

Any medical cases and health-related issues are reported in the daily security briefing.

Consultation with ADB

In connection with the host country's security arrangements, the ADB medical coordinator must be consulted and fully advised on all ongoing medical arrangements. The medical coordinator in turn discusses with the host country medical and health authorities any relevant details of arrangements. The medical coordinator also keeps the ADB Secretary and the ADB annual meeting coordinator fully informed on all medical and health-related matters.

Timeline of Tasks Related to Medical and Health Requirements

Task	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
Discuss general health requirements with ADB	11
Continue consultations with ADB medical coordinator	9
Host country appoints primary, secondary, and tertiary medical facilities near the venue and facilitates visit of ADB	7
Present health emergency response plan to ADB health coordinator	4
Establish the medical center 2 days before the opening until the end of the meeting	Month of the annual meeting
Meet with ADB medical coordinator every day during annual meeting	Month of the annual meeting



CHAPTER 15

BRANDING



Overview

The development and execution of the annual meeting brand is a collaborative effort between ADB and the host country. ADB has guidelines for how the ADB logo and annual meeting icon are developed and applied, including the use of color, by those engaged in assisting the marketing and promotion of the annual meeting, such as those providing design, creative, print, and graphics services. The following serves as an approximate guide, as the creative look and feel of each meeting will vary from one host country to another.

Branding and Its Importance to the Event

Annual meeting branding plays a significant part in promoting the meeting as a preeminent event for ADB, governments, and other development partners to attend and discuss relevant issues affecting Asia and the Pacific. Branding should be visible on the annual meeting website, relevant social media accounts, multimedia materials, as well as printed materials and collateral in and around the venue area.

Meetings with exceptional brand value that stands out on a global stage will attract prominent development experts, renowned speakers, partners and sponsors, as well as international and local media.

ADB's DOCK is the custodian of the event brand and provides institutional knowledge for the event on branding concerns.



Signages and banners welcome delegates to the 57th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Tbilisi, Georgia.

Annual Meeting Branding

When developing brand positioning, it is best to see the event through the eyes of the delegates, from their first exposure to the brand, their arrival at the airport, checking in to their hotel, registration, and participation in the various events.

Indicators of effective branding include the following:

- consistent application of graphic elements from the smallest to the largest materials, across both printed materials and digital platforms;
- branding presence in public areas such as airports, hotels, roads leading to the venue, the venue exterior, and adjoining establishments;
- sufficient digital signage and printed maps, including directional signs within the venue and in the immediate external areas and entrances, especially for a venue with multiple points of entry;
- consistent use on event collaterals such as delegate bags, merchandise items, and host country-developed materials; and
- close coordination with commercial stakeholders in and around the venue area such as malls, hotels, and transport companies.

Logo

The annual meeting logo is composed of three main and three supporting graphic elements.



The three main elements are:

ADB logo. The ADB logo is essential to the overall branding of the event. It clearly indicates the primary purpose of the event—the annual meeting of ADB’s Board of Governors. As such, the ADB logo must appear with the event icon in all materials. Its color is fixed, as is the font and form of the logo. This cannot be modified.

Event icon. The event icon is owned by the host country. It is usually derived from a cultural facet. When designing the event icon, be mindful of using



ADB BLUE
Pantone 281C

CMYK:	RGB:
C=100	R=0
M=89	G=37
Y=28	B=105
K=27	

Blue is an essential feature of the ADB brand identity.

The ADB logo color is Pantone 281C (except in black-and-white application). To ensure that the logo is always clearly defined and distinct from its surroundings, this shade is NOT part of the main and accent color palettes. NEVER use the logo on an ADB Blue background.



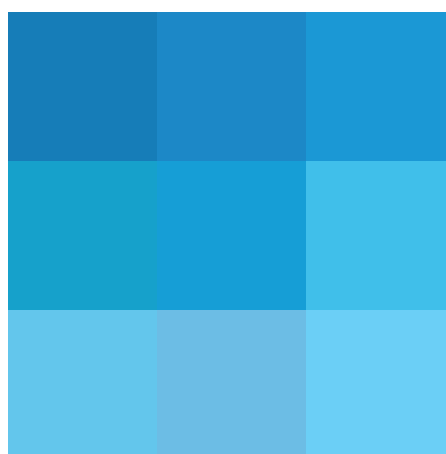
illustrations that can be used in small executions. It is best to retain a simple design that is culturally relevant and colorful. The ADB logo and event icon represent the partnership between ADB and the host country.

Event wordmark. The wordmark should contain the following in descending order of visual dominance: (i) the host city; (ii) reference to the ADB annual meeting; and (iii) the date of the event, including the year.

The three supporting elements are:

Graphic or color background. The background color and graphic motif are decided upon by the host country. ADB has a corporate color palette, which can be used as reference. The background color should accentuate and complement the ADB logo and event icon, and designers should be mindful that the background color will appear differently in print and digital media. The graphic motif should be simple; if it is intricate, fade the design to ensure the ADB logo and event icon remain prominent.

C=100 R=0 M=20 G=125 Y=0 B=183 K=20 PP 227-1	C=100 R=0 M=20 G=136 Y=0 B=199 K=10 PP 226-1	C=100 R=0 M=13 G=153 Y=1 B=216 K=2 P Process Blue
C=70 R=0 M=0 G=161 Y=0 B=203 K=20 PP 234-3	C=75 R=0 M=15 G=159 Y=0 B=214 K=5 PP 226-4	C=60 R=65 M=0 G=190 Y=0 B=232 K=5 PP 233-4
C=50 R=104 M=0 G=197 Y=0 B=234 K=5 PP 233-5	C=50 R=109 M=5 G=188 Y=0 B=227 K=5 PP 226-6	C=50 R=109 M=0 G=207 Y=0 B=246 K=0 PP 232-5



THE MAIN COLOR PALETTE is made up of shades of blue. These are the identifying colors of ADB and should be used whenever possible.

The main color palette includes the use of tints ranging from 50%–100%. However, to maintain color intensity, tints below 50% should not be used.

C=98 R=0 M=0 G=165 Y=10 B=210 K=5 P 639C	C=50 R=141 M=0 G=198 Y=100 B=63 K=0 P 376C	C=3 R=233 M=83 G=83 Y=95 B=43 K=0 P 179C
C=82 R=0 M=0 G=182 Y=23 B=201 K=0 P 3125 C	C=26 R=200 M=0 G=218 Y=100 B=43 K=0 P 382C	C=0 R=245 M=62 G=127 Y=95 B=41 K=0 P 158C
C=54 R=99 M=0 G=204 Y=4 B=236 K=0 P 2985C	C=5 R=242 M=0 G=230 Y=100 B=0 K=2 P 3965C	C=0 R=253 M=32 G=181 Y=100 B=21 K=0 P 130C



THE ACCENT COLOR PALETTE was chosen to complement and support the main palette. Whenever possible, these colors should be used in combination with the main color palette.

In limited instances, the accent color palette may also use tints ranging from 50% to 100%. However, to maintain color intensity, tints below 50% should not be used.

Event details. This is used to provide context for some branding materials but only when required.

Font. The official font of ADB and the annual meeting is a custom-purchased font called Ideal Sans, which has over 20 styles and thickness, allowing a wide range of variations. The use of the font is mandatory for copyright purposes. Copies of the font can be requested from DOCK.

Future Host Country Booth and Event

The future host country booth and related event, along with any promotional materials, serve as the first opportunity to showcase the next year's annual meeting to delegates. The booth design and event plans must be coordinated with and shared in advance with ADB.



The Future Host Country Event “Milan 2025” was held during the 57th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Tbilisi, Georgia. *Left:* Francesca Utili (seated, right), Italy’s Head of International Financial Relations at the Ministry of Economy and Finance and Alternate Governor for Italy in ADB, and the Secretary of ADB Asel Djusupbekova sign the joint declaration of intent to cooperate for the hosting of the ADB Annual Meeting in Milan, Italy in May 2025. They are joined by the then President of ADB Masatsugu Asakawa (standing, left) and the Italian Ambassador to Georgia Massimiliano D’Antuono. *Right:* The Mayor of Milan Giuseppe Sala addresses participants.

Website

The annual meeting logo is used on the annual meeting website pages on the ADB website, www.adb.org. A few days before the event, the annual meeting website becomes the home page of www.adb.org. Previous annual meeting websites are accessible at <http://www.adb.org/annual-meeting>.



Coordination

The focal points for branding from ADB and the host country will coordinate closely. They are involved in the following missions:

Establishment mission. Usually held 12 months prior to the meeting, this mission allows for initial inspection of the venue and discussions with focal points on various issues, including material and execution for event branding.

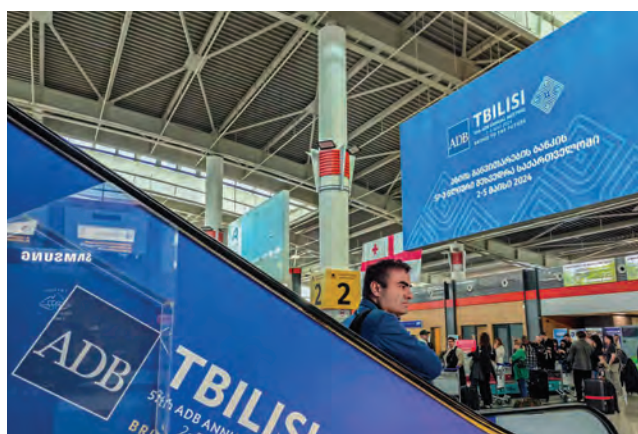
Technical mission. Usually held 4 months prior to the meeting, this mission is an opportunity for working-level discussions with suppliers and production focal points, and detailed planning of material placements. During the technical mission, a signage walk-through of the venue is done to ensure delegates can navigate through the venue easily.

Signs and Banners

Event signs and banners are considered necessary print material, though whenever possible, digital technology, such as internet protocol TV (IPTV) or digital screens, should be used. Specific areas that require signs and banners include the airport, hotels, transit and transport areas and vehicles, and external and internal areas of the venue.

Suppliers

In keeping with the annual meeting's sustainability objectives, it is recommended that, when possible, only local suppliers are contracted to print or create materials, and the host country is to coordinate the procurement process and production. ADB can assist in artwork preparation and advise on technology and quality of supplier candidates.



Signages and banners welcome delegates to the 57th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Tbilisi, Georgia.

Host Country Role

The host country

- prepares a plan for the signs required in all the venues,
- indicates the numbers of each type of sign required and exactly where they will be placed,
- prints the signs in accordance with the annual meeting branding guidelines,
- installs all signs in and around the venues at the locations agreed with ADB,
- changes signs as necessary (e.g., between meetings), and
- takes down signs after the event.

Co-Branding and Sponsors

Partners and sponsors play a significant role in promoting the annual meeting. ADB allows co-branding with partners and sponsors, provided that ADB clearance is given. ADB must ensure consistent use of the annual meeting logos by all partners and sponsors.

The use of the annual meeting and ADB logos for commercial or promotional purposes is not permitted and should not be used with private sector sponsor logos as a means of endorsement. DOCK should be looped in on the production and design of all annual meeting-related materials.

Timeline of Tasks Related to Branding

Task	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
Host country begins to develop the annual meeting logo and theme	18
Selected design is shared with ADB for comments	15
Host country participates in the annual meeting the year before they host through a host country booth and a host country event	12
Begin using logo on promotional materials and website	12
Host country develops the annual meeting branding guidelines and shares with ADB for comments	12
Technical mission to the venue and meeting of relevant suppliers	4
Begin production of event materials	3
Installation of event materials	Month of the annual meeting



CHAPTER 16

MEETING SETUPS



Overview

Space at the annual meeting venue is limited and priority is given to the needs of ADB and host country offices, seminars, and meetings. As much as possible, meeting rooms are also made available for Governors. It is usually not possible to accommodate requests for meeting rooms from other organizations, private companies, and banks. If ADB receives such requests, the requestor is asked to communicate directly with the HOC to book a meeting or function room in a suitable hotel on their behalf.

The host country appoints a space manager to oversee the setups in each part of the venue where there are meetings or seminar rooms. If these rooms are spread out in different buildings or far apart inside the venue, a different space manager should oversee each area, with a team of technicians and staff to prepare the setups.

ADB handles room assignments and prepares a report on all the meeting room requirements, in coordination with the HOC. The HOC confirms if the turnaround time for the next scheduled meeting is sufficient and allows ADB to perform a pre-function check of the lighting, ventilation, facilities, signs, equipment, technicians, and arrangements for cleaning. All equipment and other meeting requirements should be provided and checked in advance and each room should be set up and checked 30 minutes before the next meeting.

OFFICES

Occupancy Requirement					ITD				Catering		
Location (Level)	Room	Office		Estimated Occupants	Printer	Laptop	Monitor	Others	Schedule	Order	Refreshment Setting Time
South Hall Level 0	Media Center	Media Center	1	250							
South Hall Level 0	Space Room 1 and Space Room 2	NGO and Civil Society Center									
South Hall Level 0	Exhibition Area	Sponsor/Exhibition Area									

EVENTS MEETING ROOMS

Building Level	Room	Room Capacity	Event/ Meeting Room	Number of Pax	Schedule	Room Layout	Layout Change Next Day	AV/IT Requirements and Furniture	Interpretation
		744 m ²	ASEAN+3 Deputies' Meeting	200		Hollow square with backseater	Yes	TECH SPEC DETAILED in PDF	Yes
		200 m ²	ADB Seminar 1			U-shape with observers	No	TECH SPEC DETAILED in PDF	
		200 m ²	ADB Seminar 2			U-shape with observers	No	TECH SPEC DETAILED in PDF	

Sample Room Utilization Table for the general layout of offices and events meeting rooms.

Floor Plans and Layout

Floor plans and layouts are an effective way to allocate room space and plan furniture and equipment in the meeting venue. The floor plans show the locations of offices and meeting and function rooms in relation to the meeting venue and give directions to the participants. The host country provides accurate, updated architectural plans of all room venues for each meeting, in consultation with ADB.

A room utilization table is maintained by ADB to support the floor plans, furniture, and service requirements of each room for the annual meeting.

Audiovisual, Technical, and Simultaneous Interpretation Requirements

Refer to Chapter 6: Information and Conference Technology for detailed audiovisual, technical, and simultaneous interpretation requirements.

General Requirements for Speakers and Panelists

- Identical drinking water and glasses
- Desk nameplates with lettering on both sides
- Writing pads, pens, and pencils



Timeline of Tasks Related to Meeting Setups

Task	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
Agree on overall allocation of meeting and office rooms	11
Submit proposed layouts and plans of ADB offices and meeting areas	10
Agree with ADB on final space allocation and layouts	7
Submit final floor plans for reproduction	5
Agree on turnaround time for meeting and seminar rooms	5
Agree on exact setup and dismantling dates	3
Appoint space managers to oversee each venue where meetings and events will take place	3
Ensure that all meeting spaces are set up in accordance with requirements 30 minutes before the meeting or event for checking	Month of the annual meeting

Meeting Room Requirements Summary

Event	Estimated Attendance	Floor Area per Room (m ²)	No. of Rooms
Opening session	1,500	2,500	1
VIP holding room before opening session, Governors' seminar, and other events	6	50	1
Business session	650	1,800	1
ADB President's press conference	200	450	1
Media briefing room	200	450	1
Constituency and subregional meetings	50	200	5
Subregional and trilateral meetings, AFE-ADB annual general meeting	50–100	200	2
CSOs' panel discussions	150	250	1
CSOs' meeting with ADB management	200	350	1
Meeting room for seminar coordinators and speakers	12	50	2
Host country seminars	700	700	1
Governors' plenary (Governors' lounge can be used)	70	300	1
ADB seminar series	200–250	350	3
Sponsored seminars	200	350	2
ASEAN+3 finance ministers' meeting	140	950	1
ASEAN+3 finance deputies' meeting	140	950	1
Press conference for ASEAN+3 finance ministers' meeting	150	450	1
ASEAN+3 secretariat room	20	50	1
Treasury Department/Private Sector Department cocktail reception/s	200	300	1
AFE-ADB cocktail reception	120–160	300	1
Media reception	200	300	1
ADB President's reception	1,500	2,500	1
Evening reception by host country	3,000	3,000	1
Luncheon for Governors	250	300	1

Requirements for Official Event Setups

Opening session. The opening session is a high-profile event where the Chair of the Board of Governors, GOH, and the ADB President address and welcome all the annual meeting participants. Requirements include the following:

- Minimum room size of 2,500 m²
- Stage and staging area
- Four uniform, padded, high-back swivel armchairs for office bearers
- One head table
- Two lecterns with 40 cm² ADB logo (provided by ADB) and 1 lectern with host country logo for GOH, each with 1 microphone
- One speech prompter, sourced by ADB
- Flagpoles with stands for the host country and ADB flags
- Six simultaneous interpretation headsets
- Extra chairs at the wings of the stage
- One table and three chairs for the speech prompter operator, technician, and DOCK staff in an enclosed area behind the stage, near the ADB President's lectern but hidden from the audience view. Area should have a direct view of the ADB President while they deliver their speech. It should have a power outlet and space to accommodate a laptop and a scroller.
- Simultaneous interpretation facility with a minimum of 500 headsets (1,200 if GOH speaks in a language other than English)
- About 1,500 seats for the audience
- Freestanding signs to identify each seating block: Governors and HODS, Alternate Governors and temporary Alternate Governors, advisors, observers, special guests, guests, NGOs and CSOs, media, special invitees, diplomatic and consular corps, local dignitaries, ADB Board, and ADB staff
- If necessary, stanchions to cordon off certain areas
- VIP holding area with appropriate furniture
- Facilities for the reception party and reception line
- Technical rehearsals are held at the venue, with a final run-through the day before the session. All light and sound technicians should be present.
- The speech prompter setup and lectern remain in place until after the ADB President's opening session speech. Cultural presentations and other parts of the program must work around the setup.
- If the opening session is in a different venue to the main venue, a registration counter, including stanchions, and a transport desk and paging system should be provided.
- Optional additional required equipment may include chairs for a band, orchestra, or choir, uniforms for ushers, and four armchairs and coffee tables.

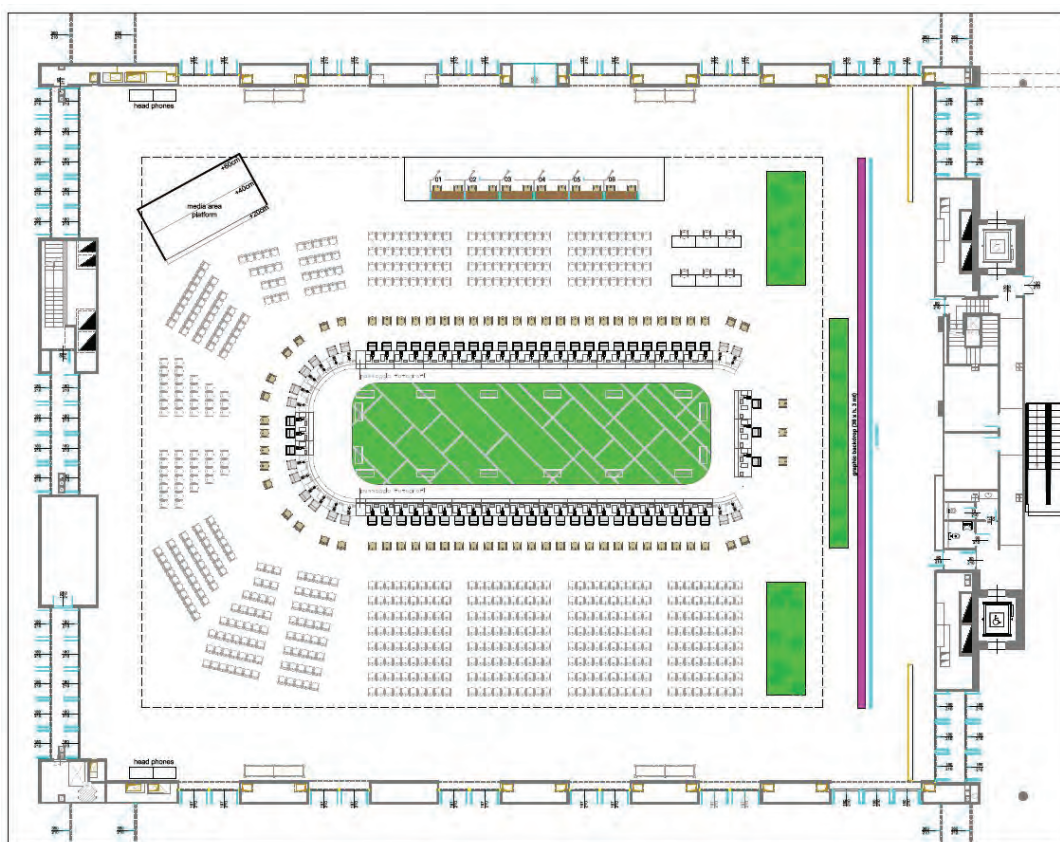
Business session. The Governors' formal business at the annual meeting is conducted in the business session where they adopt resolutions; take note of and approve documents related to the business, finance, administration, and operations of ADB; and provide guidance and direction to the institution through statements. Requirements include the following:

- Main room with a room size of 1,800 m²
- A backup room to serve as an alternative venue in the event the main room becomes unavailable



- Flagpoles with stands for the host country and ADB flags
- Table/s forming a hollow rectangle with a head table for 10
- Gavel and block for the Chair provided by ADB plus 2 additional sets of gavels and blocks also provided by ADB for the Vice-Chairs, to be presented by the ADB President at the closing
- Decorations inside the hollow table, which should not block the view of Governors across the hollow or impede video recording
- Order of speakers for the session at the head table
- Nameplates for member countries and members of the head table provided by ADB
- Padded, uniform, low-back swivel armchairs for about 350 delegates, arranged around the hollow rectangle. Each Governor is given a seat at the table. The table is surrounded by seats for Alternate Governors and advisors.
- Additional seating in a separate part of the room for about 200 observers, guests, media, and CSOs
- For the ADB Secretariat, a table for two behind the ADB Secretary and to the right of ADB staff, with a computer connected to the internet. There should also be eight chairs with writing armrests on the left side behind the head table.
- The venue, including audio and video equipment, should be set up and a dry run conducted the day before the business session.

Governors' Business Session

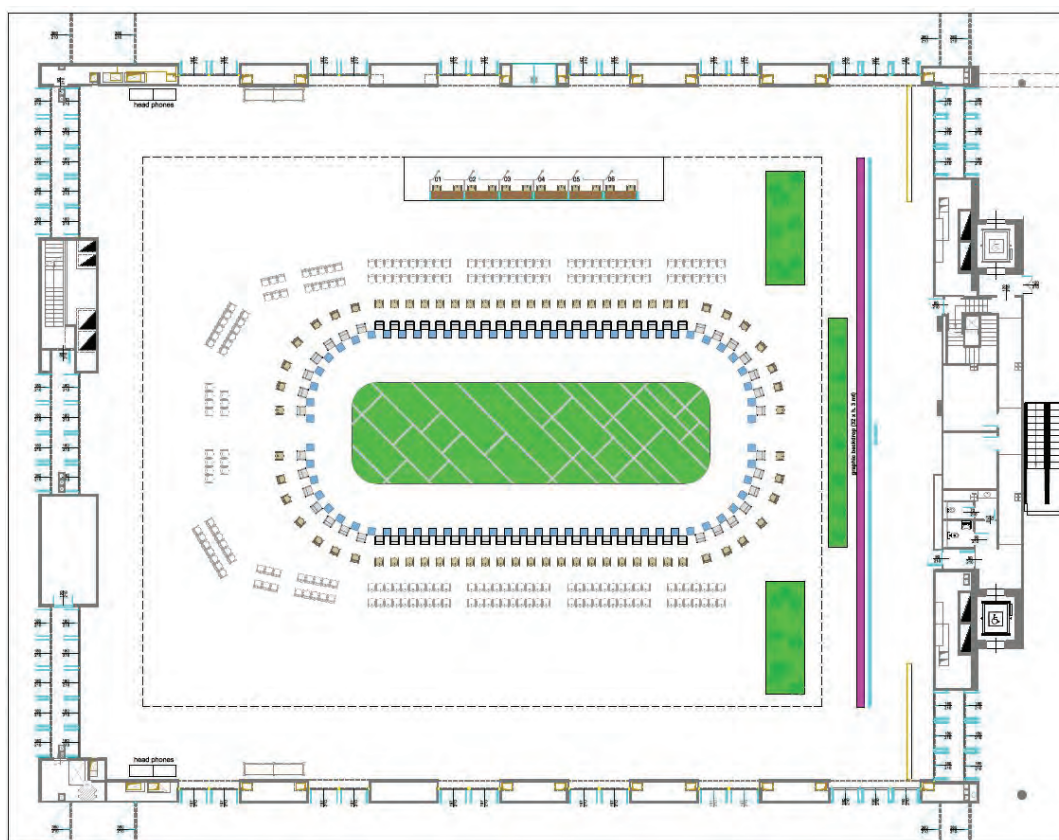


Layout for the Governor's Business Session at the Annual Meeting 2025 in Milan, Italy.

Governors' plenary. The Governors' plenary provides an opportunity for Governors to engage with their peers in a closed door, free-flowing dialogue on a topic selected by the ADB President. Requirements include the following:

- Room size approximately 300 m²
- 65–70 comfortable chairs
- Coffee tables in between the chairs, with nameplates, drinking water, and drinking glasses
- Nameplates for member countries provided by ADB
- If necessary, stanchions to cordon off certain areas
- Ten chairs for observers (senior management and Secretariat)
- Two rectangular refreshment tables inside the room with snacks, coffee, tea, and drinking water
- Two to four waiters to assist with refreshments

Governors' Plenary



Layout for the Governor's Plenary at the Annual Meeting 2025 in Milan, Italy.

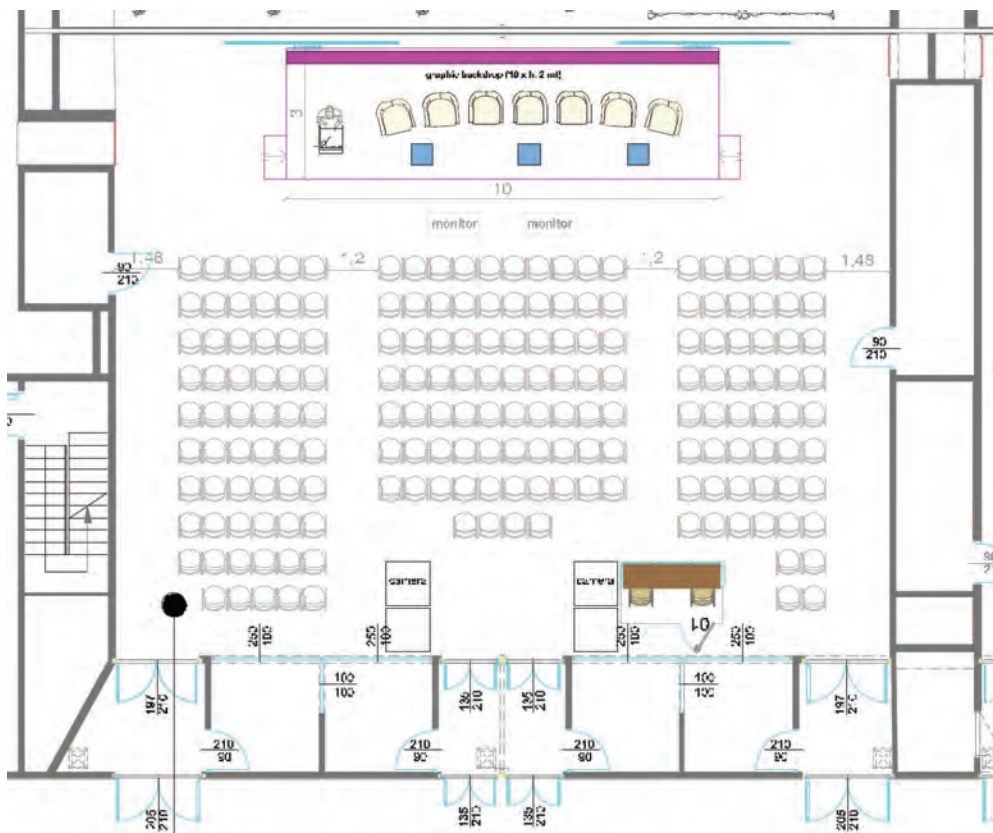
ADB President's press conference. The ADB President gives an opening press conference on topical issues, to set the agenda for the annual meeting. Requirements include the following:

- Room size approximately 450 m² for 200–250 persons attending, plus 250 theater-style seats for journalists
- Raised platform, with steps on the sides, with head table for the ADB President and moderator



- Sufficient space with platforms offering vantage view for TV crews and photographers
- Bottled water, drinking glasses, paper, and pens for head table
- By the main entrance, a small table with tray or fish bowl to collect business cards

Seminar Rooms



Sample layout for seminar rooms at the Annual Meeting 2025 in Milan, Italy.

Other official meetings. Many other official meetings take place during the annual meeting including the following:

- Constituency meetings, Board of Directors events, and delegation meetings.** The meetings are opportunities for the members of each ADB Board constituency to meet and update each other on activities over the past year, and any concerns or issues relating to ADB. Requirements are a minimum of five rooms, each 200 m², equipped with one table seating 25–30 persons, with room for another 10 chairs at the sides, and a refreshment table inside the room with coffee, tea, drinking water, and snacks.

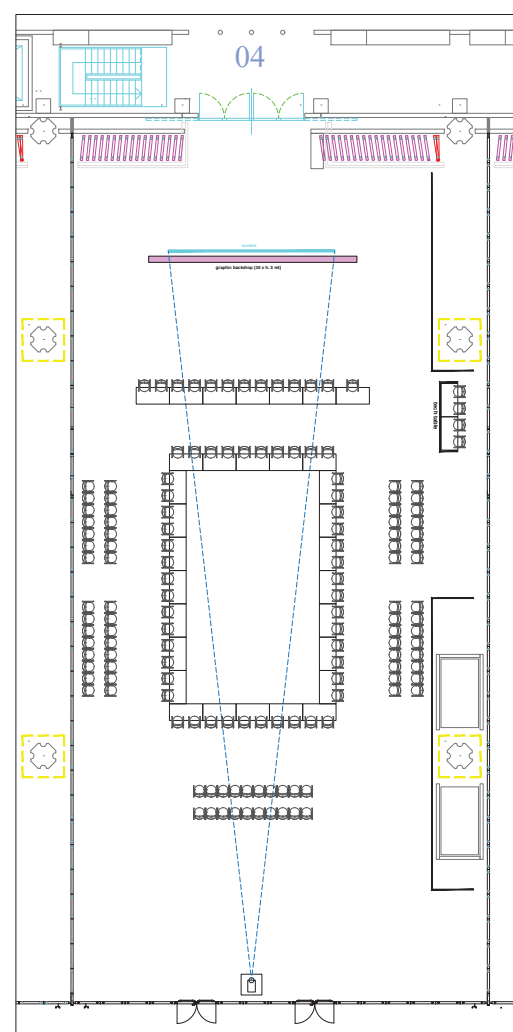
(ii) **Asian Development Fund Donors' Meeting.**

Representatives from donor countries meet with ADB to discuss the replenishment of the fund and other related matters. Requirements include the following:

- Room size of around 450 m²
- Head table for eight persons (Chair, ADB management, and staff)
- Hollow rectangular table for 30 donor country delegates and a second row of chairs
- 43 table microphones
- PowerPoint setup
- Digital recording
- Registration table
- Country nameplates provided by ADB
- Physical setup for snacks and cocktail tables

(iii) **Meeting of Pacific Developing Member Countries' Governors (subregional meeting).** This meeting precedes their meeting with ADB management. Requirements include the following:

- Approximate room size of 200 m² for 60–70 persons
- Hollow rectangular table with six chairs at head table, eight chairs on the opposite side for directors and alternate directors, 14 chairs each on longer sides of the table (42 chairs total)
- Second rows of 12 chairs each on the longer sides of the table and four chairs on the shorter side facing the head table (28 chairs total)
- 22 table microphones
- PowerPoint setup
- Sound system with digital recording
- Registration table near the entrance
- Refreshment station inside room with coffee, tea, chilled mineral water, and snacks
- Country nameplates provided by ADB

Asian Development Fund Donors' Meeting

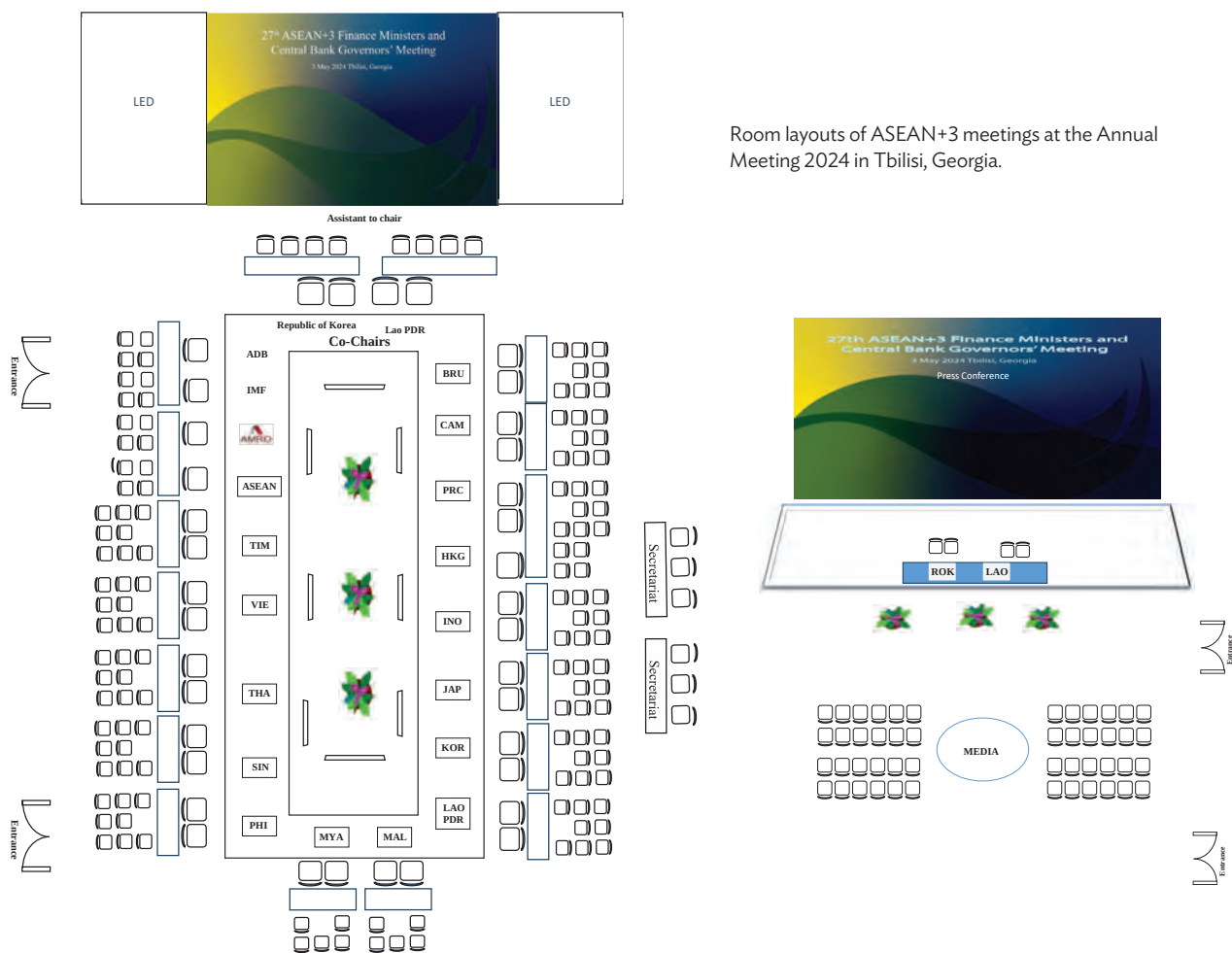
Sample room layout for Asian Development Fund Donors' Meeting



(iv) **ASEAN+3 side events.** These comprise two meetings, a finance ministers' meeting, including a press conference, and a finance deputy ministers' meeting organized by the ASEAN Secretariat. Since the ADB President also attends this meeting, a venue should be found as close to the meeting venue as possible. The organizer contacts the venue representative and caterer directly to discuss requirements and payment details. The following is required:

- Room size of around 950 m², for all
- For the finance deputy ministers' meeting, a rectangular-shape seating arrangement for 100 persons, comprising 30 persons at the main table and 70 persons in back seats
- For the finance ministers' meeting, a rectangular-shape seating arrangement for 90 persons, comprising 15 persons at the main table and 75 persons in back seats
- For the press conference, seminar-style seating arrangement for 100 persons
- A secretariat office with room size of 50 m²

ASEAN+3 Room Requirements



Room layouts of ASEAN+3 meetings at the Annual Meeting 2024 in Tbilisi, Georgia.

ADB = Asian Development Bank; AMRO = ASEAN+3 Macroeconomic Research Office; ASEAN = Association of Southeast Asian Nations; BRU = Brunei Darussalam; CAM = Cambodia; PRC = People's Republic of China; HKG = Hong Kong, China; IMF = International Monetary Fund; INO = Indonesia; JAP = Japan; KOR = Republic of Korea; Lao PDR = Lao People's Democratic Republic; MAL = Malaysia; MYA = Myanmar; PHI = Philippines; SIN = Singapore; THA = Thailand; TIM = Timor-Leste.

- (v) **Other subregional, bilateral, or tripartite meetings.** These include the Meeting of Three Country Ministers—the People’s Republic of China, Japan, and the Republic of Korea, loan signings, and multilateral development bank coordination meetings. All space, furniture, and technical requirements are discussed in detail during ADB missions.

Requirements for Seminar Programs

ADB seminars. The ADB seminars are ideally located close to the entrance of the meeting venue. The limited number of dedicated rooms means that turnaround time is short, so room layouts should be kept similar. Requirements include the following:

- 3 large, dedicated rooms with a size of 350 m², theater-style
- elevated stage/podium with appropriate lighting
- lectern with microphone
- 4–8 comfortable armchairs for speakers
- lapel, handheld or table microphone for each speaker
- table with nameplates, notepad, drinking water, and glasses for speakers
- plants/floral arrangement

The technical requirements include

- 2 laptops (with Microsoft Office, internet connection, and an English keyboard)
- 2 workstations with wireless mouse to support online Q&A/social media interaction with the audience
- 2 LCD projectors, 2 wide screens on the two sides of the stage, and 2 computers, or 1 if a splitter can be used to project the seminar title and list of speakers, and table for computers, if required
- 2 LCD screens, 1 facing the speakers at the head table and the other for outside the room displaying the title and speakers
- 4 handheld microphones for audience Q&A
- video and digital recording
- technician(s) in the seminar room for the duration of the seminar
- dimmable room lights
- simultaneous interpretation may be required for some seminars





Governors' seminar. This is the annual meeting flagship seminar and discusses topical issues. It is attended by the Chair of the Board of Governors, the ADB President, and selected Governors.

Requirements are the same as for the ADB seminars, with the following exceptions/additions:

- theater-style seating arrangements with 600 chairs
- small high table/bistro table onstage for moderator
- 4 laptops
- 4 workstations
- 6 handheld microphones for the audience Q&A
- webcasting
- simultaneous interpretation facilities with 600 headsets
- large video wall or large screen for digital backdrop; if not possible, physical backdrop

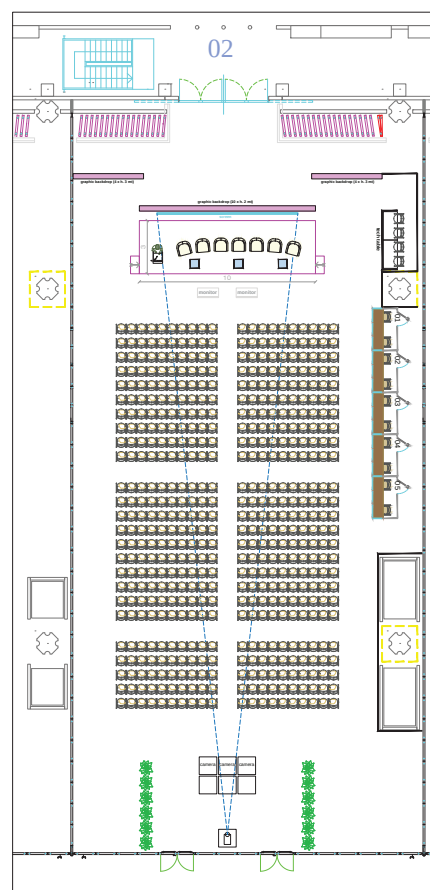
Sponsored seminars. Sponsored seminars include lunches. Equipment, supplies, and payment are coordinated and arranged directly between sponsors and vendors. They require the following setup:

- two large rooms with stages that can seat 150 persons at round tables, 8 or 10 persons per table
- screen(s) with necessary equipment for PowerPoint presentations
- handheld microphones for Q&A
- registration table outside the room

Broadcaster events. These are televised events led by DOCK. They require the following:

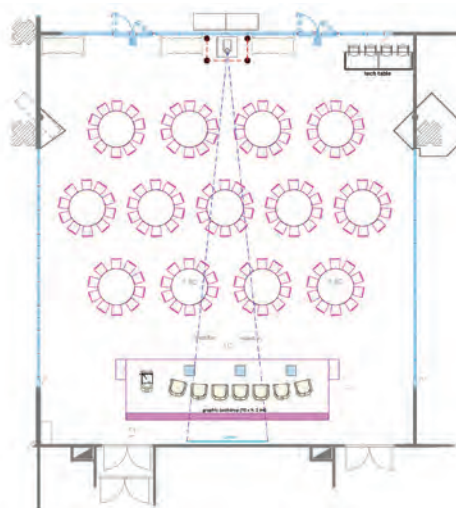
- digital backdrop with ADB, annual meeting, and media partner logos
- 5–6 seats with side tables (drinking water on tables)
- 5–6 headset microphones
- floral arrangement
- 2 microphones

Governors' Seminar



Floor layout for Governors' Seminar at the Annual Meeting 2025 in Milan, Italy.

Sponsored Seminar

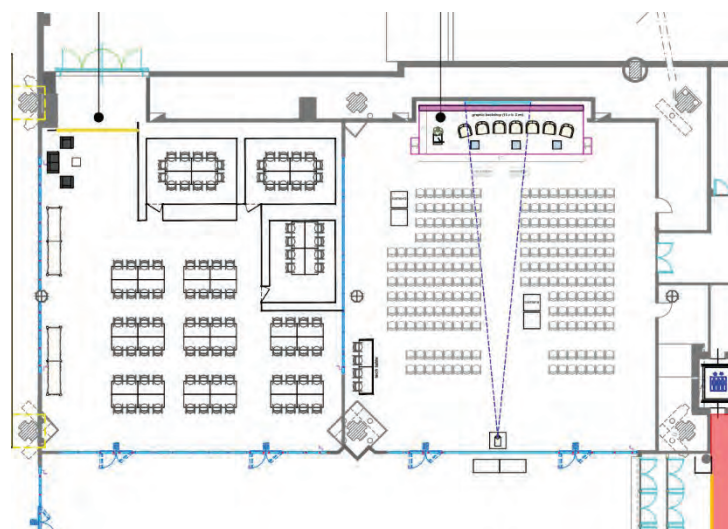


Floor layout for sponsored seminars at the Annual Meeting 2025 in Milan, Italy.

Civil Society Organizations Center. The Civil Society Center requires a room of approximately 200 m² that incorporates a lounge area for 80 people, six round cocktail tables, a publications table, and coffee, tea, chilled mineral water, and snacks for 150 persons.

Civil society panel discussions/meeting between CSOs and ADB management. These sessions require a room size of 250 m² with theater-style seating for 120–150 persons and a head table for 7 persons on an elevated platform, plus podium and lectern. A technician(s) is stationed in the room for the duration of the seminar.

Civil Society Organizations Center



Floor layout for civil society organizations center and meeting room at the Annual Meeting 2025 in Milan, Italy.

Networking Events

The ADB President's reception is the largest reception hosted by ADB during the annual meeting and is usually organized at or near the venue. An approximate room size of 2,000 m² for 1,500–2,000 persons is required, with cocktail tables. Cocktails and drinks are served.

Other smaller cocktail receptions are organized by ADB for targeted participants. These include the Treasury and Private Sector Departments cocktail reception/s, media reception, and AFE-ADB reception. These events may be held at or outside of the main meeting venue and should be held in rooms approximately 300–500 m² for 150–200 persons, with cocktail tables setup and cocktails and drinks served.

Floral Arrangements

- Floral arrangements should be able to withstand heat from the venue lights.
- During the opening session, plants should also be arranged around the lecterns to ensure that speech prompters cannot be seen.
- The height of the floral arrangement for the business session should not obstruct the speaking time control equipment and the sight lines of the participants seated around the table, i.e., be no higher than the tables. Floral arrangements should also blend with the placement of the speaking time control system.



Floral arrangements at the Annual Meeting in Incheon, Republic of Korea.

Floral/Plant Arrangement Requirements Summary

Location	Flower Arrangements	Indoor Plants
Business session	Yes	
Delegates' lounge	Yes	Yes
Governors' lounge	Yes	Yes
Observers' lounge		Yes
Sponsors' lounge		Yes
All seminar and meeting rooms		Yes
Speakers and coordinators' meeting room		Yes
Office of the Chair, Board of Governors	Yes	Yes
Office of the Secretary, Board of Governors	Yes	Yes
Office of the ADB President	Yes	Yes
Offices of the Vice-Presidents		Yes
Office of the Dean, ADB Institute		Yes
Offices of the Board of Directors (receptionists)		Yes
Offices of the Board of Directors (delegates' lounge)		Yes
Offices of the heads of departments		Yes
Registration Center		Yes
Information desks		Yes
Media interview room		Yes
TV studio		Yes
Travel/tour desk		Yes
Public areas		Yes



CHAPTER 17

STAFF SUPPORT



Overview

The host country hires local staff to support numerous tasks during the meeting such as acting as information desk hosts and airport reception desk hosts, distributing headsets, and providing administrative support. The roles may suit university students or volunteers, or a professional staffing agency may be engaged by the host country.

Logistical planning, effective briefing, and clear lines of communication between the local staff coordinator and locally engaged staff help ensure a successful annual meeting.

Local Staff Requirements

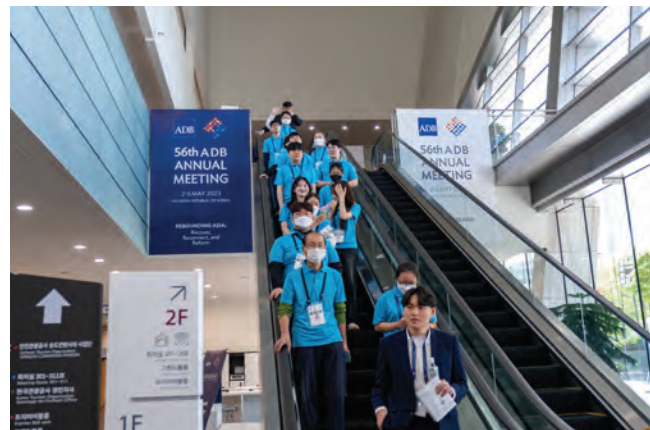
The host country provides locally engaged staff to assist their secretariat in providing meeting services both inside and outside of the annual meeting venue.

Outside the meeting venue, support is required for

- airport reception;
- transport of participants (i.e., transport coordinators, drivers, and traffic control); and
- security.

Inside the meeting venue, personnel are needed in all public spaces, some offices, and meeting rooms as

- receptionists,
- ushers,
- technicians,
- janitors, and
- security.



Locally engaged staff provided by host country to provide assistance at the Annual Meeting 2024 in Tbilisi, Georgia.



The host country also provides liaison officers to HODs and other VIPs.

Number. The number of locally engaged staff members supporting the host country secretariat varies; it may be a few hundred or over 1,000. If one or more PCO is involved in making the arrangements for the meeting, the PCO provides locally engaged staff who are already trained in carrying out the necessary tasks for the annual meeting.

Expertise. Locally engaged staff seconded to work with the host country secretariat should have the necessary expertise in their assigned positions. They must present a professional attitude, highlighted by an understanding of protocol procedures and rules applicable to dealing with international persons of high rank and stature. They must display a high level of personal presentation. They should be friendly, courteous, confident, and be able to cope with pressure.

Attire. Locally engaged staff should wear clothes that befit the occasion. The host country may wish to provide them with uniforms so that they can be easily identified as staff by the participants. Some groups, such as security, may already have uniforms, in which case a special uniform for the annual meeting is not needed.

Working hours. Locally engaged staff should dedicate their time solely to working in their assigned areas. They should be employed for the duration of the meeting rather than daily and may be required to work extended hours at short notice. The host country budget for locally engaged staff should include expenses for overtime, considering the labor laws of the host country, and for food and drinks, especially when they work overtime.

Food. There should be a system to provide food and drinks for locally engaged staff since they will not have time to leave the venue to buy food, and food is often expensive at the venue. Packed lunches may be provided by the host country, with additional meals for those working overtime. Alternatively, staff may be given vouchers to exchange for lunch in one of the food outlets at the meeting venue. If working overtime, additional vouchers may be provided if there is a food outlet on-site that can prepare the required number of meals at the right time without affecting the service provided to annual meeting participants.

Local staff coordinator. The host country appoints one person to manage all locally engaged staff. This person oversees the selection of locally engaged staff, any briefings conducted for them, and their registration, and resolves any issues that may arise during the annual meeting preparation and implementation period. If needed, the ADB annual meeting coordinator and other members of the ADB Secretariat may assist in briefing the locally engaged staff.

Registration. The host country must set up a separate registration system for locally engaged staff, together with a system for giving them access to the venue. Staff should not enter through the same doors as participants, who will have annual meeting registration badges. Appropriate security checks must be set up at this access point. IDs for locally engaged staff should have a photograph and some means of preventing easy duplication, such as a hologram.

Backup. Backup staff are required to cover emergencies such as absenteeism, tardiness, or strike. Any agreements with service providers should include a penalty for non-appearance of staff.



Scenes from the Registration Center at the 57th Annual Meeting of the Board of Governors in Tbilisi, Georgia.

Staff Supervised by the Host Country

The host country determines the number of other locally engaged staff members. Specific job descriptions are as follows:

Liaison officers. The liaison officers must speak and understand English well. They are required to travel in the car assigned to each VIP. Knowledge of the locality is an advantage. The host country may recruit student volunteers or assign government officials to serve as liaison officers. Two weeks before the annual meeting, the list of liaison officers is provided to the Board for forwarding to the ADB Governors, HODs, or designated contact persons.

About 85 liaison officers are required, comprising

- 69 for Governors and heads of delegations,
- 2 for the ADB President's office,
- 6 for ADB Vice-Presidents,
- 1 for the dean of the ADB Institute,
- 1 for the ADB Secretary, and
- 6 for high level guests/other host country VIPs.

Liaison officers are responsible for

- ensuring that the vehicle assigned to the Governor or HOD is available, coordinating with the drivers and transport desk as needed;
- channeling information to the Governor or HOD and assisting them in communicating with nationals;
- coordinating with the ADB and host country secretariats on logistical matters; and
- meeting the Governor or HOD at the start of the working day at their hotel and assisting the Governor or HOD into their vehicle at the end of official events.



The liaison officer's period of duty begins when their assigned Governor or HOD registers and ends when they depart the host country. Duty hours are from 8:00 a.m. to 6:00 p.m., but they may begin duties earlier if they are requested to accompany their assigned Governor or HOD to a breakfast meeting. Also, if the Governor or HOD attends an official event such as a reception after 6:00 p.m., the duty hours end when the Governor or HOD arrives at the venue of the official event.

The liaison officer

- accompanies a Governor or HOD within the city limits only. A separate person may be assigned to accompany the Governor or HOD to the airport or port of exit upon departure;
- conducts their duties in public areas only and should not be requested to accompany a Governor or HOD into private areas, such as hotel rooms;
- does not accompany a Governor or HOD for private business, unless agreed in advance and permission from the host country is granted to do so;
- must be provided with breaks for meals; and
- will bear no financial burden, nor will they give, receive, borrow, or lend money under any circumstances, including making purchases and exchanging currency on behalf of delegation members.

Airport reception staff. The host country should train all airport reception staff and conduct dry runs. They are required to

- meet arriving delegates at the airport,
- assist them in clearing immigration,
- assist in collecting baggage and clearing it through customs,
- escort delegates to their hotel transport, and
- assist Governors or HODs with their departure arrangements, including helping check in their luggage.

Transport desk supervisors, dispatchers, and drivers. Desk supervisors and dispatchers must understand and speak English. The transport desk operates from 8:00 a.m. to 7:30 p.m. daily from the day on-site registration opens until 4:00 p.m. on the day after the meeting. Drivers should be able to understand simple instructions in English. They must know the routes and directions to all annual meeting venues, hotels, airport(s), and hospitals.

Administrative and meeting room arrangements staff. These staff must be able to read and speak English. They are required to

- liaise with the ADB Secretariat in setting up furniture and equipment in the offices, including the turnover and collection of office keys;
- liaise with concerned staff at meeting venues regarding moving schedules, storage facilities, and security;
- coordinate closely with the ADB Secretariat to assist in preparing and setting up meeting hall(s) and rooms for the opening session and business sessions, constituency meetings, press briefings, seminars, and ad hoc meetings;
- move various pieces of furniture and equipment; and
- distribute office supplies and stationery.

Their time schedules are drawn up by the host country in close coordination with the ADB Secretariat. They may be required to work irregular or extended time periods.

Hotel desk staff. These locally engaged staff answer questions and help participants who are encountering problems with or wishing to change their hotel reservations. The staff must be able to understand and speak English and should be familiar with the host country secretariat's arrangements. This desk is staffed from 8:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. daily during the 4-day period of the annual meeting.

Travel and tours desk staff. Usually, at least two people are assigned to this desk to handle inquiries about the annual meeting and the host city. They should have in-depth information on

- official networking events and the Tour Program (if any);
- local facilities, entertainment, shopping; and
- local restaurants with a brief outline of their specialties, average price of meals, and contact details for bookings.

The staff must be able to understand and speak English and should be familiar with the host country secretariat's arrangements. This desk is staffed from 8:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. daily during the 4-day period of the annual meeting.

Information desk staff. Usually, at least two people are assigned to this desk. They must understand and speak English, and should be familiar with the annual meeting schedule, venue plans, and arrangements made by the ADB Secretariat. They handle participant inquiries regarding the location of the various meeting facilities.

They work from 8:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. daily during the 4-day period of the annual meeting. Staff members must check with their respective supervisors before leaving their posts on whether they are required to work before or after these hours.

Ushers. Opening session ushers help participants locate their seats in the hall. A minimum of 20 ushers, preferably in uniform, is required. For a few ad hoc meetings (notified in advance), two to three ushers are required. All must understand, read, and speak English. Opening session ushers must attend a 2-hour briefing on the opening session seating arrangements the afternoon before the event.

The ushers' working hours vary. For briefings that occur the day before the opening session, the time will be determined. On the day of the opening session, they work from 8:00 a.m. to noon. For ad hoc meetings, on the day of a meeting, they are expected to arrive 45 minutes to 1 hour before the scheduled meeting and stay until about 30 minutes after the start of the meeting.

Headset distribution staff. Usually, at least four to five people are assigned to the distribution desk outside the main meeting hall. They must be able to understand, read, and speak English. They are required to

- issue headsets to all participants during events with simultaneous interpretation,
- devise a form to acknowledge receipt and return of headsets,
- maintain daily inventory of headsets,
- exhaust all possible means of retrieval after each session, and
- check meeting spaces after each session for missing headsets.





On the day of the opening session, headset distribution staff work from 8:30 a.m. to noon. On the day of the business session, they work from 2:00 p.m. to the end of the session.

Service personnel and technicians. These individuals provide general computer, telecommunications, and networking support. They provide hardware like photocopiers, computers, and printers and software like Windows and Microsoft Office. A technical crew on permanent standby should be available to help the ADB Secretariat on any technical problems and should attend to reports received by the help desk.

Supplies officer. This individual coordinates with the ADB Secretariat on the distribution of stationery and office supplies in different offices and handles the stock of extra supplies to meet any shortages.

Other personnel. This includes but may not be limited to security and medical personnel.

Staff Supervised by the ADB Secretariat

The host country also provides about 100 locally engaged staff to support the ADB Secretariat and to work with ADB personnel as secretaries, receptionists, clerks, and messengers. These personnel may be recruited from agencies or universities, or they may be seconded by government departments or associated private sector entities like commercial banks.

The host country proposes agencies that meet ADB requirements as well as any requirements that the host country may have, such as security screening. If necessary, a representative from the host country secretariat may join ADB in interviewing a random sample of local staff to support ADB. Advice from the host country is also requested on labor laws, appropriate remuneration, terms, and conditions.

Locally engaged staff working for ADB personnel are briefed and supervised by ADB. The local staff coordinator and the ADB annual meeting coordinator conduct a familiarization session for locally engaged staff at least 3 days before the opening of offices. The session includes a general overview of ADB, the annual meeting, and the program of official events, as well as any arrangements, such as security, that the host country may need to raise. All aspects related to professionalism are covered, including rules of conduct. More detailed briefing sessions are conducted with each group (e.g., the registration team and secretaries) by the ADB staff in charge of the respective work areas. These sessions familiarize locally engaged staff with their assignments and enable the ADB staff in charge to meet the locally engaged staff and to provide further explanation of their assignments and responsibilities as necessary.

The Media Center requires specialized staffing in host countries whose media use a local language other than English. In this case, the center requires two translators, one for translating English content to the local language, and one to translate local language materials to English.

Last, the host country will be provided with the Environmental and Social Management System Supplier Sponsor Declaration of Compliance. The host country will verify if such standards are covered in the host country labor laws and ensure that contractors abide by these standards. The host country will also advise ADB on any relevant labor laws and requirements that must be followed in dealing with local staff.

Timeline of Tasks Related to Staff Support

Task	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
Locally engage staff	
Discuss local staff requirements and sources	11
Advise ADB on relevant labor laws, appropriate remuneration, and terms and conditions	11
Discuss with ADB arrangements for food, transport, and uniforms for local staff	11
Advise ADB on sourcing and recruitment	7
Train local staff in their jobs, including drivers of shuttle buses and liaison officers	1
Briefing	
Confirm date of hiring, training, and briefing	4
Arrange briefings by host country and ADB Secretariat	1





CHAPTER 18

FURNITURE AND SUPPLIES

Overview

All required furniture and supplies are provided by the host country. Office rooms, meeting rooms, and facilities must be equipped with furniture, furnishings, partitioning, stands, and service counters, as acceptable to ADB. The host country appoints a supplies controller to oversee the delivery of supplies and designates a help desk to maintain stocks of extra supplies to meet possible shortages. Preference should be given to local suppliers and locally produced furniture.



Annual meeting office rooms, meeting rooms, and facilities.

All furniture and equipment must be in place and functional at least 2 days before offices (such as the Media Center and Civil Society Organizations Center) open for a check. Furniture should be rented rather than purchased, where possible.

Supplies

Supplies should be made available 2 days before the offices open and delivered to the ADB Secretariat for distribution. Semi-expendable supplies (e.g., staplers, scissors, rulers) are returned to the host country after the meeting.

General Supplies

Below is a checklist of the usual supplies required, and the approximate total quantity needed for the annual meeting offices.

Item	Quantity
Bond paper, letter size and A4	50 reams (500 sheets/ream)
Spiral notebooks	50 pads
Black ballpoint pens	200 pieces
Highlighters	50 pieces
Black permanent markers	50 pieces
Paper clips	50 boxes
Rubber bands	1 box
Rulers	10 pieces
Scissors	50 pieces
Clear adhesive tape	50 pieces
Staplers and staple removers	50 pieces
Staple wire	50 boxes
Wastebaskets	100 pieces
Adaptors and extension cords (with universal power outlets)	100 pieces



Supplies for Specific Events (per Event/Room)

Business Session and Governors' Meetings	
Notepads with annual meeting logo	100 pads (20 sheets per pad)
Registration Center	
Corrugated cardboard filing boxes for badges (16 inches x 14 inches x 16 inches)	20 pieces
Utility cutters with retractable blade	3 pieces
Wastebaskets	10 pieces
Adaptors and extension cords (with universal power outlets)	20 pieces
Seminars	
Country names (printed on thick board/Toblerone style)	
Stanchions (for Governors' Plenary)	6 (depends on room)
Return Shipment of Documents (designated freight forwarder may be requested to provide)	
Corrugated cardboard boxes (16 inches x 14 inches x 16 inches)	20 pieces
Utility cutters with retractable blade	3 pieces
Plastic twine	5 rolls
Packing tape	10 rolls
Bubble, plastic, and paper wrap	15 rolls

Timeline of Tasks Related to Furniture and Supplies

Task	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
Discuss with ADB all furniture and supplies required	11
Provide rental rates of equipment and services for seminars	11
Provide photos of sample furniture and set up equipment for ADB to check	8
Procure any furniture, equipment, and supplies required	8
Ensure that furniture, equipment, and supplies provided are of appropriate standards	4



CHAPTER 19

CATERING



Overview

The host country appoints a dedicated and experienced catering manager to work during the pre-planning phase of the annual meeting and on-site during the meeting as the needs of the various delegations are complex and require detailed logistics coordination.

Caterers need to be able to provide a range of cuisines, including Asian and Western, halal and vegetarian, dairy and nondairy, and if possible organic and fair-trade options. Where snacks are required, the host country may choose to serve local delicacies and beverages to showcase their country's culture in addition to standard coffee, tea, and chilled mineral water.

Many participants eat at functions and events; however, a number will also need to purchase their own food every day. The preference is for fast food that can be eaten at the outlet or taken away. However, there is also a demand for sit-down meals. ADB cannot estimate the number of meals that will be required outside of official events and ADB-organized functions. The host country and caterers must therefore estimate this themselves. Consumption will depend on the cost and range of food available, and other options in and around the venue.

At least two waiters are required to serve and clean up during meetings and in the offices of the ADB President, ADB Secretariat, Board, and Management.

Catering

Breakfast meetings, luncheon meetings, and receptions hosted and paid for by ADB are mostly held at the annual meeting venue. Experienced caterers are appointed to provide refreshments and catering for participants. The caterers should provide ADB and the host country organizers a variety of menus for official events. The caterer also provides tables, chairs, linens, plates, silverware, glassware, flowers, and other decorations. The caterers must be able to prepare food in one place and transport and serve it in another, with enough staff to provide prompt and efficient service in a short period of time.



Offices

The host country provides coffee, tea, chilled mineral water, and snacks in all ADB offices. These include the offices of the host country secretariat, ADB management offices and Secretariat, the Media Center, Registration Center, and Civil Society Organizations Center.

Meetings

Refreshments are provided in the lounges for delegates, guests, and observers. Coffee, tea, chilled mineral water, and snacks are provided in the meeting rooms used for constituency, bilateral meetings, and other meetings and seminars. Bottled water is required in meeting rooms and simultaneous interpretation booths. The caterer is responsible for monitoring use and replenishing empty water bottles and glasses between meetings.

ADB prepares a detailed catering and refreshment schedule for the provision of refreshments in temporary offices, constituency and other meetings, and seminars.



Networking area at the 58th Annual Meeting of the Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.

Restaurants

The meeting venues must have adequate restaurant, cafeteria, and snack bar facilities for all participants for the duration of the meeting and a capacity for small functions on an ad hoc basis. These outlets provide a variety of hot and cold dishes and beverage service on an extended daily schedule to be agreed with ADB. Provision is made to cater to the needs of secretariat members and other workers who need reasonably priced food that can be served quickly and eaten in offices.

Secretariat and locally engaged staff also need to be able to buy food early in the morning and late in the evening. Consideration may be given to preparing packed lunches for staff to purchase. Dining facilities must be open even when the meeting period falls on a weekend or public holiday.

The food outlets are paid on an individual basis. The outlets need to accept all major credit cards and cash.

Food Safety

Careful attention must be paid to food standards by all service staff handling food (including during tours), which shall ensure appropriate safety and hygiene. The accreditation process must include a review of legislation on national food safety standards, and contingencies in case of an emergency must be covered in the contracts of the suppliers. Caterers will be selected at least 6 months prior to the annual meeting. The caterer must have in place a food safety management system that controls the five most common risk factors responsible for food-borne illness, namely

- purchasing food from unsafe sources,
- failing to cook food adequately,
- holding food at improper temperatures,
- using contaminated equipment, and
- practicing poor personal hygiene.

During actual food service, the provider should offer the following as a minimum:

- Hot food (food cooked and kept hot or reheated)
 - Held at an internal temperature of 60 degrees Celsius or higher
 - If reheating is required, heat at 74 degrees Celsius
 - Use only heat-holding equipment that can keep food at the proper temperature
- Cold food (chilled and prepared cold foods)
 - Held at an internal temperature of 5 degrees Celsius or lower
 - Use only cold-holding equipment that can keep food at the proper temperature
 - Do not store food directly on ice except for whole fruit and vegetables

Menus should offer a wide range of food choices such as meat (including halal), fish, vegetables, cereals, breads, fruits, and a variety of beverages to accommodate all kinds of food restrictions, with adequate quantity and reasonable prices. No pork is included in menus for ADB-hosted events and beef is also not advisable.

The host country may also consider providing food free of charge for some categories of participants on certain days.



Food choices in recyclable boxes at the Annual Meeting in Tbilisi, Georgia.

Timeline of Tasks Related to Refreshments

Task	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
Recommend three caterers to provide refreshments for events and on-site food outlets	11
Waive any fee imposed on outside caterers	11
Arrange for ADB to meet caterers to discuss requirements	9
Ensure adequate kitchen and other facilities for the caterers	9
Caterers to send menu selection to ADB for transmittal to event organizers	6
Caterers to confirm with ADB that requirements will be met	3
Caterer to deliver goods and services and submit bill for payment	Month of the annual meeting



CHAPTER 20

MEETING SUPPORT SERVICES



Overview

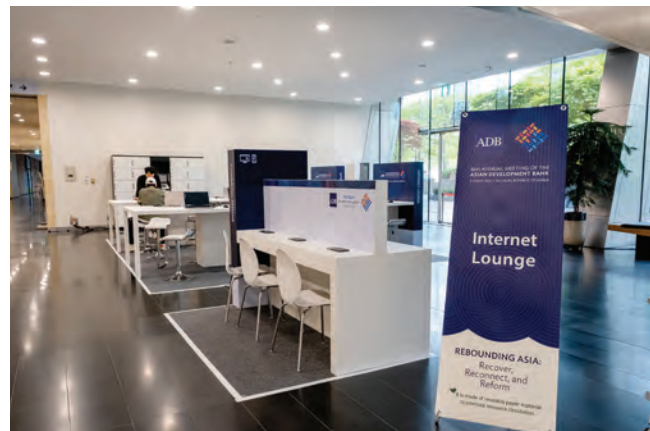
Ancillary meeting facilities and services are provided throughout the annual meeting to make it easy for delegates to continue to do business while they attend the meeting. Access to computers connected to the internet, foreign exchange desks, and ATMs need to be provided by the host country. It is also the host country's duty to provide facilities for people with disabilities. The following summarizes what is required.

Information Desk

Located at the main entrance of the meeting venue with an appropriate sign, the information desk provides general information about the meeting to all participants. The desk also directs participants to meeting rooms, offices, events, and meeting services, and serves as the contact point for lost and found items. A computer and printer are available for staff to respond to e-queries sent through the annual meeting app.

Usually, at least two English-speaking staff members with excellent communication skills are assigned to this desk for the duration of the meeting. They should have knowledge of

- meetings, events, services, and their locations;
- locations of offices;
- local knowledge (e.g., of hotels, landmarks, local services); and
- general help desk functions.



Internet lounge at the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.



Volunteers prepare to welcome delegates to the 58th Annual Meeting of the ADB Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.

Wi-Fi, Charging Stations, Printing, and Mobile Counter

- Free Wi-Fi should be available across all meeting venues.
- Cellphone charging stations and printing centers should be accessible in the main venue from the opening to the end of the meeting (i.e., days 1 to 4) and be operational and staffed from 8:00 a.m. to 6:00 p.m. daily. Special arrangements should be made for these services to be open in case the meeting falls on a weekend or a public holiday.
- A mobile counter at the event venue should sell prepaid cards, recharge cards, IDD cards, and SIM cards. It should accept international credit cards.

Currency Exchange Service and ATM

A commercial bank provides a currency exchange service in several major currencies for all participants at the meeting venues throughout the duration of the meeting (i.e., days 1 to 4) from 9:00 a.m. to 6:00 p.m. It is also helpful if an ATM that accepts international credit and debit cards could be provided at the meeting venue to dispense cash. Special arrangements should be made for these facilities to be open in case the meeting falls on a weekend or a public holiday.

Headset Distribution Counter

A headset distribution counter is established outside or inside of the meeting venues for sessions where simultaneous interpretation is offered. Headsets are placed in audience seats for the opening session, business session, Governors' seminar, Governors' plenary, and ADB seminars. For this counter, the requirements are

- table space measuring 2 meters by 1 meter;
- four chairs for staff servicing the counter;
- one wastepaper basket;
- signs to identify the headset distribution area, indicate channel assignments, and advise participants to return headsets after each session; and
- racks for individual headsets.

Usually, at least four to five persons are assigned to this counter. They are responsible for

- issuing headsets to all participants during the sessions with simultaneous interpretation,
- maintaining a daily inventory of the headsets,
- exhausting all possible means of retrieval after each session, and
- checking meeting spaces after each session for missing headsets.





Transport Desk

A transport desk for car and shuttle bus inquiries is required in meeting venues and at each hotel at which a substantial number of delegates are staying. These desks at hotels may also provide information on tours, shopping, and restaurants as well as providing event and shuttle bus schedules. Staff members operating the desks should have all information that they require, including copies of the shuttle schedule, the handbook and directory, and the schedule of annual meeting events.

Travel and Tours Desk

A travel and tour desk, managed by representatives of a local travel agency or airline, provides assistance to participants arranging their return (or onward) bookings and to provide, preferably at no charge, other travel-related functions (e.g., reconfirmation of airline bookings, rerouting and reissuing of airline tickets, revalidation and changing of reservations, car rental reservations, sightseeing arrangements, post-meeting tour information and reservations, local tours and tourist information, and reservations). The desk also handles inquiries from participants about local facilities, entertainment, and shopping. A list of local restaurants with a brief outline of specialties, average price of meals, and telephone numbers for bookings should also be available for participants.

An emergency after-office telephone number for a representative should also be available to assist participants.

Hotel Desk

The hotel desk may be located with the travel and tours desk. The hotel desk provides a direct line of communication with all official hotels and assists participants in making any changes to hotel reservations made through the officially appointed travel agency or hotel agent.

Help Desk

A help desk facility delivers basic services, such as requests for service personnel and technicians for office equipment and signs, office supplies, and human resources, to all ADB offices. It is also used to locate key members of the HOC urgently and for crisis management. Located within the host country secretariat offices, this facility usually operates through a centralized telephone system (or email station) for use primarily by the two secretariats, ADB staff, and host country service and technical personnel. The help desk supervisor should have decision-making authority. English-speaking representatives from key units of the HOC, convention center, and any PCO are assigned in shifts to operate the help desk during the meeting. The host country should ensure that the companies providing the hardware and software for the meeting are also available to provide support as required.

The management of the help desk requires

- knowledge of the logistical arrangements of the meeting,
- the ability to handle several requests simultaneously,

- familiarity and capacity to establish communication with ADB and host country secretariat counterparts, and
- necessary equipment to deliver services.

Janitorial Services

Enhanced janitorial services are required for all public areas, including public restrooms. The cleaning of the meeting area and other areas is scheduled in consultation with the ADB Secretariat and security. All janitors must be trained in proper waste management.

Prayer Rooms

Prayer rooms, one for men and one for women, are available inside the meeting venue. No furniture is needed, but the rooms should have floor carpeting and be near restrooms. The rooms should be at least 4 m².

Staff Rest Areas

Rest areas must be provided for groups of personnel working at the annual meeting, including local staff, liaison officers, drivers, and security staff. These areas should have sufficient seating for personnel to relax, tables for eating, water, and refreshments. A landline telephone may also be needed, as well as Wi-Fi.

Printing

The HOC should appoint an official printing partner for the annual meeting so that all printing requirements can be streamlined through one point of contact. As a sustainability measure, printing is largely discouraged and instead, where possible, digital solutions should be provided. If needed, materials should be printed on recycled paper and recycled once the event has concluded.

General Guidelines

All ADB publications should be digitally available on the ADB annual meeting website and advertised through digital newsletters and digital screens at the venue. If printed publications are necessary—e.g., for a publication launch—only a few copies should be shipped. Promotional fliers could be brought instead, USB versions could be offered, or limited copies may be printed on-site.

All seminars, institutional events, and host country events should use digital backdrops only, doing away with printing, installing, and dismantling physical backdrops. Generic digital branding backdrops are used to brand the venue.

Some informational and promotional materials about the annual meeting may be printed under exceptional circumstances. ADB consults the host country on the content of these materials. Any selected items that are printed for the annual meeting should follow the event's branding guidelines. News releases are printed upon request only.



Sponsored seminar organizers are allowed to bring printed materials for distribution but are encouraged to keep this to a minimum or to distribute them on USBs. They are responsible for taking back leftover copies after the event.

Economic and financial print publications cleared by DOCK may be displayed in selected high-traffic areas in the venue. Media organizations may distribute their newspapers and magazines in bins or racks, which they will take care of providing, delivering, and displaying at the venue in close consultation with DOCK. They may also arrange newspaper distribution in delegates' hotels.

Any printed materials that have not been cleared by DOCK will be collected and returned to the publisher post-event. Shipping and transport of these materials will be charged to the publisher.

Governors' statements are posted on the annual meeting website after delivery. Documents or presentations are also uploaded on the website.

Printed Event Materials

The Office of the Secretary evaluates all requests to print materials for the annual meeting. Approved materials should be printed locally. The four categories of printed event materials are as follows:

Event and directional signages. These are used to brand external areas of the event venue, arrival areas at the airport, appointed hotels, and interiors of the venue. All large format printing is provided by and coordinated with the host country. ADB provides branding guidance in the brief on branding for the meeting, as well as graphic design and file preparation assistance if required.

Event documentation materials. Produced on-site, these either enhance an event or provide further information to participants. These are usually printed using photocopiers or desktop printers. While a limited amount of printed event documentation is allowed, digital distribution is highly encouraged.

Event souvenirs. Produced by the host country for delegates, examples of these materials include bags, notebooks, USBs, ID lanyards, and notepads.

Maps. Produced and funded by ADB, the event map is a folded, pocket-size leaflet, usually A3 in size. It contains the schedule of events, maps of the venues, and important contact information and is included in delegate bags. The host country assists by supplying appropriate content and providing at least three potential local printing suppliers for ADB to engage.

Timeline of Tasks Related to Printing

Printing	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
Provide ADB with contact details of three printers to print documents on-site for ADB	11
Print materials in accordance with branding guidelines	9



CHAPTER 21

MEDIA AND OUTREACH ACTIVITIES

Overview

The host country media focal plays a significant role in the organization and implementation of the media plan and acts as a link between ADB's media representatives and local media outlets.

While ADB provides leadership and guidance, the host country needs to work closely and collaboratively with their local media contacts to ensure coverage is in line with ADB's meeting guidelines and objectives.

Media and Outreach

Annual meetings attract large international and local media participation. Social media is used to promote the annual meeting before and during the event. International, regional, and local media are invited to attend and cover all public sessions including the following official events:

- opening session;
- business session;
- all seminars organized and coordinated by ADB;
- country presentations;
- the ADB President's opening and closing press conferences; and
- any other ADB-organized press briefings and events, except for closed-door sessions, bilateral meetings, and other events that are by invitation only.

Media are allowed access to most areas of the main venue and can interview ADB management and senior staff and official participants of the meeting.

The host country assists ADB in local media outreach activities at the country level. Such activities could be undertaken as part of the ADB President's official pre-annual meeting visit to the venue approximately 6 months before the meeting and the various pre-annual meeting missions to the host country initiated by other ADB management. Media outreach activities could include visits to ADB-funded projects, press conferences, media interviews, press briefings, and public speaking opportunities for ADB management in think tanks and universities.



Every effort should be made to generate positive media coverage and to ensure that ADB's key messages are effectively and consistently conveyed to international, regional, and local media in the run-up to and during the meeting.

ADB Media and Communications Team

ADB's DOCK operates and manages all media and communications activities from the Media Center. The DOCK team

- coordinates all ADB-related media events;
- informs and updates journalists about events to cover;
- facilitates media interviews with ADB Management, senior staff, and speakers;
- organizes press conferences and media briefings;
- prepares news releases and news briefs;
- oversees the activities of the Developing Member Countries' Journalists Knowledge-Sharing Program;
- promotes the annual meeting through social media;
- writes speeches;
- provides informational materials;
- handles press inquiries; and
- coordinates multimedia production.

The team coordinates closely with the host country media focal point.

Host Country Media Focal Point

The host country designates a media and communications focal point with whom DOCK communicates directly and coordinates closely to facilitate media participation and coverage and implementation of media, multimedia, web, and branding and communications activities. The focal point should be an official of appropriate seniority and authority to make decisions on media matters on behalf of the host country, experienced in media and public relations, and with a good understanding of how the national media operates. They are expected to be appointed not later than 9 months before the meeting.

The overall responsibilities and requirements of the host country media focal person are to

- communicate directly with the DOCK director and be part of the host country secretariat;
- have good local knowledge of the host country's media, be able to communicate effectively in English, and provide ground support to DOCK staff, particularly in the run-up to the annual meeting; and
- be available at the Media Center during the meeting, working closely on a day-to-day basis with the DOCK media team on-site.

Specific activities coordinated by the focal point include

- providing an overview of the host country media and advising on the outreach program needed;
- facilitating visa and other travel requirements, customs clearance of audiovisual and photography equipment, and other formalities for international media;

- providing a list of host country-based journalists whom the host country would like to invite to the meeting;
- facilitating media registration, i.e., assisting local media to register using ADB's electronic system, reminding local media of deadline for online registration, and verifying local media who register on-site;
- arranging local media's requests for interviews with host country officials;
- conducting outreach activities with local media, e.g., coordinating press tours and briefings;
- coordinating with DOCK on local media participation in all key events;
- coordinating live coverage of the annual meeting with national broadcasters of the host country and facilitating hook-ups to other broadcasters;
- coordinating with ADB on social media;
- coordinating upload of content on website and live webcast; and
- helping create promotional materials for the host country.

Media Partnerships

The annual meeting is a vital promotional and branding opportunity for ADB and the host country. ADB partners with international and regional media, while the host country is responsible for media partnerships with local media. Before and during the annual meeting, ADB's website carries media partners' logos with links to their websites.

At the venue, ADB ensures high on-site visibility for media partners by displaying their logos on digital screens, displaying copies of publications in designated areas, and dedicating digital screens to show live or promotional programs. ADB is responsible for operating digital screens of media partners and ensuring they are duly connected with IPTV and cable TV, and for providing multimedia players, terminals, or exhibit displays at the main conference venue and high-traffic areas.

ADB also partners with a reputable international broadcast organization to organize a high-level panel discussion on topical economic and development issues. The event is televised to a global audience for maximum exposure for the annual meeting, ADB, and the host country as well.

Media Center

The facilities and equipment, particularly strong internet connectivity and cabling, should meet ADB requirements and standards of international media.

In host countries where English is not the usual language of local media, two translators will be required for translating English news releases, articles, and transcripts to the local language, translating material in the local language to English, and monitoring local news. These translators will need to be at the Media Center during the 4-day event.



Media Center at the 56th Annual Meeting in Incheon, Republic of Korea.



TV Studio

One well-equipped soundproof TV studio will be set up within or adjacent to the Media Center to facilitate broadcast interviews by ADB and other international broadcast media. With the scaling up of ADB's on-site multimedia activities, the TV studio is crucial to undertake live, on-site interviews with ADB management and participants in a professional setting. These multimedia products will be uploaded as short video packages on the ADB website and shared with broadcast media. The TV studio should be equipped with videoconference equipment to facilitate activities.

Video and Multimedia Content

ADB would like to use every possible opportunity during the annual meeting to highlight its mission to fight poverty in Asia and the Pacific through photos and multimedia material. This may range from the screening of ADB's corporate video just before the start of the opening session, to the uploading of multimedia products to the website, and to the distribution of multimedia packages to broadcasters.

It is important to maintain high-quality videos and multimedia materials as content of high editorial and technical standards adds to the overall branding of the event and enhances the experience of delegates. The following are simple guidelines for video content for the annual meeting:

- Videos should not exceed more than 4 minutes.
- Videos should be relevant to the topics discussed.
- Daily wrap-up videos or photo sequences are included in the loop the morning of the next day.
- Cultural videos that highlight the city and the host country are shown on appropriate screens only (tour desks, information centers), not throughout the IPTV system.
- Videos about corporate sponsors or partners are not shown through IPTV or on the ADB website.
- DOCK clears video content in coordination with the relevant host country focal points.

Video Wall

The host country assists in setting up and connecting the video wall (or one or two large, flat-screen TV monitors) that is connected to the IPTV system or a multimedia player with USB port. The screen(s) may be set up near the exhibit or as a stand-alone setup in a high-traffic area.



Video wall showing corporate videos at the 58th Annual Meeting in Milan, Italy.

Webcasting

Webcasting is an effective and cost-effective way of broadcasting the annual meeting to all interested stakeholders who are not present in the host country. The host country is responsible for contracting the supplier for webcasting services and is also responsible for supplier supervision during the event. Webcasting must be provided by the host country for key events to be webcast live on the ADB and host country websites. The ADB President's opening and closing press conferences, opening session, business session, Governors' seminar and other select seminars must be recorded in digital format, which ADB can upload on its website for webcast or podcast.

Social Media

ADB covers the annual meeting through Facebook (including live broadcasts for selected events), LinkedIn, Instagram, and Storify, among other social media channels. Live social media feeds are featured on IPTV screens to encourage delegates, participation in social media posts, and discussion.

Timeline of Tasks Related to Media and Outreach Activities

Task	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
Host country media outreach program	
Share host country's outreach program with ADB	10
Assist ADB with media and outreach program in host country, as needed	10
Implement program in consultation with ADB	5–1
Media and communications	
Appoint a senior official as host country's media focal point	11
Discuss media and outreach activities for the period before and during the annual meeting. Inform that the ADB President will hold a press conference during his pre-annual meeting visit.	10
Discuss extent of media coverage, including local, regional, and international print and broadcast media participation	10
Discuss media partnerships and inform that ADB will partner with regional and international media organizations to raise awareness of the annual meeting, while the host country considers appropriate partnerships with local media organizations	10
Discuss accreditation and facilitation of visa applications and related travel requirements for international media	10
Discuss customs clearance of audiovisual and photography equipment and other formalities for international media	10
Provide a list of journalists based in the host country, including their email addresses, for issuing online invitations	6
Help local media to register online	5



CHAPTER 22

SPONSORSHIPS, PARTNERSHIPS, AND GIFTS



Overview

ADB has expectations regarding how and what type of sponsors may be engaged by the host country. The bank also has requirements pertaining to the host country's strategic media partnerships and collaborative branding opportunities, and follows guidelines on gifting.

Sponsors and Partners

ADB recognizes the need for host countries to supplement their budgets with sponsored activities, events, and services. To ensure the image of the annual meeting is protected, ADB requires that the host country consults ADB before proposals are submitted to potential sponsors and partners.

Sponsorship

ADB encourages the host country to source sponsors who can provide support or services that are in line with the values of hosting a green and sustainable annual meeting. For activities, events, and even for services, sponsorship should be sourced from institutions and corporations that have some relevance to ADB's development mandate. Sponsors of services are restricted to essential requirements for international conferences, e.g., drinking water, equipment, VIP vehicles, signs, conference bags, and any souvenirs for participants. Host countries may also accept cash from companies that wish to sponsor the annual meeting but are not able to sponsor an activity, event, or service. Any agreements or contracts setting out how such funds should be used, receipts, and reporting requirements are between the host country and the sponsor.

Use of Annual Meeting and ADB Logos

The annual meeting logo may be used with sponsors' logos. However, to safeguard the integrity of the ADB logo, ADB does not permit it to be used for commercial or promotional purposes with sponsors' names or logos. Exceptions are made for ADB-organized seminars that are held in cooperation with another organization or corporation when the purpose is to enhance the value of the seminar and audience interest through a partnership. In such cases, the ADB logo may be used at ADB's discretion with the cosponsors' logo in invitations, joint publications, and seminar banners or backdrops.

Attribution of Sponsorship

Attribution of sponsorship should be treated discreetly. A sponsors' board displaying sponsor names and logos, is acceptable, as is a list of sponsors in a host country publication or on the host country website. High-profile displays are not acceptable unless they are in a separate sponsors' hall.

In general, exhibitions, stalls, and displays of sponsors' products must be held in a separate venue, or on a floor separate from the annual meeting and its offices. Exceptions are made for sponsored meeting services, such as a foreign exchange desk (sponsored by a host country bank), travel desk (sponsored by a host country airline), and displays of publications of a seminar sponsor or of a host country newspaper that is a sponsor/partner.

Out-of-scope requirements of host country sponsors should be executed at the sponsors' expense. It is also the host country's responsibility to ensure that these requirements are delivered and invoiced accordingly.

Partnerships

ADB, through DOCK, may enter partnerships on a nonmonetary basis with international and regional media. The host country may opt to partner with national media in return for reciprocal branding opportunities.

Visibility and branding opportunities for media partners may include installation of a dedicated line for live airing of partners' interviews or programs from the annual meeting venue, showing of promotional materials, placement of stand-up banners, display of logos on digital screens or media partner boards as well as the ADB website, distribution of limited copies of publications at strategic high-traffic areas, provision of TV monitors/terminals to show promotional programs, and exhibition displays. Space allocation will be determined by DOCK in consultation with the host country. Alternatively, if there is an appetite for a social media-based partnership or collaboration, this can be discussed.

As part of the partnership, journalists from the media partner organizations are invited to serve as seminar moderators.

ADB and the host country will share information on their respective media partnerships. ADB and the host country are expected to fulfill the terms under the partnership agreement with their respective media partners.





Discussion at the seminar on Digital Transformation for Sustainable Development in Asia and the Pacific at the 58th ADB Annual Meeting of the Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.



Digital Transformation for Good held on the sidelines of the 58th ADB Annual Meeting of the Board of Governors in Milan, Italy.

Gifts

For the annual meeting, giving gifts or souvenirs is entirely optional. Any gifts are usually practical items that can be used by the meeting participants.

When discussing gifts with sponsors or meeting organizers, it is important to bear in mind these points:

- Many organizations have policies that do not allow their employees to accept gifts, while some impose a limit on what is acceptable.
- Most participants travel to and from the meeting by air and cannot carry heavy gift items such as books.
- Gifts intended for all participants should be gender neutral.
- It is not advisable to give items of clothing.

ADB's policy on acceptance of gifts by its staff requires that gifts determined to be worth not more than \$50 are passed to the head of department concerned, who shall decide the most appropriate manner of disposing of the gift, e.g., by returning the item to the recipient, raffling it among staff in the office.

ADB shall auction, by itself or through an accredited organization, gifts that are determined to be worth more than \$50. Proceeds of the auction shall be donated to a charity chosen by ADB's Corporate Service Department.

Timeline of Tasks Related to Sponsorships, Partnerships, and Gifts

Task	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
Discuss with ADB sponsorship/partnership and promotional opportunities and agree on approval mechanism and acknowledgment of sponsors	10
Nominate sponsors for official events	9–3
Coordinate promotional banners and other materials with ADB	5–1
Consult ADB on sponsorship and partnership proposals and sponsors' materials	5–1
Identify what gifts/souvenirs are required across all areas of the annual meeting for VIPs and other participants	5
Advise ADB on any souvenir items to be given to participants	5
Agree on location of sponsors'/partners' areas	4
Finalize all sponsorship/partnership matters in consultation with ADB	3
Provide ADB with complete list of sponsors/partners and their promotional activities	3





CHAPTER 23

SUSTAINABILITY



Overview

The annual meeting is more than just a platform for networking, partnerships, and business opportunities—it reflects ADB’s commitment to sustainability. Together with the host country, ADB strives to minimize the meeting’s environmental footprint while maximizing its economic and social benefits.

Sustainability principles are embedded in every phase of the planning and implementation cycle to ensure the meeting is cost-effective, financially sound, socially inclusive, and environmentally responsible. These principles influence key decisions such as venue selection, accommodation, and supplier engagement.

ADB, the host country, and all suppliers are expected to fully understand and actively support the meeting’s sustainability objectives—economic, social, and environmental. Through responsible procurement, local partnerships, and alignment with ADB’s green event guidelines, the host country can deliver a meeting that sets a benchmark for sustainability in large-scale international events.

Collaborating with venues, vendors, and suppliers who prioritize sustainability enhances the host country’s reputation as a responsible event destination and strengthens long-term relationships with stakeholders.

The HOC is expected to actively support data collection activities that contribute to the overall sustainability initiative (e.g., energy consumption in the venue, details on catering servings and waste, fuel consumption of cars and buses, etc.). This includes providing relevant information and coordinating with ADB and suppliers to ensure accurate and timely reporting on key sustainability metrics related to the planning and implementation of the meeting.

Environmental Impact

ADB and the host country are committed to minimizing the environmental footprint of the annual meeting through sustainable practices focused on resource efficiency, waste reduction, and carbon offsetting.

Venue. Selected venues prioritize energy efficiency and effective waste management. On-site environmental practices include

- use of reusable cups and glasses,
- recycled registration materials and badges,
- maximized natural lighting,
- clearly marked recycling bins, and
- noise levels maintained within acceptable limits.



Scenes at the 56th Annual Meeting in Incheon, Republic of Korea.



Sustainable transportation. To reduce emissions, free public transport cards are provided for all participants and electric or hybrid vehicles and carpooling options are used, particularly for senior delegates.

Food and catering. Catering services emphasize local, fresh ingredients and sustainable sourcing. Practices also include

- use of cloth napkins and reusable tableware,
- condiments served in refillable containers,
- water served upon request,
- food waste composted or donated when possible, and
- diverse menu options to accommodate dietary needs.

Waste management. Single-use plastics are minimized. Recycling stations are made available throughout the venue, and the event is designed to be as paperless as possible.



Eco-friendly transportation at the 56th Annual Meeting in Incheon, Republic of Korea.



Accommodation. Hotels recommended for participants follow environmental best practices, including paperless check-in/out processes, towel and linen reuse programs, and optional toiletry replacement.

Digital approach. A digital-first approach is adopted to reduce printed materials. Event information is shared via mobile apps, online platforms, and digital signage. Where physical signage is necessary, reusable panels are prioritized.

Carbon offsetting. Unavoidable carbon emissions from the annual meeting are offset through ADB-supported projects aimed at reducing greenhouse gas emissions.

Social Impact

Workforce standards. All staff, contractors, and suppliers engaged in the meeting must comply with local labor laws. This includes providing fair working conditions, meeting occupational health and safety standards, and following equal opportunity policies, with accommodations made for individuals with special needs.

Community engagement. The host country maintains open communication with local communities through media, outreach events, and public engagement. Local staff are hired where possible, and measures are taken to minimize disruption to daily life.

Cultural exchange. Participants experience the host country's culture through exhibits, performances, cuisine, and locally made products. Small businesses are encouraged to showcase and sell their goods during the event.

Safe and efficient meeting environment. ADB and the host country ensure a clean, safe, and well-organized meeting environment, with strong logistical support and communications systems in place.

Economic Impact

Local businesses are prioritized in the procurement of goods and services such as catering, logistics, printing, and technical support. All procurement activities follow ADB and national regulations to ensure transparency and fairness.

To support the local economy and foster investment, business summits, investment forums, and business-matching events are organized, while local products and services are showcased through exhibits.

Economic data is collected on participant numbers, hotel rates, daily expenditures, and extended stays to assess the meeting's contribution to the host country's economy.

Timeline of Tasks Related to Sustainability

Task	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
Share Event Sustainability Management System Policy and ISO 20121 requirements with HOC	10
Review ADB's generic supplier contract with Sustainability Management Certificate; HOC considers adopting it	9
Propose waste management and conservation measures that can be put in place for the meeting	9
Discuss sustainability considerations with supply chain	9
Attend training at ADB headquarters on sustainable events	7
Set sustainability objectives and indicators; discuss these with supply chain	6
Propose specific sustainable event activities for environmental, economic, and social impacts at the annual meeting	5
Coordinate with venues and suppliers to monitor and measure sustainability results	5 to the month of the annual meeting
Communicate sustainability activities to HOC, local community, and other stakeholders	5 to the month of the annual meeting
Provide previously agreed, relevant data to measure implementation of sustainability objectives	Month of the annual meeting





CHAPTER 24

SHIPMENTS



Overview

ADB ships large and bulky items out of Manila to the host country in preparation for the annual meeting. An experienced shipping and logistics manager should be appointed by the host country to ensure one point of contact for meeting ADB's shipping requirements. ADB then appoints a registered mover or broker who liaises with the focal point of the host country and/or broker.

Shipping

ADB ships some equipment and meeting materials to and from the meeting site. The host country, through its logistics manager and the appointed broker provides

- speedy clearance through customs, transport, and associated costs for local handling (including storage charges) of these materials between the port or airport and the meeting site and back;
- space for meeting materials shipped before the meeting, either at the meeting venue or in the warehouse of the broker appointed to handle shipments, with two rooms (ADB Secretariat office and another large room) at the meeting venue made available after the meeting for assembling meeting materials and documents for the return shipment to Manila; and
- necessary human resources (possibly through its broker) to distribute the materials to their respective offices and meeting areas, and, for the return shipment, manpower and packing materials provided to collect materials to be shipped back to Manila from the different offices and meeting areas.

The host country should advise the expected processing time and required documents for tax exemption and customs clearance, as well as information on both sea and air shipments, including transit time, routing, sailing frequency, and cut-off times to and from the country. They should inform ADB about any important dates or holidays that may affect the shipping schedule.

The host country confirms the door-to-door or door-to-port/airport shipment requirement and provides support, such as trucking, manpower and equipment, to uncrate and crate, unpack and repack the shipment, including making available equipment to transfer bulky shipments from one place to another within the venue and back to the warehouse of assigned mover or broker.

Timeline of Tasks Related to Shipments

Task	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
Discuss shipment requirements with ADB	11
Appoint a focal person for shipment	9
Inform ADB of appointed broker to handle shipments	7
Submit necessary documents for tax exemption to shipping company	5
Handle customs clearance and actual shipment from ADB	3
Provide storage as necessary for ADB shipments arriving before the meeting	1
Deliver ADB shipment from storage to the main venue	Month of the annual meeting
Coordinate packing, return to ADB, and customs clearance of shipment after the meeting	Month of the annual meeting





CHAPTER 25

INSURANCE



Overview

Each party has various responsibilities pertaining to insurance for the annual meeting.

Insurance

For the duration of the annual meeting, the host country must have comprehensive general liability insurance, including automobile liability insurance, to cover the facilities and services within the scope of the MOU, either by self-insurance or through an insurance company.

All participants are informed through the invitation letter that they must arrange their own medical, travel, and personal effects insurance while attending the meeting. ADB will not be responsible for coverage of any medical costs of a participant, except for ADB staff and personnel.

If an official delegate is unable to pay for emergency care during the meeting, the host country, through the department responsible, should guarantee all such expenditures. Any funds spent to assist official delegates should be recovered through the ADB Board member or the embassy or consulate concerned.

The host country must take all necessary measures for the personal security of the participants and the safety of their property and the property of ADB while in the meeting venues.

ADB takes out marine insurance, which covers goods only while in transit. It commences as soon as the goods are lifted at origin and ends upon delivery at the destination.

All other insurance requirements must be arranged by the host country. This includes, for instance, third party liability insurance for staff and liaison officers at all venues, and that all equipment provided by the host country in connection with the annual meeting is insured against damage, loss, and theft.

For any third-party suppliers or partners appointed by the host country who have been advised that they are to provide their own general liability insurance, it is requested that the applicable paperwork be brought on-site and verified by a relevant authority appointed by the host country.

Timeline of Tasks Related to Insurance

Task	No. of Months Before the Annual Meeting
Host country to provide comprehensive general liability insurance to cover the venues, equipment, and vehicles provided for the annual meeting	12
ADB to communicate with all participants to arrange for their own medical, travel, and personal insurance while attending the meeting	5
All third-party suppliers to provide their general liability insurance or, if not, are informed that the onus of responsibility for provision of liability insurance is on them	5





CHAPTER 26

PAYMENTS BY ADB



Overview

Suppliers and partners appointed and paid by ADB may include venues, hotels, convention centers, printing services, and caterers. The ADB appointment and payment process is done through ADB's online procurement system.

Tax Exemption

ADB is exempt from value-added tax on its operations and transactions in member countries, as provided in its Charter (footnote 2). The host country is responsible for ensuring that all suppliers recommended to ADB are fully informed of this tax exemption in relation to the annual meeting. All invoice and payment procedures must follow this exception.

Pre-Annual Meeting

During the establishment mission, ADB staff meet with suppliers and discuss procurement policies, guidelines, and payment procedures. Procurement of goods and services follows ADB guidelines, posted at the ADB Institutional/Corporate Procurement website, <http://www.adb.org/site/business-opportunities/institutional-procurement>.

Suppliers must use this site to ensure all guidelines are followed. Failure to comply may result in their proposal being rejected or excluded from consideration.

Once a supplier is selected, they should complete the online supplier registration via the ADB Supplier Management System at <http://supplier.adb.org>. It can also be accessed from the ADB Institutional/Corporate Procurement website. All payments are processed through this system.

The supplier will be requested to provide documents, such as financial statements and articles of incorporation. ADB will only accept supporting documents in English. Suppliers must make the necessary arrangements for English translation before submitting to ADB. Bank details provided should be accurate to avoid unnecessary delays in processing. Suppliers will be notified of registration completion after all documents are confirmed.

While they undertake their online registration process, the supplier also provides ADB with their contract or agreement. This starts the negotiation process and helps minimize processing time. Contracts and agreements can be signed,

however advance payments may only be processed after completing registration. The supplier should provide ADB with three original copies of the signed contract.

All payments are made through wire transfer. Processing time is 2–3 weeks, assuming all documents and requirements are completed. It normally takes a maximum of 15 business days to receive the payment. Please ensure that this is incorporated in the contract or agreement.

During the Annual Meeting

On the last day of the annual meeting, the supplier prepares an advance copy of the bill in the agreed currency to be charged to the ADB master account and presents it to ADB. ADB reviews the advance copy of the bill on-site to ensure its accuracy.

Timeline of Tasks Related to Payments by ADB

Task	No. of Months Before Annual Meeting
ADB sends the supplier information form to suppliers	11
Suppliers register online	11
ADB confirms the online registration	After supplier completes documentary requirements
Suppliers send contract or agreement to ADB; negotiations commence	As required
Advance payment process	After ADB confirms online supplier registration
For payments to be made after the meeting, ADB reviews advance copy of bill	Last day of meeting
Supplier prepares final bill in agreed currency	Day after meeting
ADB brings original invoice or bill and supporting documents to ADB headquarters for processing	End of meeting
Processing of payment takes 2–3 weeks, assuming all documents are complete, and the supplier information form has been set up	Month of the annual meeting
Payment is made through wire transfer and may take a maximum of 15 business days after the value date for ADB's bank to remit payment to the bank of the supplier	Month of the annual meeting

Asian Development Bank—Annual Meeting Requirements Manual

This manual sets out the main requirements of the annual meeting of the Asian Development Bank (ADB), as referred to in the memorandum of understanding signed by the host country government and ADB. It provides a detailed guide for the host country and ADB of the requirements for an annual meeting and the responsibilities on each side. While the requirements are fairly standard for each annual meeting, they may vary according to location, local conditions, and other factors that may arise during the organization of the meeting.

About the Asian Development Bank

ADB is a leading multilateral development bank supporting inclusive, resilient, and sustainable growth across Asia and the Pacific. Working with its members and partners to solve complex challenges together, ADB harnesses innovative financial tools and strategic partnerships to transform lives, build quality infrastructure, and safeguard our planet. Founded in 1966, ADB is owned by 69 members—50 from the region.

